



OcuTrap

OcuTrap Knowledge Base

Complete user guide for the OcuTrap R1 smart wildlife trap.

Online docs: docs.ocutrap.com

Support: support@ocutrap.com

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OcuTrap Knowledge Base

Everything you need to set up, operate, and troubleshoot your OcuTrap smart trap — hardware guides, app help, billing, and support.

New here? Start with the [Set-up Tutorial](#). If something is not working, check [Common Issues](#) or [Trap Offline or Won't Connect](#).

Browse the docs

Getting Started	Set up your trap, connect the app, and learn how arming and captures work.	set-up-tutorial.md
Troubleshooting	Fix offline traps, door problems, motor connections, and other common issues.	common-issues.md
FAQs	Battery, firmware, weather, camera settings, and everyday questions.	common-questions.md
Account & Billing	Manage subscriptions, update payment methods, and reset your password.	managing-your-subscription.md
Device Management	Transfer or sell a trap, run test mode, and manage device ownership.	selling-or-transferring-a-trap.md
Support	Contact us, report bugs, and review safety information.	support.md
Downloads	Print-friendly PDFs, cheat sheets, and other reference materials.	downloads.md
Legal & Compliance	Warranty, disclaimers, and compliance information.	legal-disclaimers-and-compliance-information.md

Popular guides

Quick links to the pages customers open most often:

[Set-up Tutorial](#)

[Trap Offline or Won't Connect](#)

[Common Issues](#)

[Battery Overview](#)

[LED Guide](#)

System status

Check whether OcuTrap services are running normally before troubleshooting a connection issue.

<https://ocutrap.statuspage.io/>

Getting Started

Setup

Get your OcuTrap assembled, powered, and in the field.

[Introduction](#)

[Set-up Tutorial](#)

[Hardware Set Up](#)

[Video Assembly](#)

[Deploying Your Trap in the Field](#)

Introduction



What is OcuTrap?

- **Innovative OcuTrap Technology:** Transforming the approach to trap monitoring, management, and control.
- **Significant Time and Cost Savings:** Drastically reduces the need for frequent trap checks, saving both time and resources.
- **Instant Mobile Alerts:** Get notified immediately upon the capture of your target animal, enabling efficient trap management.
- **Smart Control Features:** Facilitates the precise capturing of target animals through advanced technology.

- **Remote Operation Capability:** Manage trap doors from anywhere in the world, significantly reducing the risk of injuries from accidental encounters with the trapped animals.

First time using your OcuTrap? Check out the [Set-up Tutorial](#).

[Safety Information](#)

Set-up Tutorial

Setting up your OcuTrap has two parts: **assembling the hardware** and **connecting it to the app**. This page walks the whole path in order — follow the steps top to bottom, and open the linked guides when you want more detail or photos.

Step 1: Charge the battery

Do this first so the battery charges while you assemble the trap.

1. Open the small white box and find the charger.
 2. Charge the **blue battery** until the charger light turns **green** — a full charge takes about **5–6 hours**.
-

Step 2: Assemble the trap

Assembly covers the **door**, the **handle**, and the **POD** (the module that holds the camera, sensor, and electronics). Two guides cover the same build — written steps with photos, or follow-along videos:

[Hardware Set Up](#)

[Video Assembly](#)

If any part is missing or damaged, stop and contact support@ocutrap.com before continuing.

Step 3: Create your account and add your trap

You manage your OcuTrap from the web portal at app.ocutrap.com — or from the mobile app, which has the same features.

1. Create an account (or log in) at app.ocutrap.com. Verify your email — the app asks for this before you can activate a trap.
2. Open **Add trap** and follow the wizard: enter your **Trap ID** and **Device ID** (both are on labels on/inside the trap), choose a cellular plan, name the trap and set its location, then tap **Activate trap**.
3. When activation completes, the app opens the new trap's **console page**, with a **Waiting for first check-in** note that clears once the trap connects. To finish billing, select **Billing** in the sidebar, find the trap under **Per-trap status**, and select **Manage**. The plan you picked in the wizard is already selected.

Full walkthrough with screenshots: [Adding a trap to your account](#).

Using a phone? Install the mobile app and turn on push notifications so capture alerts reach you immediately — see [Using the Mobile App](#).

Step 4: Power on and confirm it's connected

1. Insert the charged battery and power on the trap.
2. Watch the status LED — **breathing cyan** means the trap is connected to the cloud and ready. Other colors: [LED Guide](#).
3. Confirm the trap shows as **online** in the app.

If it won't connect, give it a minute, then see [Connectivity & Coverage](#).

Step 5: Place, set your capture distance, and test

Where you put the trap and how you set the **capture distance** matter more than anything else — the camera and sensor are fixed inside the POD, so there's nothing to aim.

The essentials:

- Put **bait behind the sensor**, near the back of the cage.
- Set the trap on **level, stable ground**.
- Pick a **capture distance** in the app (presets from 6 in to 18 in; default 8 in).
- **Test before you walk away**: arm the trap, wave your hand slowly through the detection zone, and confirm the door closes and you get a capture alert.

The full field guide — placement, capture-distance tuning, the pre-departure checklist, and validating with [Scouting Mode](#):

Deploying Your Trap in the Field

Step 6: Arm it and turn on notifications

1. **Manually open the door** — for safety, arming requires the door to already be open.
2. Tap **Arm** in the app. See [Arm & Un-arm Button](#) for what each state means.
3. Choose how you want to be alerted (push, email, or both) in [Notification Settings](#).

While armed, the trap checks in on a low-power cycle and can briefly show offline between check-ins — that's normal. You'll be alerted if it stays disconnected for more than an hour.

You're set — what happens next

- **When your trap takes photos**: [When Your Trap Takes Photos](#)
- **When you get a capture**: the door closes and locks, and you get an alert — see [After a Capture](#) and [Handling & Releasing a Captured Animal](#)
- **Getting the most out of your trap**: [Tips and Tricks](#)

Something not working? Check [Common Issues](#) or [Trap Offline or Won't Connect](#).

Hardware Set Up

This guide walks you through assembling your OcuTrap R1 step by step, in three sections: **Door**, **Handle**, and **POD**. Follow each step carefully to ensure your OcuTrap functions correctly. When the hardware is done, continue to [Adding a trap to your account](#) for the app setup.

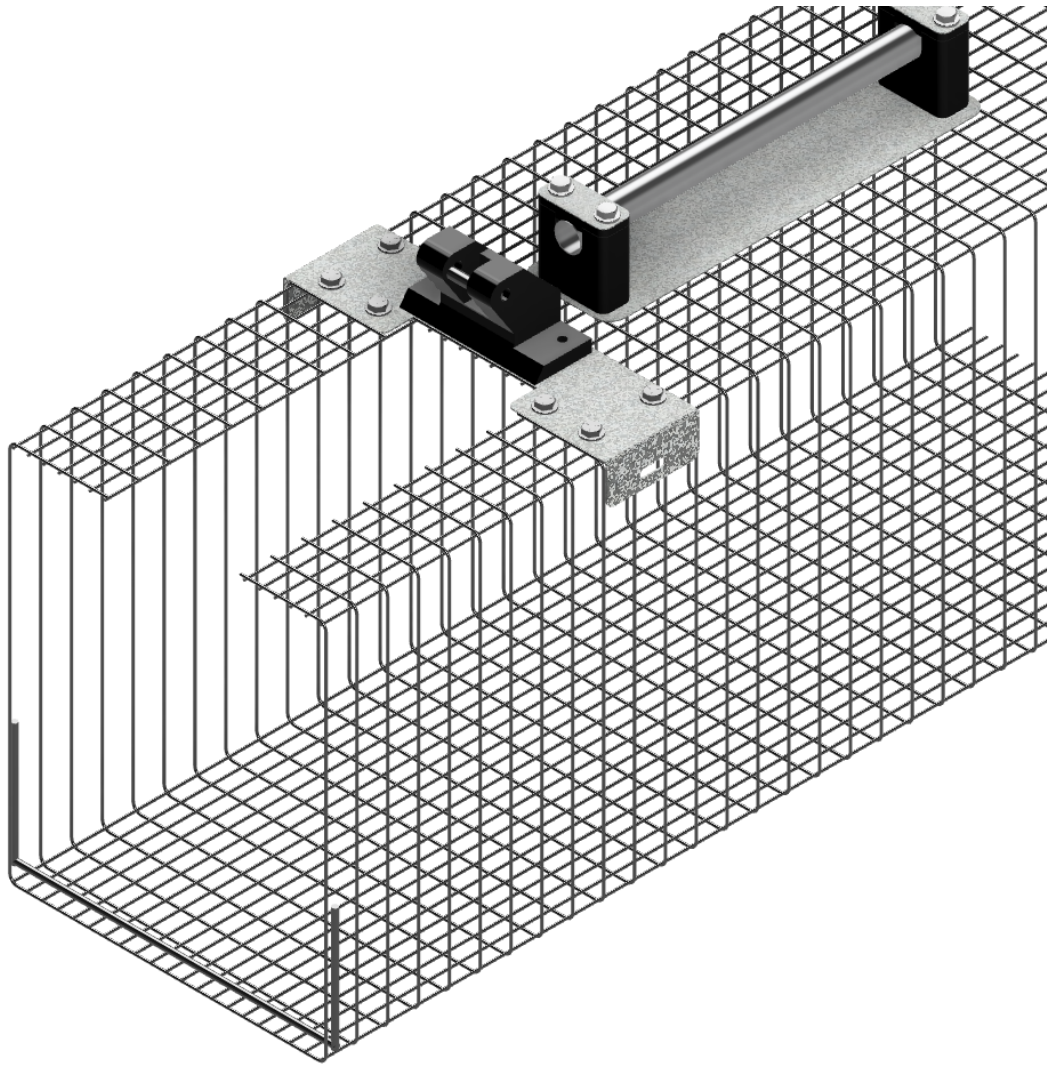
Prefer to watch? The full assembly video is below, and [Video Assembly](#) breaks it into per-section clips.

► **This page has a video.** Watch it online at docs.ocutrap.com.

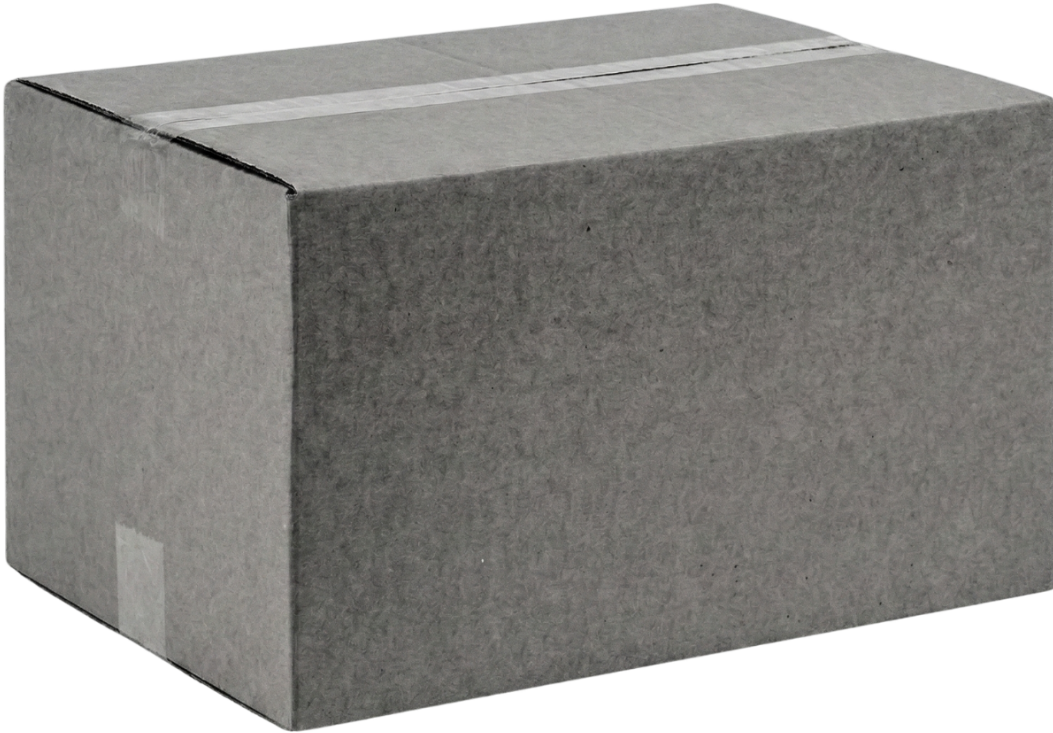
Unboxing and Initial Inspection

Carefully unpack your OcuTrap R1 and check that all components are included:

Cage



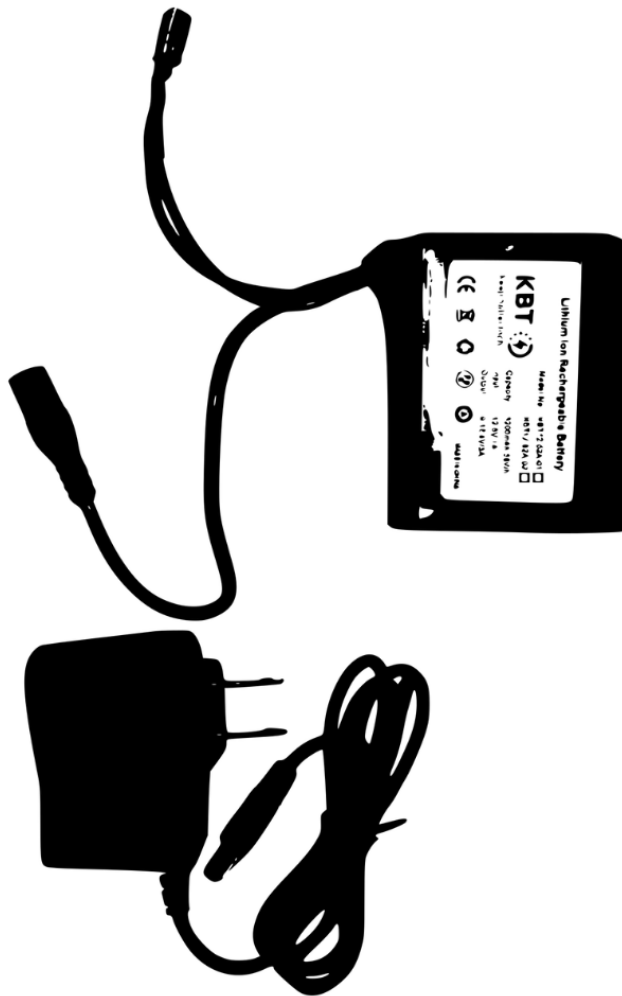
Parts Box



Examine each item for any visible damage. If anything is missing or appears damaged, halt installation and contact support@ocutrap.com with your Trap ID.

Charge the Battery

Fully charge the blue battery until the charger light is green, using the accompanying charger found in the small white box. A full charge takes about 5–6 hours — start it now so it's ready when assembly is done.



Section 1: Door Setup

Step 1: Components Needed for Setup

Before beginning, ensure you have the following parts for the door assembly:

Door

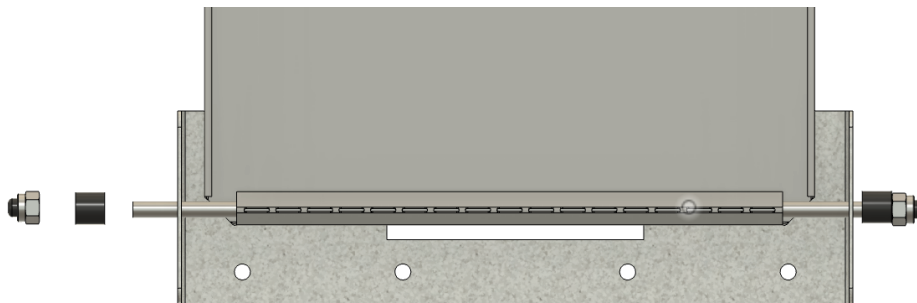
- 2x Brackets (top locking mechanism)
- 2x Black spacers
- 2x Black capped nuts
- 1x Metal door
- 1x 12" Rod
- 1x Nut Driver
- 1x Nut Assembly Tool (figure right)

Motor

- 1x Motor
- 2x Pins
- 2x Clevises

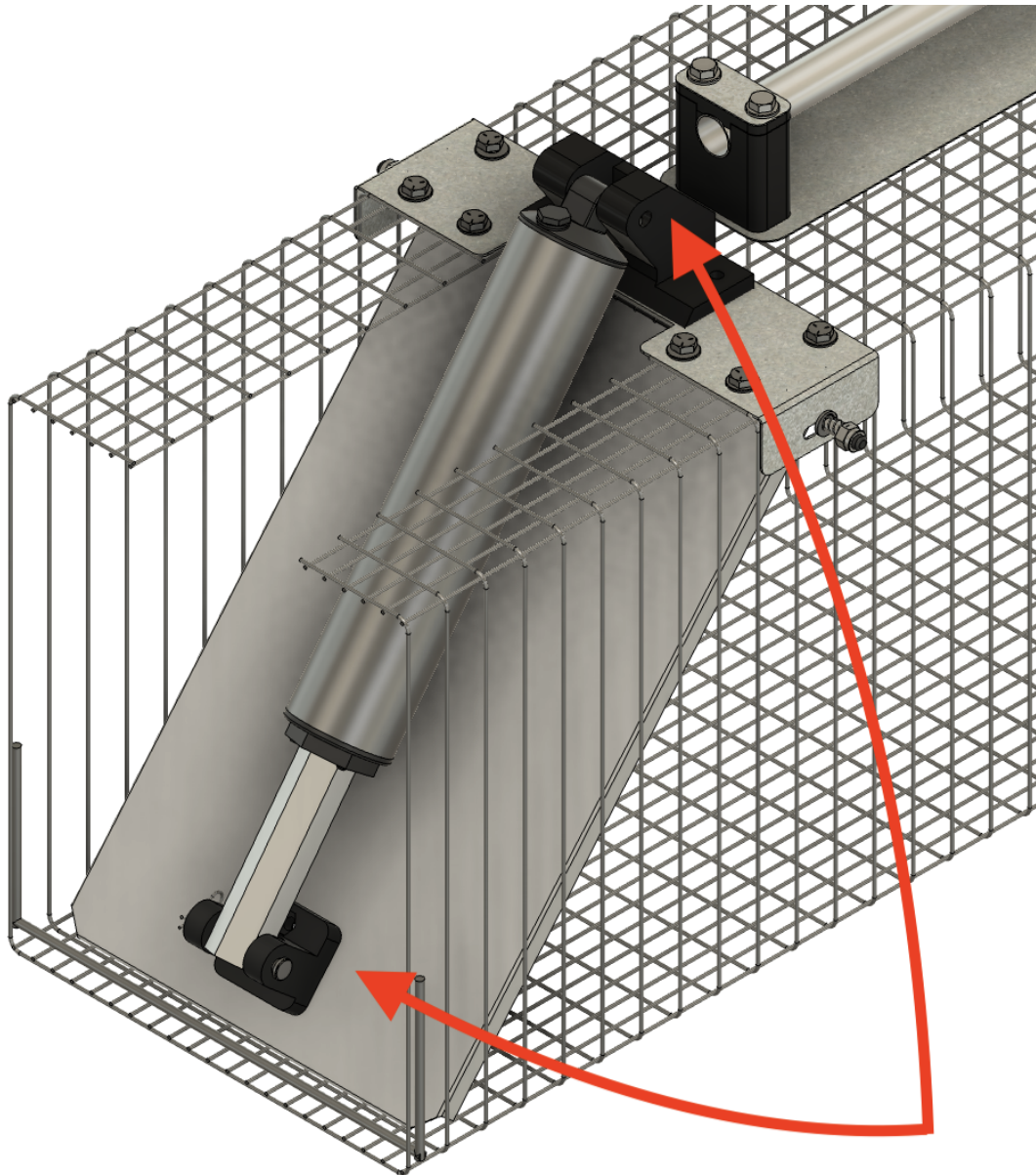
Step 2: Setup the Door Mechanism

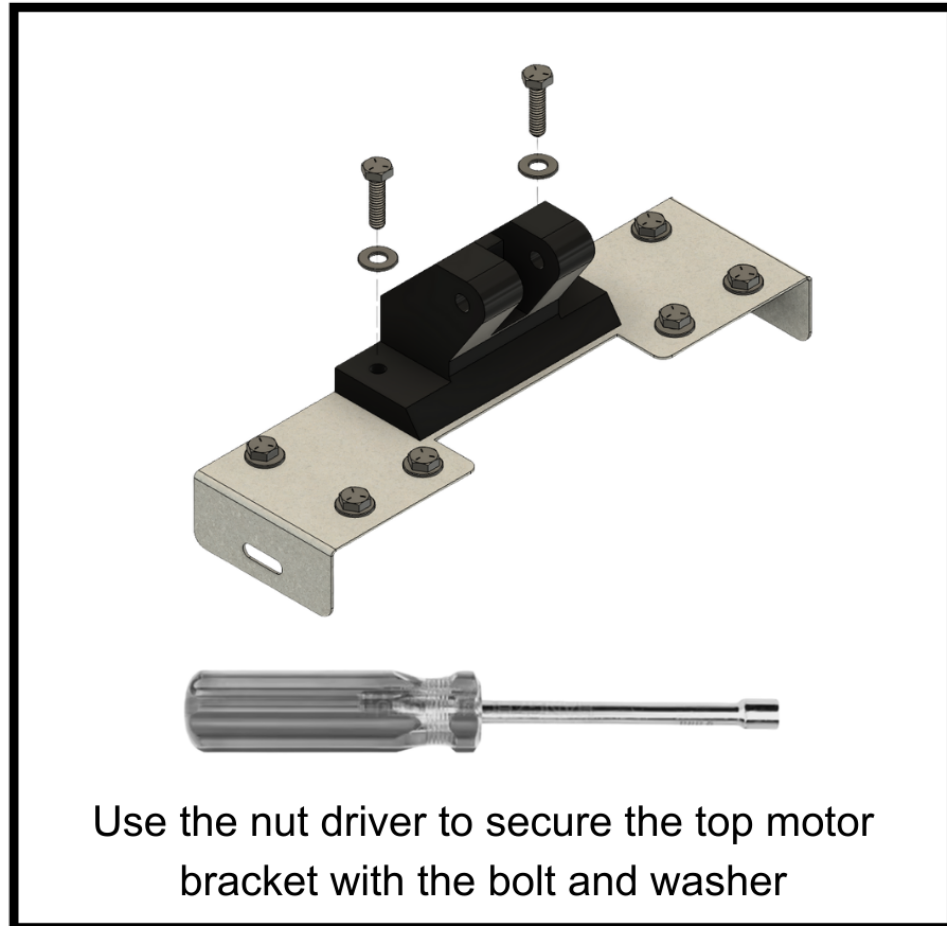
1. Align the metal door inside the trap.
2. Thread the metal rod through the oval slot in the metal bracket attached to the top of the solid metal trap door.
3. On each end of the rod:
 1. Place a black spacer.
 2. Secure it with the black capped nut on both sides
 3. Use the nut assembly tool and the nut driver on each end to tighten the nut until snug.



Step 3: Setup the Motor

1. Install top bracket with washers and bolts. Tighten with nut driver.
2. Use the pins and clevises to secure the motor to the door at both the top and bottom attachment points.
3. Feed the cable through the metal handle.
4. Verify that all components are securely fastened.
5. Check that the door moves smoothly and is properly aligned.



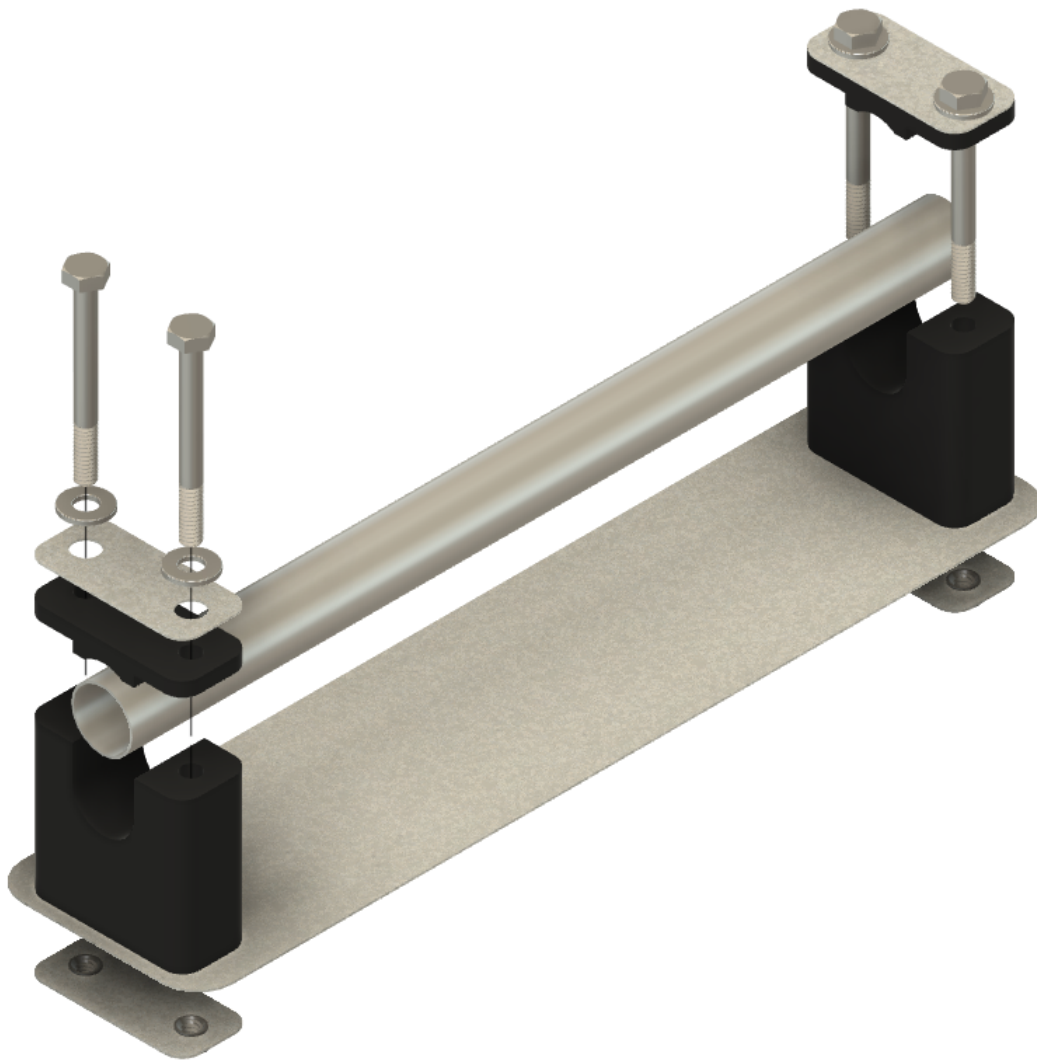


Section 2: Handle Setup

Step 1: Gather Your Components

Before beginning, ensure you have the following parts for the handle setup:

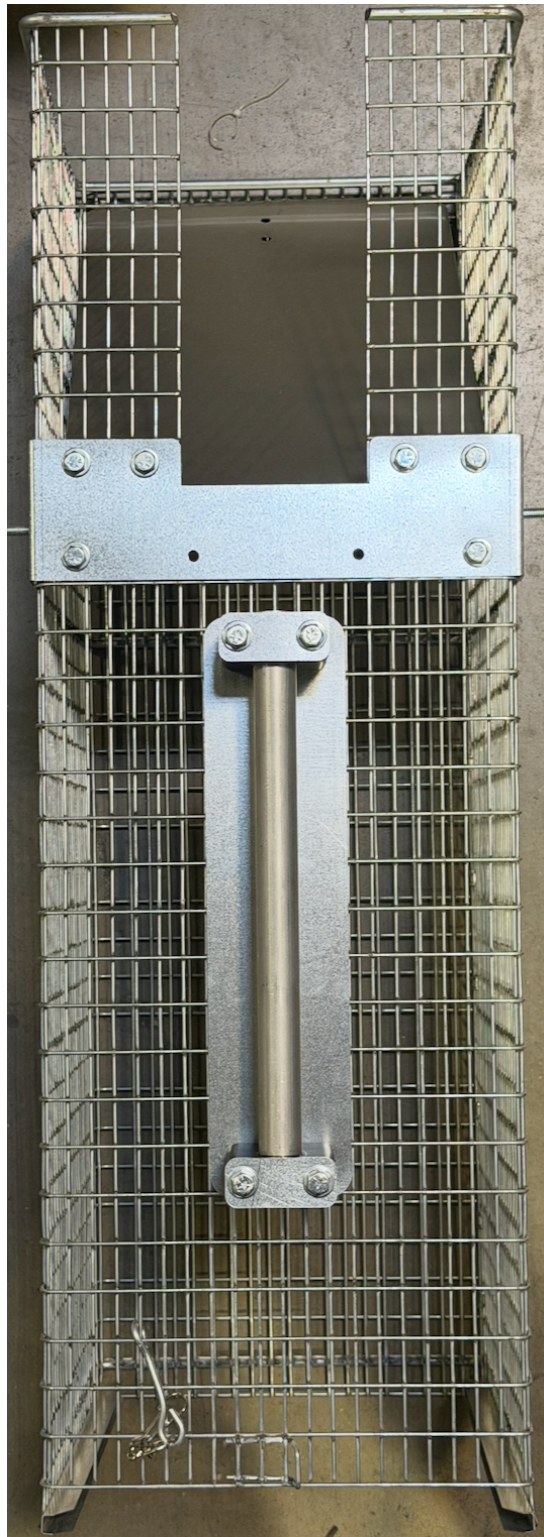
Quantity	Part
4	3" bolt
1	Handle Guard
1	Tube
4	Washers
2	Top Handle Metal Bracket
2	Upper tube plastic spacer
2	Lower tube Plastic Handle Spacer
2	Internal Trap Bracket with Press-Fit Nut
1	Nut Driver



Step 2: Screw in handle

1. Center the handle guard on the trap.
2. Insert the two top handle pieces into the holes in the handle guard.
3. Slide the tube between the two handle guards and ensure it is centered.
4. Place the bracket (with the press-fit nut) inside the trap and hand-tighten the bolts.

Do not fully tighten the bolts until the motor connector is fully through the tube



Top View



Inside trap view

Section 3: POD



Step 1: Mount the POD

1. Slide the POD down the rails on the trap until it is in place.
2. Attach the clip at the top to keep the POD in place.



Step 2: Connect the Wire to the POD

1. Attach the motor's wire to the POD using the locking screw connector, ensuring a secure connection.
2. Use the top latch to secure the POD in place.

Fully tighten all the bolts (including the handle bolts you hand-tightened earlier). At this point, your hardware setup is complete.

If you have issues, see [Common Issues](#).



The OcuTrap hardware now set up!

Next: add the trap to your account — [Adding a trap to your account](#). To learn what each part of the trap does, see [Hardware Features](#).

Video Assembly

Unpack the Components

Welcome to the OcuTrap assembly guide! In this guide, we'll walk you through each step of building your OcuTrap to ensure a smooth and successful setup.

Before we begin, make sure you have all the necessary components:

- The OcuTrap Cage
- The POD
- A fully charged battery
- The Motor

Take a moment to confirm you have all these parts.

Prepare the Battery

Ensure the battery is fully charged. A full charge takes about 5–6 hours (see [Battery Overview](#)), so it's best to charge it ahead of time if you haven't done so already.

► **This page has a video.** Watch it online at docs.ocutrap.com.

Section 1: Door Assembly

Step 1:

For the motor assembly, gather these components:

- The bracket (top locking mechanism)
- Black spacers
- Black capped nuts
- Nut driver + nut assembly tool
- The metal door

Instructions:

1. Thread the rod through the metal door.
2. On each end of the rod, add a spacer and secure it with a capped nut.
Tighten with the nut driver and assembly tool until snug.

Hardware note: The video above shows an earlier door-rod revision with white washers and springs. Current OcuTrap R1 units ship with **black spacers and black capped nuts** instead — follow the written steps here and in [Hardware Set Up](#), which match the parts in your box.

► **This page has a video.** Watch it online at docs.ocutrap.com.

Step 2: Attach the Motor to the Door

To attach the motor to the door, you'll need:

- Two pins
- Two clevises

Instructions:

1. Align the motor with the metal door attachments.
2. Secure it by inserting a pin at both the top and bottom.
3. Feed the cable through the metal handle.
4. Double-check that all components are securely fastened and that the door moves smoothly.

► **This page has a video.** Watch it online at docs.ocutrap.com.

Section 2 : POD Assembly

Step 1: Connect Battery

1. Mate the battery **XT30** connector to the trap (10,000 mAh packs use **female XT30** on the harness; 5,200 mAh packs use **male XT30**). The connectors should fit without force — see [Battery](#) if they do not mate.

Step 2: Connect the Wire to the POD

1. Connect the wire from the motor to the POD.
2. Make sure the connection is secure.
3. Then mount the pod to the trap

► **This page has a video.** Watch it online at docs.ocutrap.com.

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► **This page has a video.** Watch it online at docs.ocutrap.com.

Connect the wire to the POD, ensuring the connection is secure.

With this step, your hardware setup is complete!

Section 3: Software Setup

1. Create an account on app.ocutrap.com.
2. Once your account is created, add your trap to it.

Instructions:

- Locate the POD for your OcuTrap and open it to find the serial number at the top of the device.
- Log in to your account at app.ocutrap.com.
- Navigate to the 'Account' section in the top-right corner of the dashboard, and click **Add Trap** at the bottom of the page.
- Enter the serial number.
- Follow the in-app prompts to enable your subscription.

Once complete, the app opens your new trap's **console page**, showing a **Waiting for first check-in** note that clears once the trap connects.

Conclusion

Congratulations! You've successfully assembled and set up your OcuTrap.

If you have any questions or need assistance, [contact our team](#).

Thank you for choosing OcuTrap, and happy trapping!

Deploying Your Trap in the Field

You've assembled your OcuTrap and added it to your account — this guide walks you through actually **setting it up on site**: where to place it, how to set your capture distance, and how to confirm everything works before you leave.

Before you start, make sure you've done:

- [Hardware Set Up](#) — trap assembled, POD attached, battery charged
 - [Adding a trap to your account](#) — trap paired and visible in the app
-

Where the camera and sensor are (why placement is what matters)

The **camera and the distance sensor both live inside the POD** — the module that attaches to the trap. They sit in a single fixed position, so **there's nothing to aim or point**. You don't adjust the sensor angle or the camera direction.

What this means for setup: getting a good result is about **where you place the whole trap** and **how you set the capture distance** — not about aiming anything. The steps below cover both.

1. Choose a good location***For the best captures***

- **Put bait behind the sensor**, near the back of the cage, so the animal has to walk through the detection zone to reach it.
- **Set the trap on level ground**. A level trap avoids nuisance tilt alerts once it's armed and helps the door operate cleanly.
- **Give it a stable base** so wind or a struggling animal won't shift it.

For the best connection

- **Avoid metal buildings and dense structures** that block cellular signal — poor signal also drains the battery faster.
- **Leave a clear view of the sky** where you can, so GPS can update your trap's location.

For more placement and battery tips, see [Tips and Tricks](#).

2. Set your capture distance

Capture distance is how far **inside** the trap an animal must be before the door closes. In the app you pick a preset from **6 in to 18 in** (default **8 in**).

- **8 in (default)** — a good starting point for most setups.
- **Smaller (6–7 in)** — the animal must be deeper in the cage before the door closes. Use this to **reduce false triggers** from rain, debris, or movement near the opening.
- **Larger (10 in and up)** — the animal can trigger from farther inside the cage.

Targeting smaller animals? The sensor's detection area is naturally a little wider the farther it is from the POD, so a larger capture distance can help a small animal fall within it. Because smaller animals are harder to detect reliably, **confirm your target actually triggers at your chosen distance using Scouting Mode (Step 4) before you rely on the trap.**

Full details on presets and the sensor error messages you might see: [Distance Limits, Sensor Alerts & Errors](#).

3. Power on and confirm the connection

1. Power on the trap.
2. Watch the status LED. A **breathing cyan** light means the trap is **connected to the cloud and ready**.
3. Check that the trap shows as online in the app.

If you don't see breathing cyan, give it a minute to connect, and check signal in the area. See the [LED Guide](#) for what each color means and [Connectivity & Coverage](#) if it won't connect.

4. Test it before you walk away

Never leave a trap deployed without confirming it fires:

1. **Arm the trap** from the app (see [Arm & Un-arm Button](#)).
2. **Wave your hand** slowly through the detection zone, at about the depth your target animal would reach.

3. **Confirm** the door closes and you receive a capture alert.
4. **Open the door and disarm**, then re-arm for real deployment.

Optional — validate with Scouting Mode. [Scouting Mode](#) watches for animals and sends alerts and photos **without closing the door**. It's the best way to confirm your placement and capture distance are actually catching your target — especially for smaller animals — before you commit to arming.

5. Before you leave — final checklist

- ☐ LED shows **breathing cyan** (connected)
 - ☐ Trap shows **online** in the app
 - ☐ Battery level is enough for how long you'll be away
 - ☐ Door opens and closes properly
 - ☐ Capture distance is set for your target
 - ☐ Bait is positioned **behind** the sensor
 - ☐ Trap is **level and stable**
 - ☐ Trap is **armed** (or in Scouting Mode)
-

After you deploy

- Turn on [Pre-Capture Notifications](#) to get an alert and photo when an animal approaches — useful for confirming your target is showing up.
 - When you get a capture, follow [Handling & Releasing a Captured Animal](#).
-

Related: [Hardware Set Up](#) · [Scouting Mode](#) · [Distance Limits, Sensor Alerts & Errors](#) · [Tips and Tricks](#)

Daily use

Day-to-day app controls, tips, and the feature guides you'll use after setup.

App

Tips and Tricks

Handling & Releasing a Captured Animal

Door & Capture Features

App

Creating an account

<https://app.ocutrap.com>

Mobile app

Apple Devices



Android Devices



Adding a trap to your account

You add ("activate") a trap from the OcuTrap app at app.ocutrap.com or in the mobile app. Have the trap with you so you can read its ID labels, and make sure your email is verified first — until it is, the **Activate** button is disabled and explains why (use **Resend verification email** if needed). If you leave the wizard to verify your email, your progress is saved, so you can pick up where you left off.

What you'll need

The app asks for two identifiers:

- **Trap ID** — the human-readable label on the sticker on your trap (for example OCT-002841).

- **Device ID** — the cellular module's ID. Find it on the device sticker inside the POD (on mobile the helper text reads "printed on the cellular module inside your trap").

Support may ask for either — they refer to the same device.

Activate a trap (web)

1. Sign in at app.ocutrap.com.
2. Open **Add trap** to start the add-trap wizard. It has four steps: **Identify**, **Cellular plan**, **Site & location**, **Confirm**.
3. **Identify** — enter your **Trap ID** and **Device ID**.
4. **Cellular plan** — choose **Monthly** or **Annual**.
5. **Site & location** — give the trap a name and set its location.
6. **Confirm** — review the summary and tap **Activate trap**.
7. When activation completes, the app opens the new trap's page and shows an amber **Start your free trial** callout. Your **30-day free trial** begins when you set up billing at checkout — **not** at activation — so open the trap's **Billing** page from that callout to start it. Until the device connects for the first time, a **Waiting for first check-in** note appears on the trap page; it clears automatically once the trap checks in, usually within a few minutes.

Activate a trap (mobile)

1. Open the OcuTrap mobile app and sign in.
2. Tap **Add trap**.
3. Enter a **Name** and the **Device ID**, and optionally a location.
4. Tap **Create Trap**. Set up billing afterward from the trap's Billing screen — your 30-day free trial starts when you set up billing at checkout, not at activation.

Using the Mobile App

The OcuTrap mobile app gives you the same control as the web dashboard — manage traps, view captures, control the door, adjust settings, and see trap locations — from your phone. It's also how you receive **push notifications** the moment something happens.

Download the App

- **iPhone / iPad (iOS):** [Download on the App Store](#)
 - **Android:** [Get it on Google Play](#)
-

Sign In

The mobile app uses the **same account** as the web app:

- If you already have an account, sign in with your existing email and password.
 - New to OcuTrap? Create an account at app.ocutrap.com (or in the app), then see [Adding a Trap to Your Account](#).
-

What You Can Do

The mobile app has the **same features as the web dashboard**. From the app you can:

- View live trap status and **capture images**.
 - **Open, close, arm, and unarm** traps remotely.
 - Adjust [Trap Settings](#) and [Notification Settings](#).
 - See trap locations on the map.
-

Turn On Push Notifications

Push notifications are the fastest way to know about a capture. Two things need to be on:

1. **In the app:** open **Notification Settings** and turn on **Push Notifications**, then enable the **Alert Types** you care about (Target detected, Animal captured, Capture reminders, Low battery, Device alerts). See [Notification Settings](#).
2. **On your phone:** allow notifications for the OcuTrap app.
 - **iOS:** Settings → Notifications → OcuTrap → Allow Notifications.
 - **Android:** Settings → Apps → OcuTrap → Notifications.

If you're set up for push but not receiving alerts, the phone-level permission in the step above is the most common thing to check. If that looks right and alerts still don't arrive, try [Resetting the Mobile App](#).

See also

- [Notification Settings](#)
- [Adding a Trap to Your Account](#)
- [Resetting the Mobile App](#) — force quit or reinstall on iOS and Android
- [App](#) — overview of the OcuTrap app.

Open/Closed Button

Make sure you are logged in to your account and on the Traps page.

Open/Closed Button

- **Functionality:** Allows controlling the trap's door.
- **Open:** Lifts the door for resetting or letting animals exit.
- **Close:** Shuts and locks the door preventing escape or for safe transportation.
- **Subtext:** Shows the latest reported door state.

Releasing a captured animal: tap **Open**. This releases the door and returns the trap to **Unarmed** in one step. The trap never auto-releases — see [After a Capture](#).

Before Scouting Mode: the door must be fully open. See [Scouting Mode](#) for how scouting works without closing the door.

Arm / Unarm Button

Make sure you are logged in to your account and on the Traps page.

You set the trap's mode — **Off**, **Scout**, or **Armed** — from the **arm-mode dropdown** at the top of the trap's **Controls** card. The dropdown lists what each mode does, so the difference is clear before you choose. Picking the mode the trap is already in does nothing.

You can also arm and unarm at the trap itself, using the User and Power buttons on the POD. That works even when the trap has no cellular signal. See [Using the Buttons on the Trap](#).

Armed State

- **Purpose:** The trap is set to capture an animal.
- **Safety Requirement:** The user must manually open the door to activate this state. This ensures safety during the arming process.
- **Behavior:** Once armed and the door is confirmed open, the trap enters a low-power mode, conserving energy while remaining active for an animal to enter.
- **Notifications:** The trap sends periodic updates while armed. It may also use a low-power check-in cycle (about every **20 minutes**) and can appear briefly offline between check-ins — this is normal. You will receive an alert if the trap stays disconnected for more than an hour.

Scouting State

- **Purpose:** The trap watches activity without closing the door.
- **Safety Requirement:** The door must already be fully open before Scouting Mode can be enabled.
- **Behavior:** Scouting detects animals like Armed mode, but the door stays open.
- **Notifications:** You can receive a Scout Alert when an animal first enters the pre-capture area and a Scout Trigger if it reaches the normal trigger distance. Each alert type can send once every 5 minutes. Photos may still continue during that window.

For full details, see the [Scouting Mode](#) page.

Unarmed State

- **Purpose:** The trap is not set to capture and is in a standby mode.
- **Behavior:** In this state, the trap listens for commands and does not close the door automatically if motion is detected.
- **Transition:** After a verified capture, the trap moves to **Captured** state — door closed and locked — and stays there until you tap **Open door** (which releases the door and returns to Unarmed) or **Disarm** / set the mode to **Off** (which returns to Unarmed but leaves the door closed). See [After a Capture](#) for the full guarantee.

Scouting Mode

Scouting Mode lets you watch what visits your trap without catching it. The trap detects animals and sends photos, but the door stays open.

Use Scouting Mode when you want to:

- Confirm which animals are visiting before you arm the trap.
- Check activity around a new trap location.
- Watch behavior without closing the door.

Before you start

Scouting can only start when the trap is **Open / Unarmed**. If the door is closed, tap **Open** first and wait for the trap status to update.

The trap also checks for an obstruction before scouting begins. If something is already in the capture area, clear it and try again.

Scouting vs. Armed

	Armed	Scouting
Detects animals	Yes	Yes
Sends alerts	Yes, if enabled	Activity feed only — no notifications
Takes photos	Yes	Yes
Closes the door	Yes, after a detection	No
Best for	Capturing an animal	Observing activity

While in Scouting Mode, the door does not close automatically. The only controls that move the door are **Open** and **Close**. Switching from Scouting to **Arm** does not move the door immediately, but it does allow the trap to close on a future detection.

Start Scouting

1. Sign in at app.ocutrap.com or open the mobile app.
2. Find the trap you want to scout.
3. Make sure the trap status is **Open / Unarmed**.
4. Open the trap's detail page and find the **Controls** card.
5. Open the **arm-mode dropdown** (top of the Controls card — it shows the current mode) and choose **Scout**. Each choice lists what it does, so you can see the difference before you pick.
6. When the check passes, the trap status changes to **Scouting**.

If **Scout** does not start, the door may not be fully open, the trap may be offline, or the trap may not have checked in recently. Wait for the next check-in, then try again.

What to expect

- **Scout Alert:** Recorded in the trap's activity feed when an animal first enters the pre-capture area. Scout events are routine scouting data, not alerts — they do **not** send a push or email, do **not** appear in your Inbox, and do **not** add to the notification-bell count.
- **Scout Trigger:** Recorded in the trap's activity feed when the animal reaches the normal trigger distance. The trap takes a photo, but the door does not close. Like the Scout Alert, it stays in the activity feed only — no push, email, Inbox entry, or bell count.
- **Photos:** Fast photos about every 15 seconds while the animal is active. If it stays put, the spacing stretches to about every 4 minutes to protect battery; fresh movement brings it back to 15 seconds. The full-quality shot arrives at the Scout Trigger moment. (You may see a couple of quick frames right when it first enters, alongside the feed entries above.)

Repeat scout events from the same visit are throttled in the activity feed so it isn't flooded. New photos still arrive during that window; only the duplicate event entries are held back.

Stop Scouting

You can stop Scouting Mode in either of these ways:

- In the **Controls** card, set the arm mode to **Off** from the dropdown (or tap **Disarm**). The trap returns to Unarmed and the door stays open.
- Tap **Close door** in the **Controls** card. The door closes and the trap returns to Unarmed.

Use Armed mode instead when

- You are ready to capture a confirmed animal.
- You want the door to close after a detection.

For capture behavior after the door closes, see [After a Capture](#).

Troubleshooting

- **Obstruction error:** Clear the capture area, then tap **Scout** again.
- **Door-not-open error:** Tap **Open**, wait for the trap status to show **Open**, then tap **Scout** again.
- **Scouting activity showing up as notifications:** Scout triggers and alerts are recorded in the trap's activity feed only — they no longer send a push or email, appear in your Inbox, or add to the notification-bell count. If you still receive push or email notifications, or see Inbox entries, for scouting activity, please report it.

When Your Trap Takes Photos

Your OcuTrap takes photos automatically at different times depending on what mode it's in and what's happening at the trap. This page explains when to expect photos and roughly how often.

Photos only flow when the trap has cellular signal and enough battery. On low battery the trap pauses scheduled photos to protect runtime, and it never starts a new photo while the previous one is still uploading.

Quick reference

Situation	When photos are taken
Armed — animal approaching	A photo the moment an animal is detected, then more as it moves deeper in
Armed — animal lingering in range	Every 15 seconds at first, stretching to about every 4 minutes if it stays put
Scouting Mode	Fast photos about every 15 seconds while an animal is active, with the same stretch-out if it stays put
At capture	One photo when the door closes
After a capture	A short burst (~every 15 s for the first minute), then one every 2 hours
Time-lapse	Every 6 hours by default, in every mode (adjustable, or off)
On demand	Instantly, whenever you tap the camera button in the app

Approach photos (Armed Mode)

When the trap is **Armed** and an animal enters the detection area, the camera powers up and takes a first photo right away—even if the animal never comes closer. As the animal continues in, you'll get more:

- An initial **burst of up to two** quick photos.
- After that, a new approach photo each time the animal moves **about 3 inches (75 mm) closer**.
- If the animal stops and lingers, the trap still checks in with a photo **about every 10 minutes**.

Approach photos use a **fast, lower-resolution** setting so they arrive quickly during the action.

Presence photos (Armed or Scouting)

While an animal stays within the detection area without triggering a capture, the trap keeps sending photos. The two modes use different photo types:

- **Armed Mode:** a **full-quality** photo about every **15 seconds**.
- **Scouting Mode:** a **fast** photo about every **15 seconds**. Scouting saves the full-quality shot for the moment an animal reaches the trigger distance (the **Scout Trigger** photo).

If the animal stays put, the trap stretches the spacing to protect battery: after the first few photos the gap doubles each time, up to about **4 minutes**. Fresh movement toward the trap (about 3 inches) snaps it back to 15 seconds. In Scouting Mode photos are movement-based, so a parked animal or a fixed object like a branch will not generate an endless photo stream.

In **Scouting Mode**, this is how you watch what's visiting without closing the door. You'll also get a **Scout Alert** when an animal first enters and a **Scout Trigger** if it reaches the trigger distance. Repeat alerts from the same visit are throttled so your activity feed isn't flooded, but **photos keep coming** either way. The scouting photo interval is adjustable in settings (from 15 seconds up to 5 minutes, or off).

See [Scouting Mode](#) and [Pre-Capture Notification](#).

Capture and after-capture photos

- **At capture:** the trap takes one photo when the door closes.
- **After capture:** to document the catch, the trap takes a short burst (about every 15 seconds for the first minute), then settles into one **check-in photo every 2 hours** while the animal is held. See [After a Capture](#).

Time-lapse photos

Independent of animal activity, the trap takes periodic **time-lapse** photos in **every mode**: unarmed, armed, scouting, even while holding a catch. The default is **every 6 hours**. You can change the interval (up to 24 hours) or turn it off in [Settings](#).

On-demand photos

Any time, you can request a photo from the app—tap the **camera** button for a full-quality image or the **lightning-bolt** for a fast image. On-demand photos ignore all the timers above and capture right away. See [Requesting photos](#).

What affects the timing

A few things can stretch out the intervals above:

- **Low battery / power-saving:** scheduled photos pause until the trap is back on normal power.
- **Slow cellular or a photo backlog:** the trap automatically spaces photos out so uploads can catch up.
- **Detection range:** the trap only acts on animals within about **34 inches (875 mm)** of the sensor—anything farther out won't trigger a photo.

Need image quality, night-vision, or resolution settings instead? See the [Camera FAQ](#) and [Settings Reference](#).

After a Capture

Once an Armed trap closes on a verified detection, the trap holds the animal until **you** release it. There is no auto-release of any kind.

What does not happen

- The door does **not** reopen on a timer.
- The door does **not** reopen if the animal calms down or stops moving.
- The door does **not** reopen because of a cooldown or any sensor reading.
- The trap does **not** auto-disarm itself or change state on its own.

You can be 15 minutes away — or 15 hours away — and the trap will stay locked.

What you control

Two buttons matter after a capture:

Button	What it does
Open	Releases the door and returns the trap to Unarmed . This is the one you want most of the time — one tap, animal goes free, trap is reset for inspection.
Unarm	Returns the state to Unarmed but leaves the door closed . Use this if you want to keep the animal contained while you transport the trap, then tap Open later when you're ready to release.

On-trap buttons (v927+)

Buttons	From Captured	Result
User + Power (arm/disarm sequence)	Disarm in place	Unarmed , door unchanged (stays closed) — same as cloud Unarm
User hold-open (press User once, then press again and hold — door opens ~7 s later)	Release door	Door opens and trap returns to Unarmed — same as cloud Open . Use this to free the animal, not User+Power

Do not confuse the two: User+Power disarms without opening. To release an animal, use **Open** in the app or the **hold-open** button sequence on the trap.

For full step-by-step instructions on both sequences, see [Using the Buttons on the Trap](#).

What you'll see in the app while captured

- Trap card status reads **Captured / Closed**.
- You'll get repeat reminders for up to 48 hours so a captured animal isn't forgotten. They stop after 48 hours by design.
- Manual **Request Image** still works if you want a fresh photo of the captured animal.

Common questions

Q: If I'm out of cell range, will the trap eventually open? No. The trap holds locally — no cloud command, no door movement.

Q: If the battery dies while captured, does the door open? No. The latch is mechanical; loss of power does not release it.

Q: Can I close a trap that's already in Captured state? The door is already closed. Tapping **Close** while in Captured is a no-op (it stays Captured).

Q: How do I get the trap ready for the next capture? After tapping **Open**, the trap is in **Unarmed / Open**. Tap **Arm** on the trap card to put it back into Armed mode for the next capture.

See also

- [Arm & Un-arm Button](#) — how the modes relate.
- [Open & Closed Button](#) — door commands.
- [Scouting Mode](#) — non-trapping observation mode.

Settings in the App

The screenshot shows a settings modal titled "Manage: 6255671" with a close button (X) in the top right. Below the title is a section "Change Trap Name" with a text input field containing the placeholder "Type trap notes here.". A horizontal separator line follows. Below this is the "Notifications" section, which contains three rows: "Error", "Alert", and "Capture", each with a dropdown menu currently set to "Push-notification". Another horizontal separator line follows. Below this are two more settings: "Trigger Distance" with a dropdown set to "9 in" and the subtitle "Set trigger distance", and "Image Size" with a dropdown set to "Medium" and the subtitle "Change image size". At the bottom left is a button labeled "Device info" with an information icon (i), and at the bottom right is a link labeled "More Settings".

Trap settings control how each trap detects, captures, and alerts — including your **capture distance**, **notification preferences**, and **camera behavior**. Open a trap and tap **Settings** to adjust them; tap **More Settings** for the full list.

Name, Notes, and map location

Trap identity lives on the **trap detail** screen (top bar), not under Settings:

- **Name** — what the trap is called in your lists and alerts. Tap the name to edit (owner/manager).
- **Notes** — one free-form field for site detail (access directions, gate code, customer, etc.). Tap **Notes** in the top bar to edit. There is no separate “location note.”
- **Map location** — the site line under the name reflects the trap’s map fix (GPS or a location you set manually). Use **Set location** to place a pin or enter an address; that stamps a manual map position. It does not replace Notes.

Everyone you share the trap with can both read **and edit** name and notes — sharing has no view-only level, so every shared user is a manager. Leave out anything you would not want a shared user to see or change.

Where to go from here:

[Settings Reference](#)

[More Settings Overview](#)

[Advanced Settings](#)

Settings Reference

This page provides a complete reference of all configurable settings on your OcuTrap, including their ranges, defaults, and descriptions.

Note: After changing settings, a reboot of the trap is recommended to ensure all changes are applied correctly.

Capture & Detection Settings

Setting	Range	Default	Description
Capture Distance	6–18 in (app presets)	8 in	How far inside the trap an animal must be before the door closes.
Pre-Capture Alerts	On/Off	On	Sends an alert when an animal enters the detection zone (before capture). Includes a 2-minute cooldown between alerts.

Detection Zones Explained

OcuTrap uses two steps to verify captures and reduce false triggers:

- **Detection area** (out to ~34 in / 875 mm from the sensor) — The animal is approaching; you may get a pre-capture alert
- **Capture zone** (your set distance, default ~8 in) — The door closes when the animal reaches this point

This two-step check prevents false triggers from rain, debris, or quick movements.

Camera Settings

Setting	Range	Default	Description
Camera Time Lapse	0–24 hours	6 hours	How often the camera takes periodic photos while armed. Set to 0 to disable timelapse.
Camera Quality	1–6	2	Image resolution size (1=QVGA smallest, 6=UXGA largest). Higher = better quality but more data/power.
Rotate Image	0°, 90°, 180°, 270°	0°	Rotates captured images. Useful if trap is mounted in non-standard orientation.
Dark Lux Threshold	1–100 lux	25 lux	Light level below which the environment is considered "dark" and IR lighting activates.
Minimum IR Brightness	0–100%	10%	Minimum infrared LED brightness in dark conditions.
Maximum IR Brightness	0–100%	100%	Maximum infrared LED brightness. Lower values reduce glare and save power.

Camera Quality Levels

Level	Resolution	Best For
1	QVGA (320×240)	Fastest transfer, lowest data usage
2	VGA (640×480)	Good balance of quality and speed (default)
3	SVGA (800×600)	Better detail
4	XGA (1024×768)	High detail
5	SXGA (1280×1024)	Very high detail
6	UXGA (1600×1200)	Maximum detail, highest data usage

Battery & Power Settings

Setting	Range	Default	Description
Battery Type	5200 mAh / 10000 mAh	Varies by region	Must match installed battery for accurate level estimation.
Battery Alerts	On/Off	On	Enables low battery notifications at 20% and 10% levels.
Power-Off Voltage	7.0–12.0V	9.6V	Voltage threshold below which the trap automatically hibernates.

Battery Alert Thresholds

Alert Level	Default Voltage	Description
20% Warning	10.4V	Low battery warning sent
10% Critical	~9.5V	Critical battery warning sent
Auto Power-Off	9.6V	Trap enters hibernation to protect battery
Reset Threshold	11.0V	Battery must reach this level to clear low-battery flags

Temperature Alert Settings

These alerts watch the **outdoor weather at the trap's location**, not the trap's own internal sensor. The trap's location can come from its GPS fix or from a location you set manually. See [Advanced settings](#).

Setting	Range	Default	Description
Temperature Alerts	On/Off	Off	Enables alerts when the outdoor temperature at the trap passes a limit below.
High Temperature Limit	Configurable	45°C (113°F)	Alert sent if the outdoor temperature rises above this.
Low Temperature Limit	Configurable	-10°C (14°F)	Alert sent if the outdoor temperature falls below this.
Temperature Alert Interval	1–24 hours	6 hours	Minimum time between repeat temperature alerts.

GPS & Location Settings

Setting	Range	Default	Description
Location (GPS)	On/Off	On	Enables periodic GPS location updates.
GPS Interval	Configurable	8 hours	How often the trap updates its GPS position. Longer intervals save battery.

GPS Behavior Details

- **First fix delay:** 5-minute initial delay after boot before first GPS acquisition
- **Acquisition timeout:** 3 minutes for first fix, 2 minutes for subsequent fixes
- **Fix requirements:** Minimum 5 satellites, 3D fix required for valid position
- **Automatic updates:** GPS automatically triggered on capture events

Accessory Port Settings

Setting	Range	Default	Description
Accessory	On/Off	Off	Enables the 12V accessory port for external devices.
Accessory Timing	0–30 seconds	—	Duration the accessory port remains powered when activated.

The 12V accessory port can power external devices like dispensers, pumps, or other add-on hardware.

Capture Alert Settings

Setting	Range	Default	Description
Capture Alerts Interval	0–48 hours	8 hours	Minimum time between capture alert notifications. Prevents repeated alerts for same capture.

Hardware & Feedback Settings

Setting	Options	Default	Description
Enhanced Door Closing	On/Off	On	Re-seats the door under the locking rod after every close, captures included. Improves the chance the door locks. Does not confirm it.
EDC Backoff (ms)	30 to 130 ms (10 ms steps)	50 ms	Advanced per-trap setting. Leave it at 50 ms if the door consistently finishes under the fixed bar. An incorrect value can prevent EDC recovery or leave the door effectively unlocked. If calibration is needed, use an empty trap and change one 10 ms step at a time. Needs firmware v2.3.2-1010+.
Actuator Inverse	On/Off	Off	Reverses the door motor drive direction. Turn On if your motor is going the wrong way and the door opens when it should close.
Units	Metric/ Imperial	Imperial	Display units for distance and temperature throughout the app.

Image Cropping Settings

These settings remove portions of the image before processing. Values are percentages of the image dimension.

Setting	Range	Default	Description
Left Crop	0–50%	0%	Removes left portion of image
Right Crop	0–50%	0%	Removes right portion of image
Top Crop	0–50%	0%	Removes top portion of image
Bottom Crop	0–50%	0%	Removes bottom portion of image

Settings Locations

Settings are accessible in different locations:

Location	Settings Available
App → Trap → Settings → More Settings	Most user settings
App → Trap → Settings → Advanced Settings	Temperature alerts, image cropping
App → Account	Notification preferences, units

Tips for Optimal Settings

For Maximum Battery Life

- Set GPS Interval to 8+ hours
- Use Camera Quality level 1–2
- Set Camera Time Lapse to 6+ hours or disable
- Reduce Maximum IR Brightness if images are overexposed

For Best Image Quality

- Use Camera Quality level 4–6
- Adjust Dark Lux Threshold based on your deployment (lower = earlier IR activation)
- Fine-tune IR brightness settings for your environment

For Fastest Response

- Keep GPS enabled for accurate location on captures
- Enable Pre-Capture Alerts to see animals approaching
- Use shorter Capture Alert Intervals if monitoring actively

More Settings Overview

Note: After changing any settings, a reboot of the trap is recommended to ensure all changes are applied correctly.

Battery Type

Selects the battery configuration installed in the trap. This setting is used to improve battery level estimation, charging behavior, and low battery alerts. Always match this setting to the actual battery installed.

Accessory

Enables or disables the accessory port on the trap. When enabled, the accessory port can power external devices such as dispensers or add-on hardware.

Accessory Timing

Controls how long the accessory port remains powered when activated. Shorter durations reduce power consumption, while longer durations may be required for certain accessories.

Enhanced Door Closing

Re-seats the door after every close, including closes on a capture. The door backs off slightly, then drives closed again to seat under the locking rod.

This improves the chance the door locks. It does not confirm the lock. Enabled by default. Turn it off only if support asks. See [Enhanced Door Closing](#).

EDC Backoff

Sets how long the door reverses during Enhanced Door Closing. A higher time reverses farther; a lower time reverses less. Options run from 30 to 130 ms in 10 ms steps. Default is 50 ms, and most traps calibrate between about 40 and 120 ms.

Advanced setting: Leave EDC Backoff at its **50 ms default** if the door consistently finishes underneath the locking bar. An incorrect value can prevent EDC recovery or reverse the door too far and leave it effectively unlocked. Adjust only while calibrating an empty trap.

Every trap door is slightly different, and a fully charged battery can move the motor faster. Both too little and too much reverse can leave the door on top of the fixed locking bar:

- Door does not retract enough to re-seat: raise the value by 10 ms.
- Door retracts so far that it begins to lift and lands on top of the bar again: lower the value by 10 ms.

Start at 40 ms and change one step at a time, testing with a fully charged battery. Pass only when repeated cycles finish underneath the bar every time. See [Enhanced Door Closing](#) for the complete calibration and optional recovery test.

Requires trap firmware v2.3.2-1010 or newer. Older firmware ignores this setting. Only applies while Enhanced Door Closing is On. If adjusting it does not fix the door, the mechanism needs physical inspection. Contact support.

Camera Time Lapse

Sets how often the camera captures periodic photos while the trap is armed. More frequent photos provide better visibility but increase power and data usage.

Camera Quality

Controls the image quality of photos taken by the trap camera. Higher quality images improve clarity but increase capture time, data usage, and power consumption.

Rotate Image

Adjusts the orientation of captured images. This is useful if the trap is mounted in a non-standard orientation.

Dark Lux Threshold

Defines the ambient light level at which the system considers the environment to be dark. This threshold is used to determine when infrared lighting should be activated.

Minimum IR Brightness

Sets the minimum brightness level for the infrared LEDs. This ensures a baseline level of illumination in dark environments.

Maximum IR Brightness

Sets the maximum brightness level for the infrared LEDs. Limiting the maximum brightness can help reduce glare, reflections, and power usage.

Battery Alerts

Enables or disables low battery alerts. When enabled, the system will notify users when the battery voltage drops below a defined threshold.

Pre-Capture Alerts

Enables or disables alerts that occur before a capture event. These alerts can provide early notification of activity near or inside the trap.

GPS Interval

Sets how often the trap updates its GPS location. Shorter intervals provide more frequent location updates but increase power consumption.

Location

Enables or disables periodic location logging. When enabled, the trap logs its location at regular intervals for tracking and history purposes.

Advanced Settings

Note: After changing any advanced settings, a reboot of the trap is recommended to ensure all changes are applied correctly.

Outdoor Temperature Alerts

Enables or disables alerts when the weather at the trap gets too hot or too cold.

These alerts use the **outdoor weather at the trap's location**, not a reading from the trap's own sensor.

The trap's location can come from either its **GPS fix** or a location you **set manually**. Only a trap that has neither, one that has never reported a location and never had one set, cannot check the weather. If that happens, set the location yourself and the checks begin at the next interval.

The selected interval determines how often the weather is checked.

Until the first check comes back, the card shows **Not checked yet** and no temperature. Checks run on a schedule rather than the moment you switch them on, so give it up to an hour to fill in.

Temperature Alert Thresholds

Defines the outdoor temperature limits that trigger alerts. These values use the selected unit system, shown as Imperial in the interface.

Above Upper Limit

Sets the maximum temperature. An alert is sent if the outdoor temperature at the trap rises above this value.

Below Lower Limit

Sets the minimum temperature. An alert is sent if the outdoor temperature at the trap falls below this value.

Capture Alerts

Controls notifications related to capture events.

Capture Alerts Interval

Defines the minimum amount of time between capture alerts. This helps prevent repeated notifications for the same capture event or ongoing activity.

Image Cropping

Adjusts how images are cropped before being processed or uploaded. Cropping can be used to remove unnecessary areas of the image, reduce file size, or focus on a specific region inside the trap.

Left Crop

Removes a portion of the image from the left side.

Right Crop

Removes a portion of the image from the right side.

Top Crop

Removes a portion of the image from the top.

Bottom Crop

Removes a portion of the image from the bottom.

Notification Settings

OcuTrap alerts come from your traps themselves (their firmware), and the app lets you choose **which events notify you** and **how they're delivered**. The web and mobile apps present these controls a little differently.

Web (Settings → Notifications)

On the web app, open **Settings** and find the **Notifications** section. You pick, for each event category, which channels deliver it:

Event categories

- **Captures** — confirmed catches from a trap.
- **Trap alerts** — battery, signal, offline, and tilt alerts.
- **Billing** — failed payments, renewals, and plan changes.
- **System updates** — firmware releases and planned maintenance.

Channels

- **Email** — sent to your account email address.
- **In-app** — shown in the app's **Inbox**. The **notification bell** in the app header shows your unread-inbox count (the same number as the Inbox); open it to read in-app notifications. Scout-mode triggers and alerts are the exception: they appear in the trap's activity feed, not the Inbox, so they never count toward the bell.
- **Push** — mobile only; configure push in the mobile app (the toggle is disabled on web).

Mobile (Notification Settings)

In the mobile app, open **Notification Settings**:

- **Notification Channels** — toggle **Push Notifications** and **Email Alerts**.
- **Alert Types** — toggle **Target detected**, **Animal captured**, **Capture reminders**, **Low battery**, and **Device alerts** (battery, signal, offline, and tilt — **not** Scout triggers or alerts, which are activity-feed-only).
- **Digest** — choose **Immediate**, **Daily Digest**, or **Weekly Digest**.

Push notifications also require phone-level permission for the OcuTrap app. See [Using the Mobile App](#). If permissions look correct and push still fails, try [Resetting the Mobile App](#).

Scout-mode triggers and alerts work differently from **Captures** and **Trap alerts**: they are recorded in the trap's activity feed only, and never send push or email, never appear in your Inbox, and never affect the notification-bell count. For how Scouting works and where to see photos while the door stays open, see [Scouting Mode](#).

Trap Control

Each trap's detail screen has a **Trap Controls** bar — a card that sets the trap's arm mode and sends commands to the device. (This replaces the older pop-up control panel.)

Arm mode

At the top of the controls is the **arm-mode selector**, a dropdown with three modes:

- **Unarmed** — the trap will not capture. It stays connected and responds to commands.
- **Scouting** — the trap takes photos and sends pre-capture alerts without closing the door. See [Scouting Mode](#).
- **Armed** — the trap is ready to capture. See [Arm & Un-arm Button](#).

Primary action

Below the arm mode is the main door control:

- **Open door / Close door** — moves the door. See [Open & Closed Button](#).
- When the trap is **Captured**, the primary action becomes **Disarm & release** (returns to Unarmed and opens the door) with a **Snooze** option for the capture reminders. See [After a Capture](#).

Quick actions

A row of quick actions handles the most common commands:

- **Request Image** — request a fresh photo from the camera. See [Requesting photos](#).
- **Location** — request an updated GPS location. See [GPS](#).
- **Buzz** — sound the trap's buzzer, handy for locating the trap or confirming it's responsive.

Advanced

Expand **Advanced** for less-common commands:

- **Data refresh** — ask the trap to take a fresh set of readings and send them in right now, instead of waiting for its next scheduled check-in. Use it when you want up-to-the-minute battery, signal, or temperature values. The trap has to be awake and in range to answer. On the mobile app this command is called **Status Check**.
- **Reboot** — restart the device. Asks you to confirm first.
- **Sleep** — put the trap into hibernation (sleeps until you press the power button or change the battery). Asks you to confirm first. See [Power Modes](#).

Command status

After you send a command, a status line under the controls shows its progress — **Sending...**, then confirmed or failed, and **Image incoming...** when you request a photo — so you can tell the trap received your command.

Checking data, network, and charts

Device and network details live outside the controls bar, on the trap detail screen:

- **Vitals** — battery, signal, temperature, and **Last heard**. Select **Last heard** to **Ping** the trap (ask it to check in right now). When the trap answers, **Last heard** updates to show that check-in.
- **Charts** — graphical history of the trap's performance over time. Pick a reading (battery, signal, and more) and a time range. A trap builds this history as it checks in, so a newly added trap has little to show at first and fills in over the following days.

Logs

Every trap keeps a running history of what it has done, so you can troubleshoot, monitor performance, and see exactly what happened and when. In the app this history is the trap's **Activity** feed.

Where to find it

Open a trap and select the **Activity** tab on the trap detail page. Entries are grouped by day, newest first, and each row shows an icon, a short label, an optional detail message, and a timestamp.

To review activity across all of your traps at once, use the account-level **Activity** page, which combines events from every trap you own or manage.

Filtering the feed

A row of chips at the top of the Activity tab lets you narrow the feed:

- **All** — every event
- **Images** — new captures and photos
- **Alerts** — pre-capture, temperature, battery, and device alerts
- **Heartbeats** — connectivity and check-in events (online/offline, cellular)
- **Commands** — remote commands you sent and their results
- **Settings** — settings changes

What gets recorded

The Activity feed records the events that matter for operating and troubleshooting a trap, including:

- **Captures** — a new capture/detection, with its photo.
- **Remote commands** — commands sent from the app (open/close door, set arm mode, disarm & release, request image, request location, buzzer, reboot, sleep/hibernate), along with whether each command was confirmed or failed.
- **Arm-mode and settings changes** — when the trap is switched between **Unarmed**, **Scouting**, and **Armed**, and when device settings are changed.
- **Alerts** — pre-capture alerts, low-battery warnings, and high/low temperature alerts.
- **Connectivity** — when the trap goes online or offline and cellular connect/disconnect events.
- **Sharing** — when a trap is shared, a share is removed, or an invite is accepted.
- **Subscription and billing** — subscription and payment events, and ownership or billing transfers.

Errors and device faults appear in the feed as alerts (shown with a red indicator) so they're easy to spot. If you contact support, the Activity feed is a good place to note the last events and their timestamps.

Deleting an Image

To delete the **current image**, use the **trash icon in the bottom-right corner** of the live image on the trap's detail screen. The steps below cover deleting older images from the gallery.

1. **Open the image gallery**
 - From the trap dashboard, scroll to the image gallery below the live image.
 - Use the left and right arrows to navigate between images if needed.
2. **Select the image to delete**
 - Click or tap on the image thumbnail you want to remove.

- The image will open in a popup with the image view.

3. Click the delete icon

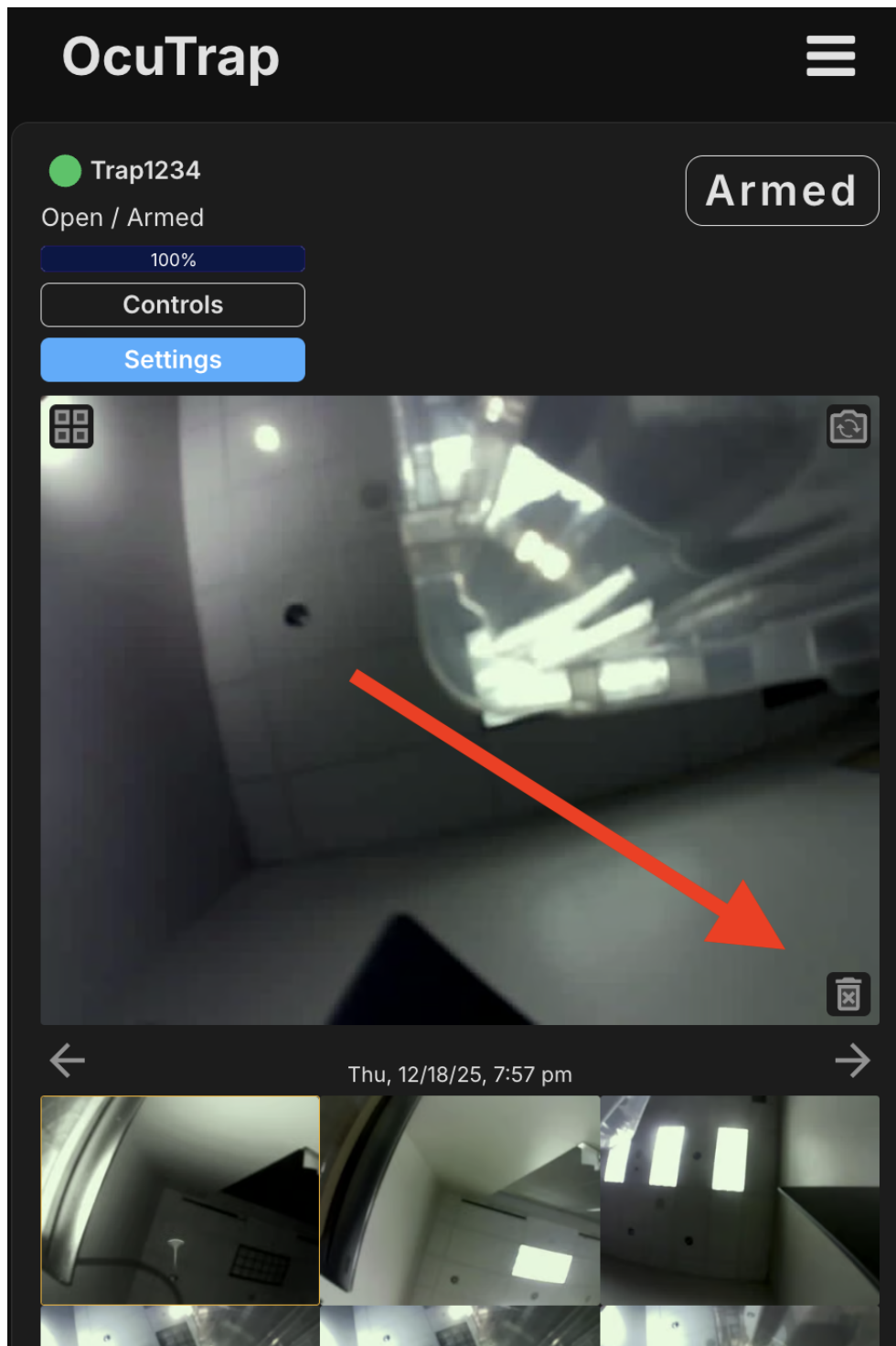
- In the bottom right corner of the image view, click the trash can icon.
- This will open a confirmation dialog.

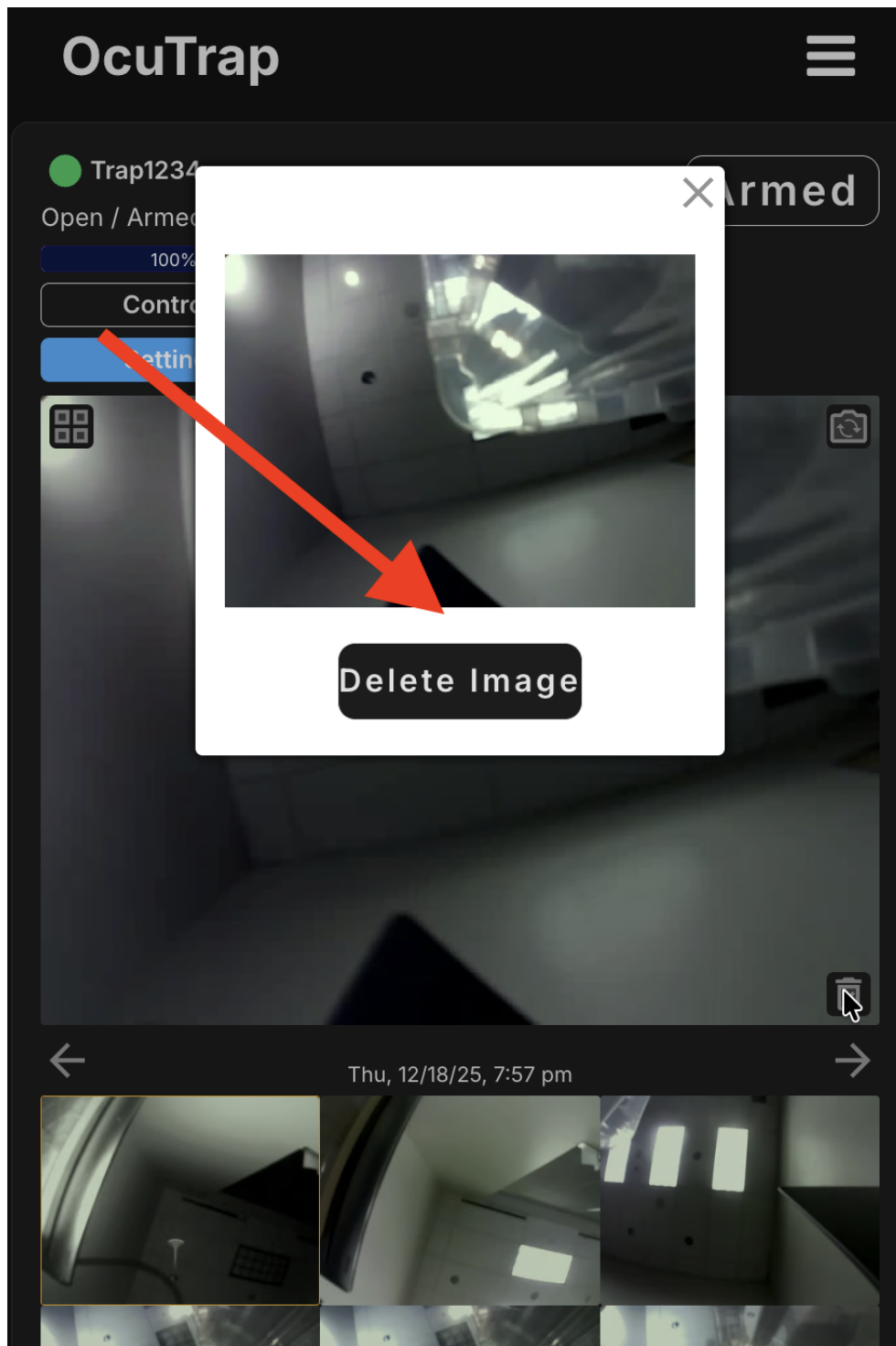
4. Confirm deletion

- In the confirmation window, click **Delete Image**.
- The image will be permanently removed from the trap record.

Important Notes

- Image deletion is **permanent** and cannot be undone.
- Deleting an image does not affect trap operation, settings, or status.
- If you do not see the delete icon, ensure you have the correct permissions and that the image has fully loaded.





Troubleshooting

- **Delete button does not appear**
 - Refresh the page and reopen the image.
 - Verify your internet connection.

- **Image does not disappear after deletion**

- Refresh the gallery view.
- Allow a few seconds for the change to sync.

For additional help, refer to the general Images and Gallery documentation or contact OcuTrap support.

Other app information

Connectivity and Reporting

- **Regular Updates:** The trap pings several times an hour to report its status and confirm network connection.
- **Disconnection Alert:** Users are alerted if the trap loses network connectivity for over an hour.

User Interface

- **Indicator:** The trap's status is communicated through its armed/unarmed state indicator.
- **Command Listening:** In the unarmed state, the trap awaits user commands for further operations.

This concise guide helps users understand the operational modes of the OcuTrap, ensuring efficient and safe usage.

Refreshing data

To pull the latest data, select **Last heard** on the trap's vitals and **Ping** the trap — it will check in right away if it's connected.

Trap controls

Commands are sent from the **Trap Controls** bar on the trap detail screen — arm mode (Unarmed / Scouting / Armed), open/close door, request image, location, buzz, and (under Advanced) reboot and sleep. Battery, signal, temperature, last-heard, camera, and map are all shown on the same trap detail screen. See [Trap Control](#) for the full rundown.

Sharing

Share a trap from its **Sharing** tab: enter the email of the person you want to share with, and (if you're the owner) choose their manager level. You cannot share with yourself or double-share the same trap. Once they accept the emailed invite, the trap appears in their account. See [Sharing Traps](#) and [User Levels](#) for details.

Changing trap name and notes

On the trap detail screen, tap the **name** in the top bar to rename the trap. Tap **Notes** in the same top bar for the single free-form notes field (access directions, gate codes, etc.). Map position is separate — use **Set location** for a pin or address; that is not a text “location note.”

Using the Buttons on the Trap

The trap has two buttons on the POD: the **Power button** on the left and the **User button** on the right.

Everything on this page works with the buttons alone. No app. No cell signal. Use it when you are standing at the trap and need to arm it, unarm it, open the door, or shut it down.

Every button action on this page works even when the trap has no cellular signal. The trap updates the app the next time it connects.

Check the trap's status

Press the **User button** once. You get a short beep, and the LED shows the trap's state for about 5 seconds.

LED	State
Magenta	Captured
Yellow	Armed
Alternating yellow and blue	Scouting
Blue	Unarmed, door open
Green	Unarmed, door closed

Press again to keep the display up longer.

Every color and blink pattern is in the [LED Guide](#).

Open or close the door

1. Press the **User button** once. The status color shows.
2. Within 5 seconds, press the **User button** again and keep holding it.
3. After a moment the LED starts blinking the color of what will happen. Blue means the door will open. Green means the door will close.
4. Keep holding about 5 seconds, until the LED goes solid. Then release.
5. The trap beeps rapidly for 2 seconds as a warning, then the door moves.

To cancel, let go while the LED is still blinking.

Keep hands and fingers out of the door opening once the rapid beeps start. The beeps mean the door is about to move.

Arm the trap

The door must be fully open before the trap will arm. Open it first, with the **Open** button in the app or with the hold sequence above.

1. Press the **User button** once.
2. Within 5 seconds, press the **Power button** once.

3. The LED blinks yellow while the trap checks that the capture zone is clear.
This takes a few seconds.
4. One long high beep and a solid yellow LED confirm the trap is armed.

If the trap refuses to arm

- **Door not fully open.** The LED pulses green and red a few times. Open the door fully and try again.
- **Something in the capture zone.** The LED pulses red a few times. Clear the area in front of the sensor and try again.
- **A sensor fault.** The LED pulses red a few times. Power the trap off and back on, then try again.
- **A firmware update is in progress.** The LED pulses red. Wait a minute and try again.

Scouting mode cannot be started from the buttons. Start it in the app. See [Scouting Mode](#).

Unarm the trap

Same sequence as arming. Press the **User button** once, then press the **Power button** once. The LED blinks white, then goes solid white, with one long high beep.

This works while the trap is armed, while it is scouting, and after a capture.

After a capture, User then Power unarms the trap but leaves the door closed, so the animal stays contained. To open the door and release the animal, use the open sequence above. Details: [After a Capture](#).

Pressing either button on a captured trap also acknowledges the capture and quiets the capture reminder notifications.

Power off and on

Hold the **Power button** about 3 seconds. The LED flashes red while you hold, then goes solid red with a descending beep, and the trap shuts down.

It stays off until you press the **Power button** again.

See [Power Modes](#) for what the trap is doing in each state.

No signal? The buttons still work

Arming, unarming, opening the door, closing the door, checking status, and powering off all happen on the trap itself. None of them need a connection.

An armed trap keeps watching for animals with or without signal. The app catches up the next time the trap checks in, about every 20 minutes while armed.

See [Connectivity & Coverage](#) and [Improving a Weak Cellular Signal](#).

See also

- [Arm & Un-arm Button](#): setting the mode from the app.
- [Open & Closed Button](#): door commands from the app.
- [After a Capture](#): what Open and Unarm each do once the trap is closed.
- [LED Guide](#): every color and blink pattern.
- [Handling & Releasing a Captured Animal](#): what to do in the field.
- [Improving a Weak Cellular Signal](#): getting a trap back online.

Tips and Tricks

Get the most out of your OcuTrap with these best practices and pro tips.

Powering Off the Trap

When you're not using the trap, **power it down properly**:

1. Hold the **power button for 3 seconds** until the device powers off
2. The trap will send a final status update before shutting down

3. This ensures a clean disconnection and protects the electronics

Proper shutdown prevents unnecessary battery drain and extends the trap's lifespan.

Maximizing Battery Life

Deployment Tips

- **Strong cellular signal** — Poor signal causes the trap to work harder to stay connected, draining battery faster
- **GPS interval** — Keep at 8 hours (default) or disable if you don't need location tracking
- **Camera timelapse** — Set to 6+ hours or disable if you only need capture photos
- **Firmware updates** — Keep updated for the latest battery optimizations

What Drains Battery Fastest

1. Poor cellular coverage (constant reconnection attempts)
 2. Frequent GPS updates
 3. Short camera timelapse intervals
 4. Cold temperatures (reduces battery capacity)
-

Optimal Trap Placement

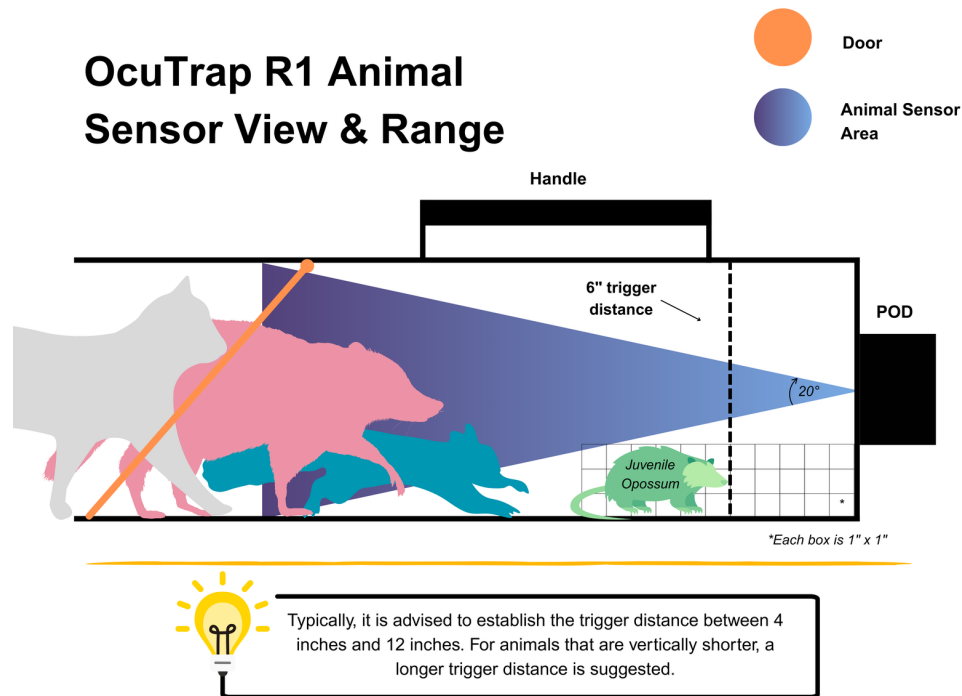
For Best Captures

- Set your **capture distance** so the animal is fully inside before the door closes — the sensor is fixed in the POD, so there's nothing to position (see [Deploying Your Trap in the Field](#))
- Place bait **behind the sensor**, near the back of the cage, so animals must pass through the detection zone
- Level ground helps prevent tilt alerts when armed

For Best Connectivity

- Avoid metal buildings or dense structures that block cellular signal
- Test signal strength before leaving the trap — check for cyan breathing LED
- Clear sky view improves GPS accuracy

Animal Sensor



How Detection Works

The **distance sensor** in the POD watches the inside of the trap for movement.

Detection Process

1. **Animal enters the detection area** (out to ~34 in / 875 mm from the sensor)
 - You may get a pre-capture alert
2. **Steady presence confirmed** — The trap waits for several consistent readings to avoid false triggers
3. **Animal reaches your capture distance** (default ~8 in) — The door closes
4. **Capture complete** — Photo taken and alert sent

Why This Matters

Unlike traditional traps that use a mechanical trip pan, OcuTrap uses a **distance sensor** to detect the animal's position. This method:

- Improves accuracy
 - Minimizes false triggers from rain, debris, or vibration
 - Allows remote monitoring without physical trigger mechanisms
-

Testing the Trap

This video shows how your OcuTrap works once it's set up and ready to catch animals.

► **This page has a video.** Watch it online at docs.ocutrap.com.

Test Before Deploying

1. **Arm the trap** using the app
 2. **Wave your hand** through the detection zone
 3. **Verify** the door closes and you receive an alert
 4. **Disarm** and reset for deployment
-

Trigger Settings

Capture Distance

- **Default:** ~8 inches
- **Adjustable range:** 6–18 inches (app presets)
- **Tip:** Smaller values = animal must be closer before triggering

Timing

- The sensor must register **continuous presence** before activating
- This timing **reduces false triggers** while ensuring the animal is fully enclosed

- Timing is automatic and cannot be manually adjusted
-

Reducing False Triggers

If you're getting unwanted captures:

1. **Decrease capture distance** — Requires the animal to be closer before the door closes (reduces false triggers from rain, debris, or distant movement)
2. **Check sensor window** — Clean any dirt, debris, or condensation
3. **Reposition the trap** — Avoid areas with blowing debris or heavy rain entry
4. **Review pre-capture photos** — See what's triggering the trap

The trap uses a **two-step check** to filter out most false triggers from rain and debris automatically.

Getting Better Images

In Daylight

- Images are automatically color
- Adjust **image rotation** if the camera view is upside down
- Use higher **camera quality** settings (3-6) for more detail

At Night

- IR LEDs activate automatically below the dark lux threshold
- If images are too dark: Lower the **dark lux threshold** or increase **minimum IR brightness**
- If images are washed out: Decrease **maximum IR brightness**

General Tips

- Keep the camera lens clean
 - Use **image cropping** to remove cage mesh from the frame if needed
 - Higher quality = larger files = longer transfer times
-

Using Pre-Capture Alerts

Enable **Pre-Capture Alerts** to get notified when an animal is approaching:

- Sends alert when object enters detection zone (before capture)
- Includes a photo of what's approaching
- 2-minute cooldown between alerts to prevent spam
- Great alongside [Scouting Mode](#) when you want photos and alerts without animal captures

Use cases:

- See if non-target animals are visiting
- Monitor animal behavior patterns
- Verify trap placement is attracting targets

Button Shortcuts

Learn the physical button controls:

Action	How To
View status	Single press User button (5 second display)
Open/close door	Press User button once, then press again and hold ~5 seconds (about 7 seconds total before the door moves)
Arm/disarm	Press User button, then Power button
Power off	Hold Power button for 3 seconds
Wake from hibernation	Press Power button

Full step-by-step instructions, including the LED and beep cues for each sequence, are in [Using the Buttons on the Trap](#).

Seasonal Considerations

Cold Weather

- Battery capacity decreases in cold temperatures
- Expect shorter runtime in winter
- Consider the 10,000 mAh battery for extended cold-weather deployments

Hot Weather

- Temperature alerts will notify you if the outdoor temperature at the trap exceeds 45°C (they watch the local weather, not the trap's internal sensor)
- Shade the trap if possible in extreme heat
- Electronics are rated to 45°C operating temperature

Wet Conditions

- The enclosure is weather-resistant but not waterproof
- Avoid submerging or prolonged heavy rain exposure
- Condensation on camera lens can occur — see [Condensation on the Camera](#)

Multi-Trap Management

If you're managing multiple traps:

- **Name your traps** clearly in the app for easy identification
- **Use the map view** to see all trap locations at once
- **Share traps** with team members using appropriate permission levels
- **Stagger GPS intervals** if deploying many traps to spread data usage

Before You Leave the Field

Checklist before leaving your trap:

- ☐ LED shows breathing cyan (connected)
- ☐ Battery level is sufficient for deployment length
- ☐ Door opens and closes properly
- ☐ Trap is armed (yellow LED)
- ☐ GPS location is updated
- ☐

- ☐ Bait is positioned behind sensor
- ☐ Trap is level and stable

Handling & Releasing a Captured Animal

When an Armed trap closes on a verified detection, **it holds the animal until you release it** — there is no auto-release. This page covers what *you* do next, in the field. For how the door and app behave after a capture, see [After a Capture](#).

The OcuTrap door closes in under half a second and can pinch or crush. A trapped animal may also be stressed and defensive. **Keep your hands, fingers, and face clear of the door's path at all times**, and keep children and pets away. See [Safety Information](#).

Before You Approach

1. **Check the app first.** Confirm the trap reads **Captured / Closed**, and tap **Request Image** for a fresh photo so you know what you've caught and its condition before walking up.
2. **Identify the animal.** OcuTrap targets animals in the **5–25 lb** range (e.g., cats, raccoons, opossums). Decide whether it's your **target** animal or a **non-target** capture — this changes what you do next (see below).
3. **Bring the right gear.** Thick gloves and, ideally, a towel or blanket to cover the trap.

Approaching Safely

- Move **calmly and quietly** — a startled animal thrashes and can injure itself.
 - **Cover the trap** with a towel or blanket. Reducing what the animal can see usually calms it noticeably.
 - Keep the trap **level and upright**; don't tilt, drop, or jostle it.
 - Stay **clear of the door's path** and never put fingers through the cage.
-

Releasing a Target Animal

Where and how you may release or relocate an animal is regulated and varies by location. Read [Responsible & Legal Use](#) **before** you release or relocate anything.

1. Position the trap at your release point with the **door end facing away** from you and toward open space.
2. Stand **behind or to the side** of the trap, clear of the door.
3. In the app, tap **Open** — this releases the door **and** returns the trap to **Unarmed**.
4. Let the animal **leave on its own**. Do not reach in or tip the trap to force it out.

Out of cellular range? You don't need the app. You can unarm the trap and open the door with the **User** and **Power** buttons on the POD. See [Using the Buttons on the Trap](#).

Transporting Before Release

If you need to move the trap before releasing (for example, to an approved relocation site), you don't need to change the trap's state — it can **stay in Captured mode**, with the door closed, while you transport it.

1. **Verify the door is fully closed and locked** before you lift the trap, so the animal cannot push it open in transit. For the most secure hold, see [Enhanced Door Closing](#).
2. Keep the trap **covered, level, well-ventilated, and out of direct sun and heat**.
3. Release **as soon as possible** — minimize the time the animal is confined.
4. At the release site, tap **Open** to release the door (this also returns the trap to **Unarmed**).

You can also tap **Unarm**, which keeps the door closed but returns the trap to Unarmed for the move. Either way, confirm the door is locked first. See [After a Capture](#) for how the Open and Unarm buttons differ.

Non-Target Captures

If you've caught an animal you didn't intend to (including someone's pet — note the 5–25 lb range overlaps with cats):

- **Release it promptly and unharmed at the capture site.** As a rule, non-target and protected species should be let go where they were caught, not relocated.
- If the animal appears injured or you're unsure how to proceed, contact your local wildlife authority or a licensed wildlife rehabilitator.
- See [Responsible & Legal Use](#) for rules on protected species and relocation.

After Release

- **Inspect and clean** the trap before redeploying — see [Maintenance](#).
- **Re-arm for the next capture:** after tapping **Open**, the trap is **Unarmed / Open**. Tap **Arm** on the trap card to put it back into service.
- OcuTrap sends **repeat capture reminders for up to 48 hours** so a captured animal is never forgotten. For the animal's welfare, respond as quickly as you can.

See also

- [After a Capture](#) — how the door and app behave once a trap closes.
- [Responsible & Legal Use](#) — local laws on trapping and relocation.
- [Safety Information](#) — injury risks and precautions.
- [Maintenance](#) — cleaning and inspection between captures.

Door & Capture Features

Deep dives on door closing, pre-capture alerts, and capture-distance / sensor behavior. For the full list of knobs in the app UI, see [Settings in the App](#).

Main Settings

On the main trap settings page, you can:

- **Set Notifications** – Choose how you want to receive alerts for errors, captures, and important events.
- **Adjust Capture Distance** – Set how far inside the trap an animal must be to trigger the door.
- **Change Image Size** – Select the photo resolution for captured images.

Trap **name** and **Notes** are edited from the trap detail top bar (not Settings). Map position uses **Set location** (pin or address).

Advanced / More Settings

By clicking **More Settings**, you can access advanced configuration options, including:

- **Battery Type** – Select which battery your trap uses (**5,200 mAh** or **10,000 mAh**). The app adjusts the low-battery alert thresholds to match your pack automatically.
- **Accessory Controls** – Enable or disable accessory ports and set their timing.
- **Enhanced Door Closing** – Improve lock reliability by enabling automatic door re-locking.
- **Pre-capture Notifications** – Get alerts and images when an animal nears the trap, before capture
- **Distance limits, sensor alerts & errors** – App preset table, 6 in expanded zone, dirty-sensor arm gate + 5 min retry
- **Camera Controls** – Set up time lapse, image quality, and night vision thresholds.
- **Sensor Settings** – Adjust capture distance and infrared brightness.

- **Temperature Alerts** – Turn temperature alerts on or off. (Battery alerts are always on, with thresholds set automatically from your **Battery Type** — there are no manual battery voltage or percentage controls.)

Each of these setting can be adjusted for each individual trap. All changes are applied when trap is connected. This will usually take about 1-5 minutes.

Enhanced Door Closing

Enhanced Door Closing (EDC) re-seats the trap door after every close, including closes on a capture. **EDC Backoff (ms)** controls how long the door reverses during that re-seat.

Why it exists

The locking bar is fixed. The door locks by rotating down and then sliding **under** the bar at the bottom of the trap. An obstruction can make the door come to rest **on top of** the bar instead. It looks shut from a distance, but it is not locked and an animal may be able to push it back open.

Enhanced Door Closing makes a second attempt after each close. The door backs off slightly, then drives closed again to seat under the bar.

What EDC Backoff changes

EDC Backoff is the duration of that brief reverse movement. A higher time reverses the door farther. A lower time reverses it less.

Timing	What happens	Result
Too short	The door does not retract far enough to reset its position.	The second close may still leave the door on top of the bar.
Correct	The door retracts far enough to drop flat, then slides forward again.	The door finishes underneath the locking bar.
Too long	The door travels beyond the needed sliding movement and begins to lift.	The second close may put the door back on top of the bar, effectively leaving it unlocked.

The app offers **30 to 130 ms** in 10 ms steps and defaults to **50 ms**. Most traps calibrate between about **40 and 120 ms**, but there is no single best value for every trap. Do not copy a value from another unit.

Advanced setting: EDC Backoff defaults to **50 ms**. If the door consistently finishes underneath the locking bar at 50 ms, **do not change it**. An incorrect value can prevent EDC from recovering after an obstruction or can reverse the door too far, leaving it on top of the bar and effectively unlocked. Adjust it only while calibrating an empty trap, one 10 ms step at a time.

Battery voltage changes motor speed. A fully charged battery makes the motor move faster; lower voltage makes it move more slowly. Always calibrate with a fully charged battery so you test the fastest normal movement and the greatest risk of reversing too far.

Enabled or disabled

- **Enabled (default):**

Every close is followed by a re-seat attempt.

- **Disabled:**

The door closes once. No re-seat. A capture is held by whatever that single close achieved.

Leave this on. Turn it off only if OcuTrap support asks you to. With it off, a trap that closes on an animal gets no second attempt to lock.

What it does not do

Enhanced Door Closing improves the chance the door locks. It does not check whether the door locked.

The trap has no sensor that can tell a locked door from a merely closed one. The app reports **Closed** for both. Enhanced Door Closing does not change that, and no setting will confirm the lock for you. Always inspect the door at the trap during calibration and whenever a capture matters.

Find the settings

1. Open the trap you want to update.
2. Go to **Settings**.

3. In the advanced layout, open **More Settings** → **Advanced Settings**, then find **Enhanced Door Closing Timing**. In the newer web and mobile layout, open the **Door** section.
4. Turn **Enhanced Door Closing** on and select **EDC Backoff (ms)**.
5. Save and allow the setting to sync to the trap.

EDC Backoff requires trap firmware **v2.3.2-1010 or newer**. Older firmware ignores it.

Calibrate EDC Backoff

Calibrate an **empty, unarmed trap** on a stable surface. Keep hands, fingers, clothing, and your body out of the door opening whenever the door can move.

1. Fully charge the battery and install it in the trap.
2. Confirm that the door, hinge, and locking area are clean, aligned, and moving freely. Timing cannot correct a damaged or binding mechanism.
3. Turn **Enhanced Door Closing** on.
4. Close the door using **Close** in the app or the physical-button door sequence. Inspect it at the trap and confirm it is underneath the locking bar before continuing.
5. Set **EDC Backoff (ms)** to **40 ms**, save, and wait for the setting to sync.
6. Run a complete Open and Close cycle in the app, or use the physical buttons. Watch for the brief reverse followed by the second close.
7. Inspect the door at the trap. A successful cycle ends with the door underneath the locking bar, not resting on top of it.
8. Repeat the cycle several times. If the door does not retract far enough to re-seat, increase the setting by **10 ms**, save, and test again.
9. Stop at the **lowest value that ends under the bar every time**. If the reverse begins lifting the door or the door travels too far, reduce the setting by 10 ms.

Observation	Adjustment
Door barely reverses and remains on top of the bar	Increase by 10 ms.
Door retracts, drops flat, and re-closes under the bar every time	Calibration passes. Keep this value.
Door reverses so far that it begins to lift, then lands on top of the bar	Decrease by 10 ms.

If you cannot get repeatable success within the usual **40 to 120 ms** window, stop adjusting the timing and contact OcuTrap support. The door mechanism may need inspection or alignment.

Optional recovery test

This test checks whether EDC can recover after an obstructed first close, similar to a door that met part of an animal before reaching the locked position.

Use caution. Test only with an empty, unarmed trap. Work from outside the cage with a long **wooden broom handle** and keep your hands and body clear. Do not use your hand, a screwdriver, or another conductive metal tool. Remove the handle before the EDC reverse begins. Stop immediately if the mechanism binds or the object becomes trapped.

1. First complete the normal calibration above.
2. Open the empty trap and position yourself outside the door's travel.
3. Start a Close cycle. During the first closing movement, briefly use the wooden handle to prevent the door from completing its normal slide under the bar.
4. As soon as the door reaches the top of the locking bar, remove the handle and stay clear. Do not obstruct the EDC re-seat.
5. Watch the automatic EDC reverse and second close, then inspect the final position.

Final position	Meaning	Next step
Door is underneath the bar	Pass. EDC recovered and re-locked the door.	Repeat to confirm consistent operation.
Door remains on top after only a small reverse	Backoff is probably too short.	Increase by 10 ms and re-test.
Door reverses too far, lifts, and lands on top again	Backoff is too long.	Decrease by 10 ms and re-test.

This test demonstrates recovery only. It does not add a lock sensor or make the app able to verify the final door position.

The setting syncs to the trap on its next check-in.

Note: Enhanced Door Closing is enabled by default on every trap. Leave it on unless OcuTrap support directs otherwise.

Pre-Capture Notification

What It Does

When enabled and the trap is in Armed Mode, Pre-Capture Notification alerts you when an animal is detected approaching the trigger point. This early warning system sends a notification and a photo (if applicable), helping you stay ahead of trap activity.

How It Works

OcuTrap uses a distance sensor to detect animals before they reach the capture point. It watches two areas:

- **Detection area (out to about 34 in / 875 mm from the sensor):** The trap tracks an approaching animal and may send a pre-capture alert with a photo.
- **Capture point (your capture-distance setting; default 8 in / 200 mm):** The door closes once the animal is confirmed at or inside this distance.

Default capture distance is 8 inches (200 mm), adjustable from **6–18 inches** in the app. Pre-capture alerts can fire while an animal is still approaching in the detection area, before the door closes.

Example

With the default **8 in (200 mm)** capture distance:

- As the animal approaches within the detection area (out to ~34 in), you may receive a **Pre-Capture Alert** with an approach photo.
- At **~8 in (200 mm) or closer**, the trap confirms capture and the door closes.

In the app, the notification shows as a **Pre-Capture Alert** — it lets you know an animal is approaching before a capture happens, and includes an approach photo when available. In Scouting Mode the same approach event shows as a **Scout Alert** instead. The distance the animal was detected at is recorded on the event details.

Units (inches or millimeters) depend on your trap's **Units** setting. For the full sensor model, see Technical Specifications.

How to Enable or Disable

This setting is configured per trap:

1. Open the OcuTrap app or app.ocutrap.com
2. Tap on the trap you want to edit
3. Go to **Settings** → **More Settings**
4. Find the **Pre-Capture Notification** option
5. Toggle to **On** or **Off**

Default setting: **On**

Why Use This Feature?

- See what's approaching your trap before it's too late
- Detect non-target animals early (like pets or skunks)
- Monitor animal behavior without needing a capture — or use Scouting Mode to watch activity without closing the door
- Improve trap placement and setup based on activity patterns

What you'll see (alert motion gate, firmware v906+)

Signal	When it fires
Pre-Capture Alert	After the animal shows real inward movement (~3 in / 75 mm) toward the trap — static grass or debris in the detection zone will not trigger the alert
Approach photos	On zone entry and during approach — not blocked by the motion gate that holds the alert
Door close	Only when the animal is confirmed in the capture zone (Armed mode)

Testing tip: Trap Test / demo mode is **not** the same as **Armed** mode. To verify pre-capture behavior, arm the trap normally with the door open and approach slowly. Scout mode uses the same motion gate for its alert; approach photos are not held by that gate.

Need to Turn It Off?

If you prefer to only be notified after a capture, you can disable **Pre-Capture Notification** in settings at any time. It will not affect the actual capture or release functions.

Distance Limits, Sensor Alerts & Errors

Quick reference for capture distance settings and arming errors you may see in the app.

Capture distance setting

Choose how far inside the trap an animal must be before the door closes. In the app, pick a preset from **6 in to 18 in**.

Preset	When to use it
8 in (default)	Good starting point for most setups
6–7 in	Animal must be closer — helps reduce false triggers from rain or debris
10 in and above	Animal can trigger from farther inside the cage

Smaller values mean the animal must be deeper in the trap before the door closes.

Sensor blocked or dirty

Warning — arms anyway

If the POD lens looks blocked or dirty when you arm, the trap **still arms** but sends a warning so you know to clean it:

- Arm: Trap armed. Check camera and clean sensor if blocked.
- Scout: Scout on. Check camera and clean sensor if blocked.

What to do: Clean the POD lens and clear anything in front of the sensor. The trap keeps working, but a dirty lens can affect detection, so clean it as soon as you can.

Real obstruction — arming blocked

Error: Remove object at <distance> first (for example, Remove object at 4.0 in first) — something is physically blocking the trap interior. Remove it and arm again.

Other arm errors

Message	Cause
Sensor blocked or dirty. Clean sensor window, then power-cycle.	Sensor can't see through the POD lens (usually condensation or grime) — clean the lens, power-cycle, then arm again
Sensor fault. Power-cycle the trap.	Sensor self-check failed — power-cycle the trap, and contact support if it persists. Firmware v1061 and earlier also shows this when the lens is blocked or dirty
Open the door first	Door is not fully open — open it all the way, then arm
Release animal first (open door)	Trap is in the captured state — open the door to release, then arm
Cannot disarm	A capture is triggering right now — wait a moment and try again

See [Common Issues — Trap Won't Arm](#).

Reference

Specs, connectivity, LEDs, and battery — look here when you need a number or a status light explained.

[Hardware Features](#)

[Technical Specifications](#)

[Connectivity & Coverage](#)

[LED Guide](#)

[Battery Overview](#)

Hardware Features

Overview of the OcuTrap R1 hardware components and capabilities.

Connectivity

The OcuTrap connects via **4G LTE cellular** networks, providing nationwide coverage without the need for Wi-Fi or local network setup. Simply power on and the trap connects automatically.

Camera

The integrated camera provides a clear view inside the trap with:

- **Automatic night vision** — IR LEDs activate in low-light conditions
 - **Adjustable image quality** — Choose from 6 resolution sizes
 - **Image rotation** — 0°, 90°, 180°, or 270° to match your trap orientation
 - **Timelapse photos** — Periodic images while armed (configurable interval)
-

Door

The door is powered by a **linear motor** for fast, reliable operation:

- **Close speed:** Less than 0.5 seconds
 - **Open speed:** Less than 1 second
 - **Remote control** — Open, close, and lock via the app
 - **Manual control** — Button sequence on the device; see [Using the Buttons on the Trap](#)
 - **Enhanced closing** — Optional double-close sequence for secure locking
-

Location

Track your trap location using the integrated **GPS module**:

- **Satellite positioning** — Displays number of satellites connected
 - **Battery-optimized** — Updates every 8 hours by default
 - **Map view** — See trap location on Map or Satellite view in the app
 - **Automatic updates** — GPS triggered on capture events
-

Sensors

OcuTrap includes multiple sensors for monitoring and capture detection:

Sensor	Function
Distance Sensor	Detects when an animal enters the trap
Temperature & Humidity	Monitors internal conditions, sends alerts if thresholds exceeded
Ambient Light	Detects darkness to activate night vision automatically
Accelerometer	Detects tilt and movement of the trap

Audio & Haptic Feedback

- **Buzzer** — Audible beeps for button feedback and status indication
 - **Vibration motor** — Haptic feedback for certain operations
-

Battery

Rechargeable **12V lithium-ion battery** for extended field deployment:

- **10,000 mAh (111 Wh)** — Standard for new traps; ~40+ days runtime per charge
 - **5,200 mAh (56 Wh)** — Canadian shipments (~21 days runtime)
 - **Battery Type setting** — Pick your pack in **Settings** → **Battery Type**; alert thresholds adjust automatically
 - **Low battery alerts** — Notifications at 20% and 10% levels
 - **Auto-hibernation** — Protects battery when voltage drops too low
-

Accessory Port

12V accessory port for powering external devices:

- Connect dispensers, pumps, or other add-on hardware
 - Configurable activation duration (0–30 seconds)
 - Enable/disable via app settings
-

Smart Detection

Advanced capture detection with false-trigger prevention:

- **Dual-zone verification** — Objects must pass through detection zone before triggering
 - **Rain/debris filtering** — Rejects oscillating readings from environmental interference
 - **Consecutive reading requirement** — Prevents single-reading false triggers
 - **Pre-capture alerts** — Optional notification when animals approach
-

Construction

- **Weather-resistant enclosure** — Built for outdoor field deployment

- **Dimensions:** 10" wide × 12" tall. Cage length is **32"** without the POD and with the door closed. The POD adds ~5"; with the door fully open, add ~4" more (~41" total length). See [Technical Specifications](#) for details.
- **Weight:** 24 lbs (10.9 kg)
- **Target animals:** 5–25 lbs (cats, raccoons, opossums)

For detailed specifications, see [Technical Specifications](#).

Technical Specifications

This page provides detailed technical specifications for the OcuTrap R1 smart wildlife trap.

Physical Specifications

Specification	Value
Width	10" (25.4 cm)
Height	12" (30.5 cm)
Length (cage only)	32" (81.3 cm) — trap body without the POD; door closed
POD (adds to length)	~5" (~12.7 cm)
Door open (adds to length)	~4" (~10.2 cm)
Approx. total length	~41" (~104 cm) with POD installed and door fully open
Weight	24 lbs (10.9 kg)
Construction	Weather-resistant enclosure, compatible with Tomahawk trap frames
Target Animals	5–25 lbs (cats, raccoons, opossums, similar wildlife)

Door Mechanism

Specification	Value
Actuator Type	Linear motor with DRV8873 motor controller
Close Speed	< 0.5 seconds
Open Speed	< 1 second
Door States	Opening, Closing, Fully Open, Fully Closed, Error, Forced Stopped
Control Methods	App remote control, physical button sequence

Battery & Power

Specification	Value
Battery Type	Rechargeable KBT 12V Lithium-ion (6-cell pack)
Standard Capacity	10,000 mAh (111 Wh) — new traps / US shipments
Canadian Variant	5,200 mAh (56 Wh) — Canadian shipments
Operating Voltage Range	7.0V – 15.0V
Low Battery Warning (20%)	~10.4V (internal, set by Battery Type)
Critical Battery Warning (10%)	~9.5V
Auto Power-Off Threshold	~9.6V (internal, set by Battery Type)
Runtime (10000 mAh)	~40+ days per charge (typical usage)
Runtime (5200 mAh)	~21 days per charge (typical usage)
Charger (10000 mAh)	2A @ 12V, ~5–6 hours full charge
Charger (5200 mAh)	1A @ 12V, ~5–6 hours full charge
Trap connector (5200 mAh)	Male XT30 on pack; female XT30 on trap PCB
Trap connector (10000 mAh)	Female XT30 on pack; male XT30 on trap PCB
Alternate pack / connector	Contact support for PCB + holder swap

Selecting your battery in the app: OcuTrap ships with either the **5,200 mAh (56 Wh)** or **10,000 mAh (111 Wh)** 12 V 6-cell pack. Tell the app which one your trap uses under **Settings** → **Battery Type** — it adjusts the low-battery alert thresholds and level readout to match. The setting defaults to the 5,200 mAh pack, so update it if your trap shipped with the 10,000 mAh battery. There are no manual voltage or percentage threshold controls; the app derives them from your Battery Type.

Connectivity

Specification	Value
Connection	4G LTE Cellular
Coverage	Multi-network cellular coverage
GPS Update Interval	Every 8 hours (default, battery-optimized)
GPS Accuracy	Minimum 5 satellites, 3D fix required

Sensors

Distance Sensor

Specification	Value
Sensor Range	Up to 13 ft (4 m) hardware capability
Active Detection Range	Up to ~34 in (875 mm) — the trap detects, alerts, and photographs only within this distance
Capture Distance	App presets 6–18 in ; default 8 in . See Distance Limits & Alerts

Environmental Sensors

Sensor	Function
Temperature & Humidity	Environmental monitoring, alerts
Ambient Light	Automatic day/night detection for camera
Accelerometer	Tilt detection, movement alerts

Temperature Thresholds

Alert	Default Value
High Temperature Alert	45°C (113°F)
Low Temperature Alert	-10°C (14°F)
Alert Interval	Every 8 hours (configurable 0–48 hours)

Camera System

Specification	Value
Night Vision	Integrated IR LED (automatic activation)
IR Brightness	0–100% (configurable min/max)
Image Sizes	QVGA to UXGA (6 selectable sizes)
Rotation Options	0°, 90°, 180°, 270°
Color Modes	Grayscale (dark conditions), Color (daylight)
Dark Detection Threshold	25 lux (default, configurable 1–100 lux)
Timelapse Interval	0–24 hours (default: 6 hours)

Capture Detection System

OcuTrap uses a two-step detection process to prevent false triggers from rain, debris, or non-target movement.

Detection Process

1. **Animal enters the detection area** (within ~34 in / 875 mm) → Steady readings required before proceeding
2. **Pre-capture alert sent** (if enabled)
3. **Animal reaches capture distance** (your preset, default ~8 in) → Door closes
4. **Capture photo taken and transmitted**

False Trigger Prevention

- **Steady-readings check** — Requires consistent presence before closing
 - **Rain and debris filtering** — Ignores splashy or erratic movement
 - **Dirty-sensor detection** — Blocks arming when the lens is obstructed
-

What's in the Box

- OcuTrap R1 Smart Cage Unit
 - 12V Lithium-ion Battery (10000 mAh US / 5200 mAh Canada)
 - Battery Charger (2A or 1A depending on battery)
 - Quick-Start Guide
 - Assembly hardware
-

Environmental Ratings

Specification	Value
Operating Temperature	-10°C to 45°C (14°F to 113°F)
Weather Resistance	Designed for outdoor field deployment
Recommended Placement	Areas with strong cellular signal for optimal battery life

Firmware & Software

Specification	Value
Updates	Over-the-air (OTA)
Mobile App	iOS and Android

Regulatory Information

For warranty, safety, and compliance information, see:

- [Safety Information](#)
- [Warranty Information](#)
- [Legal Disclaimers](#)

Connectivity & Cellular Coverage

OcuTrap connects to the OcuTrap app over **4G LTE cellular** — the same kind of network your phone uses. There is **no Wi-Fi and nothing to set up**: power the trap on and it connects automatically.

How OcuTrap Connects

- **Cellular only.** OcuTrap uses **multi-network 4G LTE** across the **United States and Canada**. It does **not** use Wi-Fi, and no local network setup is required.
- **Data included.** The cellular data your trap uses is **included in your OcuTrap subscription** — there's no separate data plan or SIM card to buy. See [Your OcuTrap Subscription](#).
- **Automatic.** On power-up, the trap finds a network and comes online on its own.
- **No hotspot or router needed.** You don't need any other equipment in the field.

The trap is not tied to a single carrier. It reaches **multiple nationwide 4G LTE networks** and picks whichever one has the best usable signal at your site, switching automatically if that network fails. If a trap sits in marginal coverage, work through [Improving a Weak Cellular Signal](#).

What Affects Coverage

Like any cellular device, OcuTrap needs a usable signal where it's deployed.

- **Available in the US and Canada.** OcuTrap's cellular service covers the **United States and Canada**. The trap is not supported in other countries.
- **Place it where there's signal.** Areas with **strong cellular signal** give you the most reliable connection *and* the best battery life — a weak signal makes the trap work harder to stay connected and drains the battery faster.
- **Obstacles matter.** Dense buildings, deep valleys, and very remote backcountry may have little or no coverage.
- **GPS is separate.** Location uses a built-in GPS module (clear view of the sky helps) and updates about every 8 hours. See [GPS](#).

For battery and signal tips on where to place a trap, see **Optimal Trap Placement** in [Tips and Tricks](#).

Staying Armed When Signal Is Weak

OcuTrap is built to keep working through brief connectivity gaps:

- In **Armed Sleep Offline** mode, the trap **stays armed and monitoring for captures even while disconnected**, checking in with the cloud about every **20 minutes**.
- If a **capture happens while offline**, the trap **reports it at its next check-in** — you won't lose the event.
- See [Power Modes](#) for how the trap balances connectivity and battery.

When a trap is in **Hibernation** (very low battery, long idle, or powered off), it **cannot send or receive anything**. See [Power Modes](#).

Checking Your Trap's Connection

- The app shows each trap's status and how long ago it last checked in.
 - If a trap won't come online, work through [Trap Offline](#) or [Won't Connect](#).
-

See also

- [Technical Specifications](#) — cellular, GPS, and sensor details.
- [Power Modes](#) — how the trap conserves battery and stays armed offline.
- [GPS](#) — location tracking and map view.
- [Trap Offline or Won't Connect](#) — troubleshooting connection issues.

LED Guide

The light on your OcuTrap tells you what the trap is doing. **Pick the color you see, then how it's behaving, and this guide takes you straight to what it means and how to fix it.** Prefer a table? The full reference is right below the diagnostic.

On **battery**, the light stays off between brief check-in flashes — roughly one quick flash every ~10 seconds is normal. On **external/USB power** (or for a few seconds after a command) the light stays on continuously.


```

### -----
### SINGLE SOURCE OF TRUTH for the interactive LED diagnostic wizard (SW-333 /
### SITE-10) AND the reference table rendered on this page. Edit entries here -
### the wizard and the table both update on the next deploy, with no code changes.
### # Each entry:
### color      a color id: blue | green | cyan | yellow | magenta | white | red |
### no-light    (drives the swatch shown in the wizard)
### pattern     solid | breathing | blinking | fast-blink | off
### meaning     what this color+pattern indicates
### action      (optional) what the customer should do
### context     (optional) short qualifier, e.g. "idle on power", "after a command"
### links       (optional) site-absolute paths into the relevant fix pages
### # The same color+pattern may carry more than one meaning (the LEDs reuse
### combinations) - just add multiple entries; the wizard lists them together.
### -----
entries:
  - color: cyan
    pattern: breathing
    context: idle on power
    meaning: Connected to the cloud and fully operational.
    action: Your trap is online - nothing to do.
  - color: cyan
    pattern: fast-blink
    meaning: Connecting to the cloud.
    action: Wait a few minutes while it connects.
    links:
      - label: Trap Offline or Won't Connect
        href: /troubleshooting/trap-offline-or-wont-connect
  - color: green
    pattern: solid
    meaning: Unarmed, with the door closed.
    action: Normal resting state when the trap is not armed and the door is closed.
  - color: green
    pattern: blinking
    context: idle on power
    meaning: Searching for a cellular signal (looking for internet).
    action: Move the trap outdoors or to an area with better cellular coverage, then give
it a few minutes to reconnect.
    links:
      - label: Trap Offline or Won't Connect
        href: /troubleshooting/trap-offline-or-wont-connect
      - label: Connectivity & Coverage
        href: /getting-started/connectivity-and-coverage
  - color: green
    pattern: blinking
    context: just after a command
    meaning: Closing the door after a manual close command.
    action: Normal for a few seconds - the light returns to its resting state once the
door finishes closing.

```

- color: blue
pattern: solid
meaning: Unarmed, with the door open.
action: Normal resting state when the trap is not armed and the door is open.
- color: blue
pattern: blinking
context: just after a command
meaning: Opening the door after a manual open command.
action: Normal for a few seconds while the door opens.
- color: blue
pattern: fast-blink
context: idle, not after a command
meaning: The trap is trying to join the cellular network and cannot. It keeps retrying and never reaches the cloud, so it stays offline in the app.
action: Move the trap outdoors or to an area with better cellular coverage and give it 10 minutes. If it is still blinking blue quickly, contact support with your Trap ID.
links:
 - label: Trap Offline or Won't Connect
href: /troubleshooting/trap-offline-or-wont-connect
 - label: Connectivity & Coverage
href: /getting-started/connectivity-and-coverage
 - label: Contact Support
href: /support/support
- color: yellow
pattern: solid
meaning: Armed and ready to capture.
action: The trap is watching the capture zone. Nothing to do.
- color: yellow
pattern: blinking
context: just after arming
meaning: Arming the trap – checking the capture zone.
action: Wait a few seconds. If it flashes solid red instead, arming was blocked – clear the obstruction or clean the sensor window and try again.
- color: magenta
pattern: solid
meaning: An animal has been captured.
action: Approach carefully and handle the captured animal safely.
links:
 - label: Handling a Captured Animal
href: /getting-started/handling-a-captured-animal
- color: magenta
pattern: blinking
meaning: Firmware update in progress, or booting in safe mode.
action: Leave the trap powered on and wait – do not disconnect the battery.
links:
 - label: Updating Firmware
href: /faqs/updating-firmware
- color: white
pattern: blinking

```

context: just after a command
meaning: Unarming the trap.
action: Normal for a few seconds while the trap disarms.

- color: red
  pattern: solid
  context: ~2 seconds after an arm command
  meaning: Arming was blocked – something is in the way, the sensor window needs
cleaning, or an update is pending. The trap did NOT arm.
  action: Clear the obstruction or clean the sensor window, then try arming again.
- color: red
  pattern: solid
  context: at boot, or staying red while idle
  meaning: Battery critically low at startup, or the trap is hibernating / shut down.
  action: Charge or replace the battery, then press the power button to wake the trap.
  links:
    - label: Battery
      href: /faqs/battery
    - label: Trap Offline or Won't Connect
      href: /troubleshooting/trap-offline-or-wont-connect
- color: red
  pattern: fast-blink
  meaning: Powering down – the power button is being held to shut the trap down.
  action: Release within ~3 seconds to cancel. Otherwise the LED goes solid red and the
trap powers off. Rapid red blinking is not a fault code – genuine faults show as brief
flash bursts (see the note below the table).

- color: no-light
  pattern: off
  meaning: No power, hibernating, or a failed boot. On battery, brief flashes every ~10
seconds are normal – only a light that never appears is a problem.
  action: Reconnect the yellow battery connector, press the power button once, then
send any command from the app to confirm the trap is awake.
  links:
    - label: Trap Offline or Won't Connect
      href: /troubleshooting/trap-offline-or-wont-connect
    - label: Power Modes
      href: /faqs/power-modes

```

Note: Rapid red blinking is **not** an error code — it means the trap is powering down. Genuine faults show as brief flash bursts: **3 orange flashes** for a sensor error (clean the lens and power-cycle) or **5 magenta flashes** for a data error. If a fault repeats, [contact support](#). These states are managed automatically; only use the power button if the LED does not respond.

Low Battery Startup Behavior

When the battery is **critically low at startup**, the following will happen:

- The trap shows a **solid red LED** during boot.
- Sends a cloud error notification (if connected).
- Automatically shuts down and enters hibernation.
- Low-battery hibernation auto-wakes about once an hour to re-check the battery (v946+); it recovers on its own once voltage is back. Only a manual power-button shutdown stays off until you press the power button.
- If voltage is still low, it will repeat the cycle.

To recover, charge or replace the battery and press the power button again.

User Button Interactions

The color and pattern for each of these actions is in the diagnostic and table above. This section covers **how to trigger** them with the physical buttons. For the full how-to, including arming failures and power off, see [Using the Buttons on the Trap](#).

Manual Door Control

To manually open or close the trap door:

1. Press the **User Button** once.
2. Press it again and **hold for about 5 seconds**. After a short confirmation delay (about **7 seconds total** from the start of the hold), the door actuates.

Hold the button for the full duration — releasing early cancels the action. The door then opens (or closes) and stays in that position; there is no auto-close timer.

The door light blinks **blue** while opening and **green** while closing.

Arm / Unarm the Trap

1. Press the **User Button**, then the **Power Button**

The light blinks **yellow** while arming and **white** while unarming.

Notes

- LED brightness may dim in low power mode to conserve battery.
- No LED means the device is off or in hibernation.
- Any pattern not listed here may indicate a malfunction — [contact support](#) if unsure.

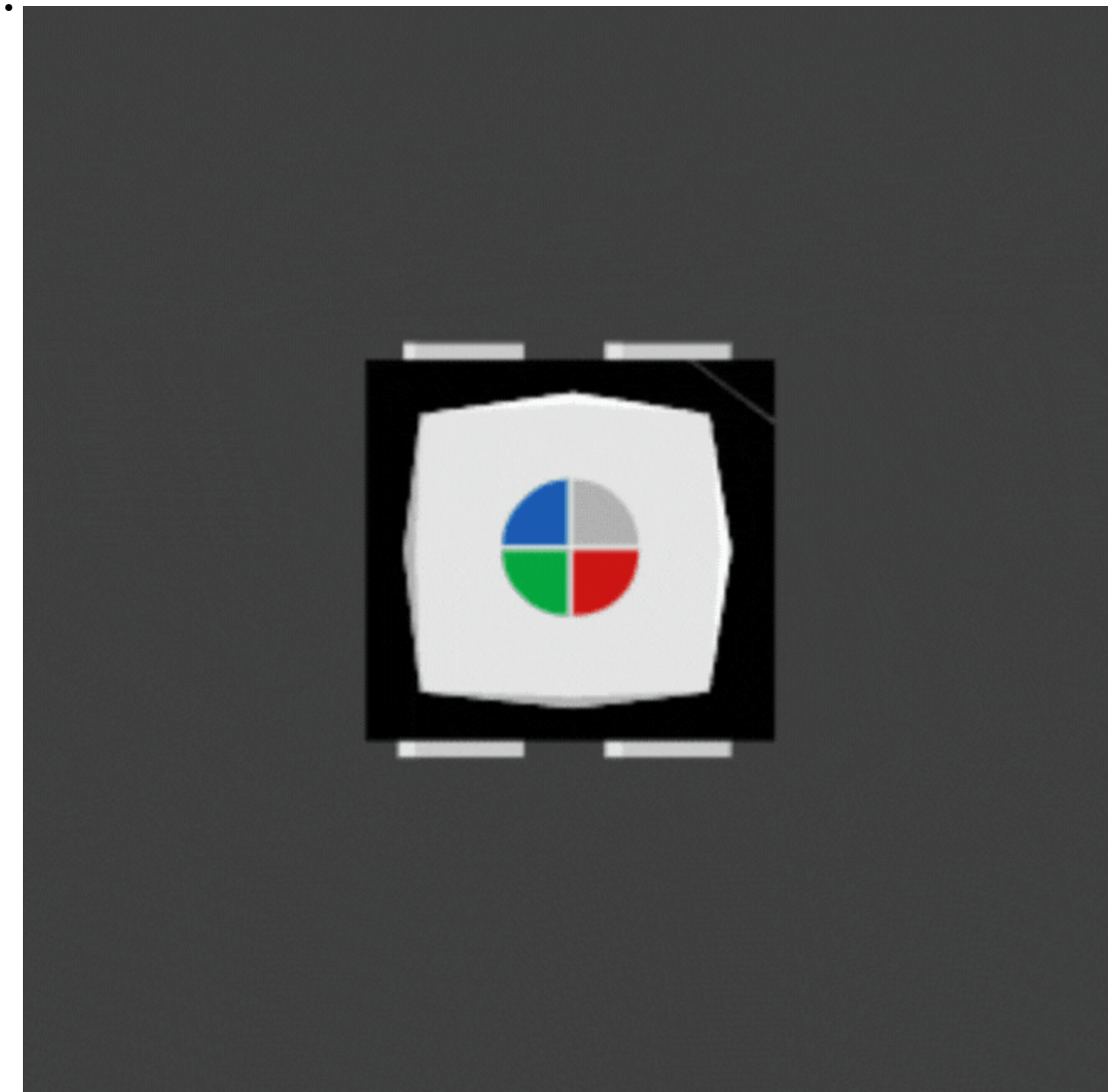
LED Pattern Animations

For what each color and pattern means — including red blinks, battery idle flashes, and what to do next — use the [LED Guide](#). That page is the single source of truth (interactive diagnostic + full reference table).

The GIFs below are short visual examples of the most common **connection** patterns. They do not replace the LED Guide.

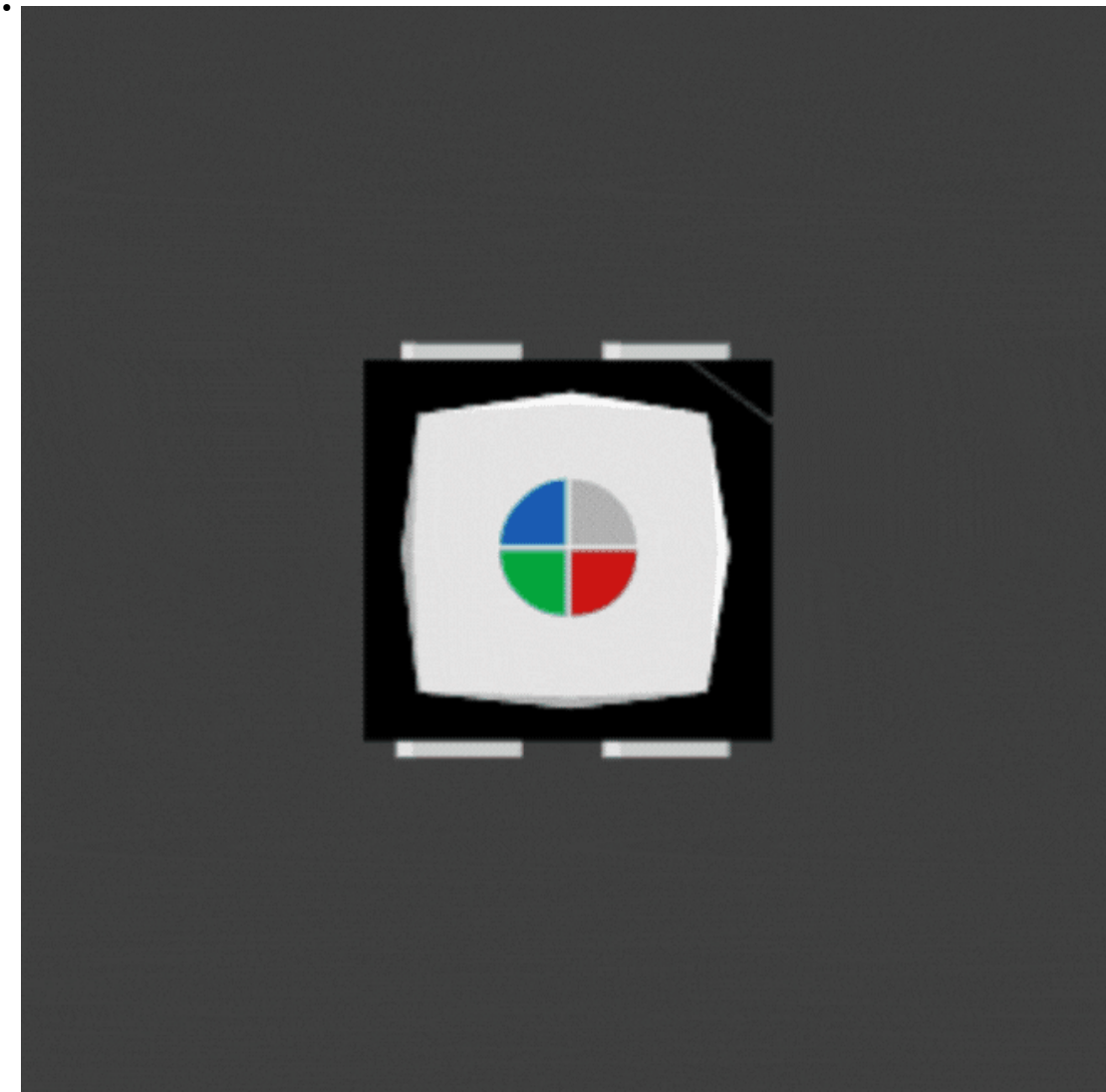
Connected Mode

- **Breathing Cyan:** The trap is connected to the cloud and online.



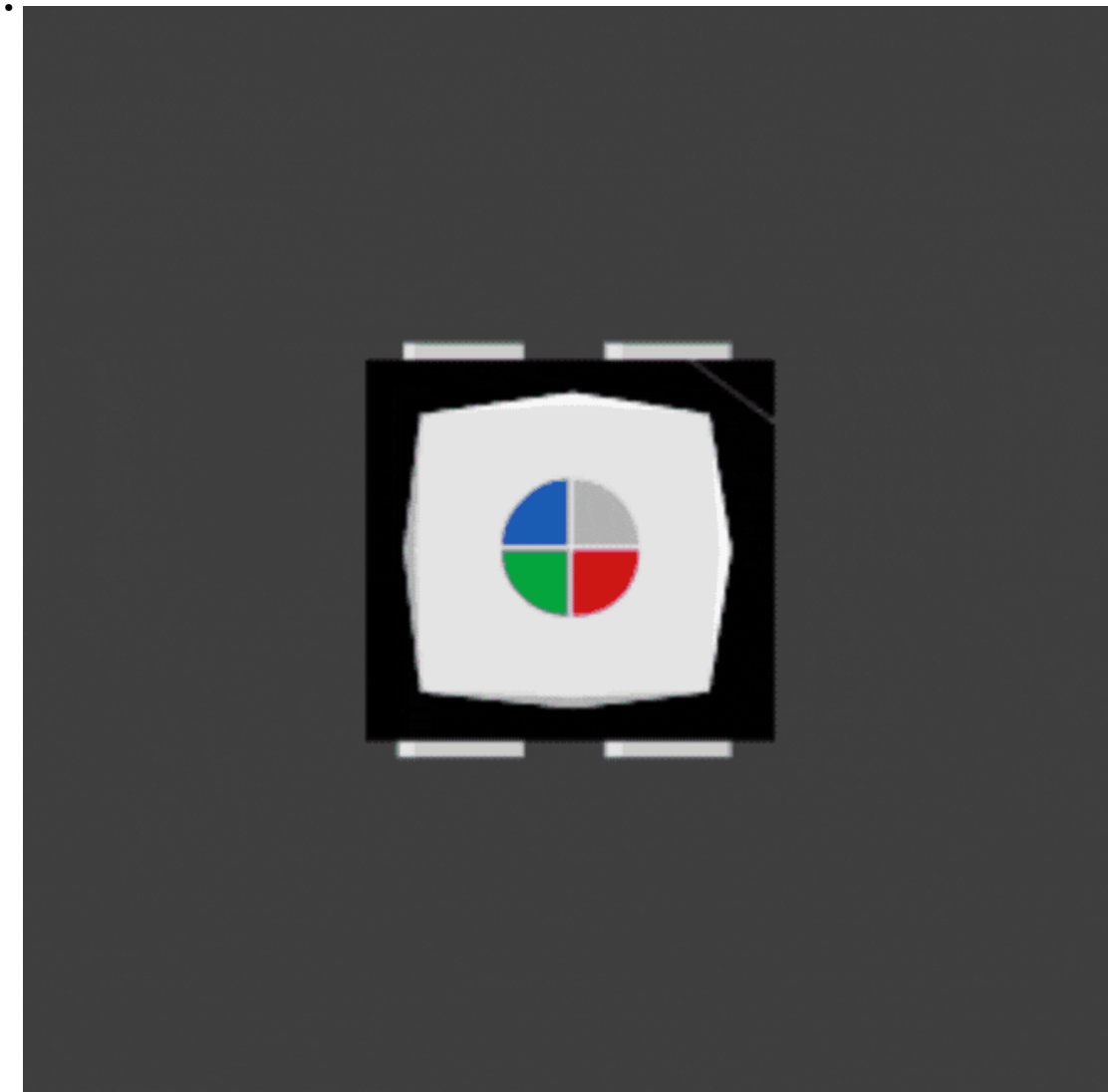
Connecting to the Cloud

- **Rapidly Blinking Cyan:** The trap is connecting to the cloud, usually after finding cellular signal.



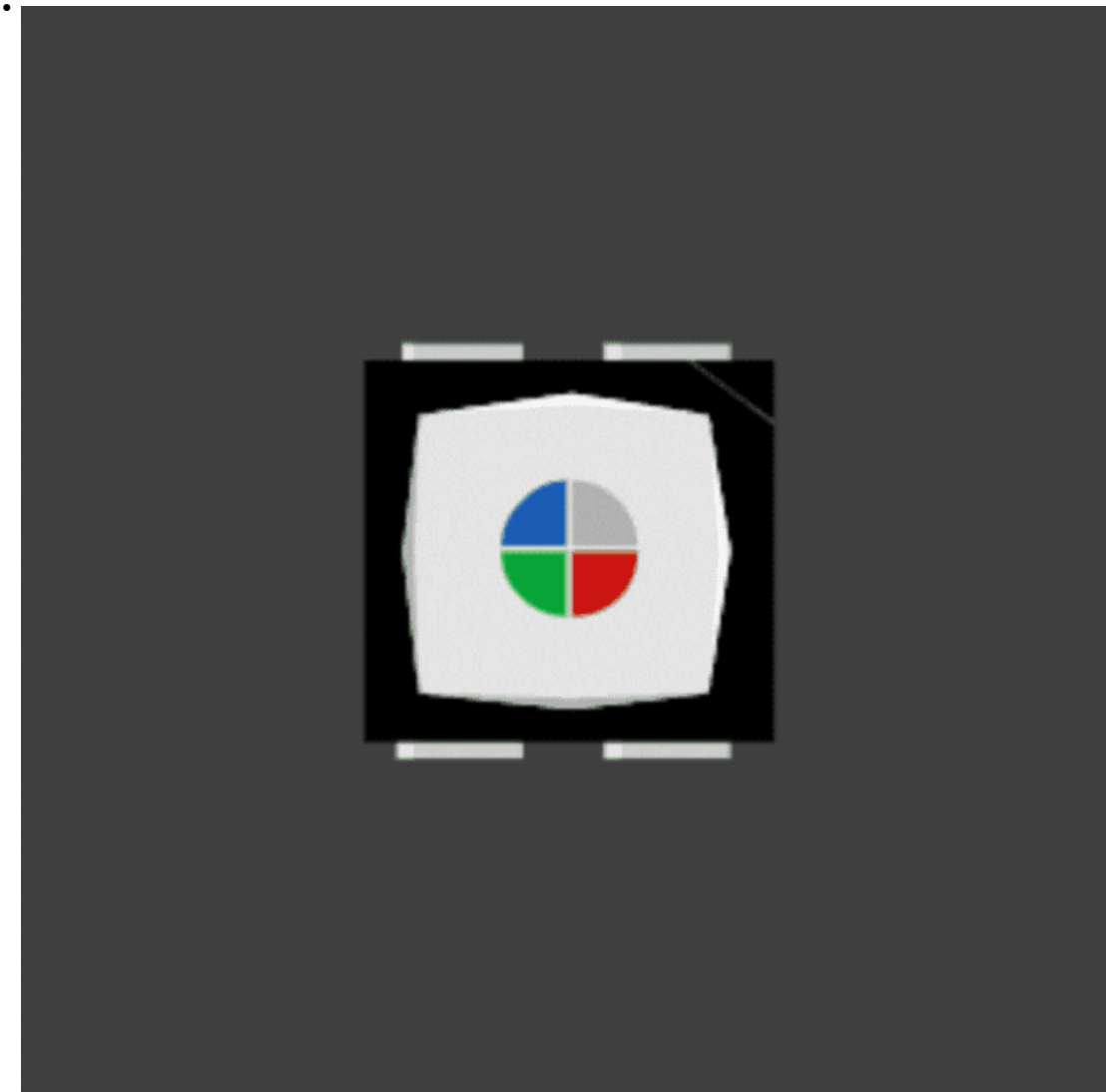
OTA Firmware Update

- **Blinking Magenta:** A firmware update is in progress. Leave the trap powered on and wait.



Looking for Internet

- **Blinking Green:** The device is attempting to establish a cellular connection.



Red light or no light?

Rapid red blinking usually means the trap is **powering down** (power button held) — not an SOS/error code. Solid red, brief red flashes after a command, and “no light” cases are all covered in the [LED Guide](#). If the LED never comes on after you reconnect the battery and press power, see [Trap Offline or Won't Connect](#).

Battery Overview

Current Models

Battery capacity depends on your shipment region:

- **KBT 10,000 mAh (111 Wh, 12V)** — standard for **US shipments**
 - Estimated battery life: **~40+ days** per charge (under normal usage).
 - Charger: **2A (12V)**
 - Trap cable: **female XT30** on the battery harness (trap uses mating **male XT30**).
- **KBT 5,200 mAh (56 Wh, 12V)** — included with **Canadian shipments**; also used on some earlier US traps
 - Estimated battery life: **~21 days** per charge (under normal usage).
 - Charger: **1A (12V)**
 - Trap cable: **male XT30** on the yellow harness (trap uses **female XT30**).

Both packs are **12 V, 6-cell** lithium-ion batteries. The two packs use **opposite XT30 genders** so they cannot be plugged into the wrong trap by mistake. If you need to run a different capacity than your trap was built for, contact support@ocutrap.com to request the matching connector and battery holder.

Tell the app which battery you have

In the app, set your pack under **Settings** → **Battery Type** (choose **5,200 mAh** or **10,000 mAh**). The app uses this to adjust the **low-battery alert thresholds** and level readout for your pack, so alerts fire at the right time. Battery thresholds are handled automatically from this setting — there are no manual voltage or percentage controls. Battery Type **defaults to the 5,200 mAh pack**, so if your trap shipped with the 10,000 mAh battery, update this setting so battery level and alerts read correctly.

For full electrical specs, see [Technical Specifications](#).

Charging

- Use only the **provided KBT charger** (1A or 2A, matched to your pack) to ensure safety and proper charging.

- The **5,200 mAh battery** takes approximately **5–6 hours** to fully recharge with the 1A charger.
- The **10,000 mAh battery** takes approximately **5–6 hours** with its 2A charger.
- The charger light turns **red** while charging and **green** when fully charged.
- Always disconnect the charger once fully charged to preserve long-term battery health.

Extending Battery Life

We are actively working on **software improvements** to increase efficiency and extend battery life. In addition, you can maximize runtime by:

- Ensuring traps are placed in areas with **strong cellular** (poor signal increases power usage).
- Keeping firmware up to date (updates include **battery optimization improvements**).
- Using the appropriate battery size for your deployment length (e.g., **10,000 mAh for longer-term setups**).
- Powering down the trap when not in use.

Battery Care & Safety

- Store batteries in a **cool, dry place** when not in use.
- Avoid exposing batteries to extreme heat or moisture.
- Only use **OcuTrap-approved chargers**.
- Do not attempt to open, puncture, or modify the battery.

Care

Keep the trap working in the field.

Maintenance

Maintenance

To ensure optimal performance and longevity of your OcuTrap, please follow the maintenance checklist below. **Always power off the trap before performing any maintenance.**

Maintenance Tasks (Every Trapping Session)

Maintenance Task	Action
Camera Lens Cleaning	Wipe with a soft, lint-free cloth to remove smudges and debris.
Door Operation Test	Verify smooth opening and closing of the door.
Trap Exterior Cleaning	Use a damp cloth; avoid harsh chemicals that may damage the surface.
Interior Components Inspection & Cleaning	Inspect the door, spring, and motor assembly for obstructions.
Battery Terminal Inspection	Look for signs of corrosion or wear; clean gently if needed.
Motor and Sensor Test	Confirm that the motor and sensors are operating correctly.
Seals and Enclosures Inspection	Ensure that all seals and enclosures are intact and secure.
Post-Adverse Weather Inspection	Check for moisture or debris and clean as necessary.

Note: Firmware updates are automatically applied, so no manual update is required.

FAQs

Sharing Traps

OcuTrap allows users to share traps with others, enabling collaboration and remote monitoring. To share a trap, follow these steps:

Requirements

- The user sharing the trap **must have an OcuTrap account**.
- The recipient must also have an OcuTrap account with a valid email address.

How to Share a Trap

1. **Log into your OcuTrap account** and open the **trap** you want to share.
2. Open the trap's **Sharing** tab.
3. Enter the recipient's **valid email address**.
4. If you're the trap **owner**, choose the manager level for this person — **Standard Manager** or **Full Manager** (see [User Levels](#)).
5. Send the invitation.

Pending invites

Sharing sends the recipient an email invitation. Until they accept it, they appear in the trap's **Shared With** list with a **Pending** indicator — they don't have access to the trap yet. Once they accept from their email, the trap shows up in their account with the access level you chose.

You stay in control of every share at any time:

- **Cancel invite** — remove a pending invitation before it's accepted.
- **Remove access** — revoke an accepted user's access whenever you need to.

Trap owners and managers can cancel a pending invite or revoke access at any time.

Once shared, the recipient will have access based on their **user level**. To learn more about different access levels, see the [User Levels](#) page.

User Levels

When you share a trap, each person you share with is a **Manager**. There is no view-only role — everyone you share a trap with can both see it and control it. What differs between levels is who can manage billing, ownership, and other users.

The three levels

- **Owner** — the person who registered the trap (or received it via an ownership transfer). Full control of the trap, plus billing, ownership, and settings-lock. There is one owner per trap.
- **Full Manager** — full control of the trap **and** can add or remove other managers.
- **Standard Manager** — full control of the trap. Can add or remove other managers **only if** the owner grants them that permission when sharing (or afterward).

At share time, the trap owner chooses whether a new manager is a **Standard Manager** or a **Full Manager** (and can toggle whether a standard manager may manage other users). Managers who share on the owner's behalf can only invite standard managers.

What each level can do

Capability	Owner	Full Manager	Standard Manager
View the trap, images, and activity	✓	✓	✓
Set arm mode — Unarmed / Scouting / Armed	✓	✓	✓
Open / close the door, disarm & release	✓	✓	✓
Rename the trap, edit details, set location	✓	✓	✓
Change device settings	✓	✓ ¹	✓ ¹
Lock settings so only the owner can change them	✓	✗	✗
Add or remove other managers	✓	✓	Only if granted
Delete the trap	✓	✗	✗
Transfer ownership	✓	✗	✗
Manage subscription and billing	✓	✗	✗

¹ A manager cannot change settings that the owner has locked.

Managing access

Access can be revoked by the owner (or a manager who has user-management permission) at any time. A shared invite stays **Pending** until the recipient accepts it from their email; until then they have no access to the trap. See [Sharing Traps](#) for the step-by-step sharing flow.

Common questions

Short answers for the questions customers ask most. For deeper how-tos, follow the links.

Does OcuTrap require a subscription?

Yes — each trap needs an active subscription to stay connected over cellular and use the cloud app (remote control, captures, notifications, image history, GPS).

- Cellular data is included in the subscription; there is no separate SIM plan to buy.
- Without an active subscription, the trap **cannot connect** to the OcuTrap cloud — remote commands and live captures stop.

See [Your OcuTrap Subscription](#) and [Managing Your Subscription](#).

What are the ongoing costs?

After purchase, the main ongoing costs are:

- **Per-trap subscription** (monthly or annual) — required for cellular + cloud features.
- **Battery charging / replacement** as packs age — see [Battery](#) and [Battery Overview](#).

Can OcuTrap tell species apart (raccoon vs skunk vs opossum)?

Not automatically. Any animal that enters can trigger a capture. Use **remote release** from the app, review capture photos, and tune placement / Capture Distance. See [What animals is the OcuTrap R1 designed for?](#) and [Trap Control](#).

What size is the OcuTrap R1?

About **10" wide × 12" tall**. Cage alone (door closed, without POD) is **~32"** long. The POD adds about **5"**; with the door fully open, add about **4"** more (**~41"** total). Full specs: [Technical Specifications](#).

How do I change my name or email?

Sign in at app.ocutrap.com → **Account** → edit your details → **Save**.

How do I share a trap with someone else?

Open the trap → **Sharing** tab → enter their email → choose manager level (owner only) → send invite. Details: [Sharing Traps](#) and [User Levels](#).

Can I control the trap remotely?

Yes — with an active subscription and cellular coverage, open/close, arm modes, and settings work from the web or mobile app. See [Trap Control](#).

How do notifications work?

Capture and device alerts can go to push and/or email depending on your preferences. Configure them under **Account** notification settings. Details: [Notification Settings](#).

Scout-mode activity stays in the trap feed only (no push/email). See [Scouting Mode](#).

Why am I not getting push notifications?

- Allow notifications for OcuTrap in phone Settings.
- Confirm preferences in the app (Account).
- If they still fail, delete and reinstall the app, then sign in again so push can re-register.

Step-by-step: [Resetting the Mobile App](#).

Does it need Wi-Fi?

No. OcuTrap uses **4G LTE cellular only** — no Wi-Fi. Coverage must be available at the deploy site. See [Connectivity & Coverage](#).

Is it weather-resistant? What about cold weather?

The trap is built for outdoor field use. For extremes and winter tips, see [Weather & Environmental Guidelines](#) and [Cold Weather](#).

How long does the battery last?

Runtime depends on temperature, photo cadence, and cellular conditions. Charging and pack basics: [Battery](#). Overview: [Battery Overview](#).

Is there an iOS and Android app?

Yes — both platforms. Web: app.ocutrap.com. Mobile overview: [Using the Mobile App](#).

What if the trap is offline or commands fail?

Start here:

- [Trap Offline or Won't Connect](#)
- [Trap Not Sending Commands](#)
- [LED Guide](#)

I can't sign in / forgot my password

- Password reset: [Resetting Password](#)
- Broader sign-in issues: [Can't Sign In to Your Account](#)

How do I reduce false triggers?

Tune placement and bait, review pre-capture / capture photos, and adjust **Capture Distance** and related door/sensor settings. See [Distance Limits](#), [Sensor Alerts & Errors](#) and [Pre-Capture Notification](#).

Where can I buy an OcuTrap?

Purchase through ocutrap.com (and authorized partners listed there). For second-hand units, see [Selling or Transferring a Trap](#).

What animals is the OcuTrap R1 designed for?

The OcuTrap R1 is built for **medium-sized nuisance wildlife** — animals roughly **5–25 lbs** that fit comfortably inside the cage. This page covers which species the trap is designed around, which ones are a poor match, and how to set your expectations honestly before you deploy.

Primary target species

The R1 was designed around three groups of animals:

- **Raccoons** — the most common target. Adult raccoons fit the cage well and trigger the sensor reliably.
- **Feral and stray cats** — a natural fit for the cage size, and a frequent use case for TNR (trap-neuter-return) programs and property managers.
- **Skunks** — sized well for the cage. The remote door control is especially useful here: you can manage the trap [from the app](#) without startling the animal up close.

Opossums and similarly sized animals in the same weight range also work well, even though they aren't the primary design targets.

They're active at night — plan for it

Raccoons, cats, and skunks are **nocturnal or crepuscular**: most of their activity happens between dusk and dawn. That matters for how you run the trap:

- **Bait and arm the trap before dusk**, so it's ready when your target starts moving.

- **Expect alerts overnight.** Captures most often happen in the hours after sunset and before sunrise — make sure your [notification settings](#) will actually reach you.
- **Plan a morning check.** A captured animal shouldn't sit in the trap through a hot or cold day — see [Handling & Releasing a Captured Animal](#).
- **Not sure what's visiting?** Run [Scouting Mode](#) for a night or two first. It photographs whatever shows up without closing the door, so you know what you're targeting before you arm.

Will it fit? Cage size and geometry

The cage interior is **10" wide × 12" high × 32" long** (see [Technical Specifications](#) for full dimensions).

Fit	Animals	Notes
Comfortable fit	Raccoons, feral/stray cats, skunks, opossums (~5–25 lbs)	Enough room to fully enter and reach bait placed behind the sensor
Tight / poor fit	Large dogs, coyotes, adult beavers, anything much over ~25 lbs	Too large to fully enter — the door can't close safely behind them
Poor match (too small)	Mice, chipmunks, small squirrels, other very small rodents	Fit through the cage easily but are not detected reliably — see below

A good rule of thumb: the animal should be able to **walk fully inside the cage with room to spare** and reach bait placed near the back. If it has to squeeze in, or the door would close on its body, the R1 is the wrong size for that animal.

What the R1 is *not* designed for

We'd rather be honest here than have you waste nights on the wrong tool:

- **Very small rodents (mice, chipmunks, small squirrels).** The R1's sensor is tuned for medium-sized animals. Very small animals produce a weak detection signal and **may walk through the trap without ever triggering it** — especially at larger capture distances, where detection of small animals is less reliable. The R1 is not a rodent trap, and we don't recommend buying it for mice or rats.
- **Animals larger than the cage.** If the animal can't fully enter, the trap can't capture it safely.
- **Birds and reptiles.** Detection is not designed or validated for them.

Targeting something on the small end of the range? Don't take our word for it — or the trap's. Validate with [Scouting Mode](#) first: if your target animal shows up in scouting photos and registers a **Scout Trigger** at your chosen capture distance, you know the trap can actually detect it. If it only appears in photos but never triggers, it's too small for reliable capture at that distance — try a shorter capture distance, or reconsider whether the R1 is the right tool.

Setting up for your target

Once you know your target species:

1. Follow [Deploying Your Trap in the Field](#) for placement, capture distance, and the pre-deployment test.
2. Set your capture distance for the animal's size — the default **8 in** works for most raccoon/cat/skunk setups; see [Distance Limits, Sensor Alerts & Errors](#).
3. Use bait suited to your target and place it **behind the sensor**, near the back of the cage.

Related: [Deploying Your Trap in the Field](#) · [Scouting Mode](#) · [Common questions](#) · [Technical Specifications](#)

Safe-mode

What Safe Mode is for: Safe Mode is a recovery mode built into the trap's cellular controller. In Safe Mode the device still starts up and connects to the cloud, but it does **not** run the trap's normal program. That lets it accept a firmware update (or clear a bad state) when the trap is stuck in a crash or boot loop and won't come online on its own. It's an advanced step — you normally only need it when **OcuTrap Support** asks you to use it while recovering a device.

While in Safe Mode the LED shows **magenta** (the same firmware-update color you'll see in the [LED Guide](#)).

Buttons: The **RESET** and **MODE** buttons referred to below are the two small buttons on the trap's internal cellular controller (the cellular module inside the POD) — not the User and Power buttons you use for everyday operation.

Prerequisite: Make sure the device has enough battery charge. If it will not turn on, charge the battery and try again.

To put your device in Safe Mode:

1. Hold down BOTH buttons (RESET and MODE).
2. Release only the RESET button, while continuing to hold down the MODE button.
3. Wait for the LED to start blinking magenta.
4. Release the MODE button.

Before the LED blinks magenta, the trap goes through its normal startup sequence (blinking green, then blinking cyan). If the trap cannot connect to the cloud, you may not see breathing magenta — but if the LED is blinking magenta after you release the MODE button, Safe Mode is active.

If you're not sure whether your trap needs Safe Mode, [contact support](#) before using it.

Battery

Features

High-Quality Batteries: Each pack is built with premium cells to provide reliable 12V power.

Built-in Protection Board: Prevents over-charge, over-discharge, over-voltage, and short circuits.

Charging Process:

1. Identifying the Connectors:

- Your battery pack comes with **two connectors**:
 - The **yellow connector** is for connecting to the OcuTrap device.
 - The **black connector** is used exclusively for charging the battery.

2. Charging the Battery:

- Plug the **black connector** into the supplied **12V battery charger**.
- Connect the charger to a power source.
- The charger's indicator light will show:
 - **Red light**: Battery is charging.
 - **Green light**: Battery is fully charged.

3. Charging Duration:

- If the battery is **completely drained**, it will take approximately **5–6 hours** to fully charge.

4. Disconnecting:

- Once the charger's light turns **green**, the battery is fully charged and can be disconnected from the charger.

Package Includes:

- **1 x 12V battery pack** (capacity depends on region — see [Battery Overview](#))
- **1 x 12V battery charger** (1A or 2A, matched to your pack)

Specifications:

- **Capacities: 5,200 mAh (56 Wh) or 10,000 mAh (111 Wh)** — both 12 V, 6-cell packs. Tell the app which pack you have under **Settings** → **Battery Type** so low-battery alert thresholds match automatically.
- **Battery Pack Size**: 70 x 55 x 40 mm (L x W x T)
- **Battery Weight**: Approx. 295g (5,200 mAh pack) — note the **10,000 mAh** pack is standard for new US shipments; see [Battery Overview](#) for both models
- **Charger Cable Length**: 90 cm

Always charge your battery properly to maintain optimal performance and battery life. If you encounter any issues, contact support@ocutrap.com.

For regional battery models, runtime estimates, and connector details, see [Battery Overview](#).

Updating Firmware

OcuTrap firmware updates are delivered automatically over-the-air (OTA) to ensure your device has the latest features and security improvements.

How Firmware Updates Work

Automatic Updates

- Firmware updates are pushed automatically when your OcuTrap is connected to the internet.
- Updates typically occur during low-activity periods to minimize disruption.
- Your trap will briefly restart after an update is applied.

Update Requirements

For a successful firmware update:

- The trap must be powered on and connected to cellular.
- Battery level should be above 20% to prevent interruption during the update.
- The trap should remain powered during the update process (usually 5-15 minutes).

Checking Your Firmware Version

To view your current firmware version:

1. Open the **OcuTrap Mobile App**.
2. Select your trap from the device list.
3. Navigate to **Settings** or **Device Info**.
4. The firmware version is displayed under device details.

Troubleshooting Update Issues

Update Not Installing

- Ensure the trap has a stable internet connection.
- Verify the battery level is sufficient.
- Try power cycling the trap by removing and reinserting the battery.

Trap Unresponsive After Update

- Wait 5 minutes for the trap to complete its restart sequence.
- If the trap remains unresponsive, turn the trap off and on again (remove and reconnect the battery, or hold the power button).
- Contact [support](#) if issues persist.

Release Notes

For information about the latest firmware features and fixes, check the **Updates** page on docs.ocutrap.com or contact support.

Requesting photos

You can request a fresh photo of the inside of your trap at any time. Open the trap's detail screen — the most recent photo is shown as a large image (the **camera view**) with the trap's controls beside it. There's no separate step to open the camera view.

Request a photo

To ask the trap for a new photo, use **Request image**. The trap captures a standard, full-quality photo and sends it to the app — the best choice for confirming what's inside or checking image clarity.

In the mobile app, you can also choose **Request quick image** for a faster, lower-resolution photo — handy when you just need a quick check and don't need full detail.

Manage: 4097022

[Change Trap Name](#)

Notifications

Error Push-notification

Alert Push-notification

Capture Push-notification

1 Larger is better quality but takes longer to send

Image Size

Trigger distance

none

Monitoring Mode

☒ Enabled

☐ Enabled

[More Settings](#)

2

Update now

Trap Order

Position: 1

SN: 0a10aced202194944a051c4c

After you request a photo, an **Image incoming...** indicator appears on the camera view while the trap captures and uploads the new image. It clears on its own once the fresh photo arrives.

Browse past images

From the camera view you can:

- Tap the image to open the gallery
- Use the **Images** tab to see previously captured photos

If images look too dark, washed out, or blurry, see [Camera](#) for light-switching settings and fixes.

See also

- [Trap Control](#) — all the commands you can send your trap
- [When Your Trap Takes Photos](#) — automatic capture timing
- [Camera](#) — image quality and night-vision settings

GPS

OcuTrap uses an integrated u-blox GPS module to provide location tracking and mapping capabilities. This guide explains the GPS settings and functionality to help you get the most accurate location data for your traps.

How GPS Works on OcuTrap

GPS is **battery-optimized by design**. Rather than continuously tracking location, OcuTrap uses strategic update intervals to maximize battery life while keeping you informed of trap locations.

Default Behavior

- **Update Interval:** Every 8 hours (default)
 - **First Boot Delay:** 5-minute delay after power-on before first GPS acquisition
 - **Automatic Capture Updates:** GPS automatically triggered when a capture occurs
 - **Fix Requirements:** Minimum 5 satellites with a 3D fix for valid position
-

GPS Settings

GPS Interval

- Controls how frequently the GPS updates location data
- **Default:** 8 hours (recommended for battery life)
- Can be disabled to conserve battery life
- Located in Settings → GPS Interval

- Manual updates still possible through the interface when disabled

GPS Status Indicators

When viewing trap locations, you'll see key metrics:

- **Satellites Connected:** Number of GPS satellites currently in use (e.g., "8 connected"). More satellites = better accuracy.
- **Last Updated:** How long ago the GPS position was updated (e.g., "6 Hours Ago").
- **Radius:** The trap's last location is within the approximate radius.

Best Practices

Optimal GPS Performance

- Place the OcuTrap outdoors with clear sky view for best results
- **First fix:** Allow up to 3 minutes for initial GPS acquisition after power-on
- **Subsequent fixes:** Typically acquired within 2 minutes
- System will timeout if no fix is acquired within the timeout period
- More satellites generally means better accuracy
- Buildings, dense foliage, and urban canyons can reduce accuracy

Manual Updates

- In controls, click on data button to request a GPS update
- Only works when GPS is not disabled in settings
- Useful for verifying position without waiting for next interval

Access Levels

- Anyone with access to a trap can view that trap's location. The owner and any managers the trap is shared with all see the trap on the map tab.
- You only see traps you own or that have been shared with you — a trap's location is not visible to anyone you haven't shared it with.

Troubleshooting

No Fix Available

1. Ensure device is outdoors with clear view of sky
2. Wait up to 3 minutes for initial fix
3. Check GPS Interval setting is not disabled
4. Try manual update by clicking location data
5. If problems persist, verify no physical obstructions are blocking GPS antenna

Poor Accuracy

- Move device to location with clearer sky view
- Wait for more satellites to be acquired
- Verify Fix type is 3 for best accuracy
- Consider environmental factors (buildings, trees, etc.)

Battery Considerations

- GPS usage impacts battery life significantly
- **Default 8-hour interval** is optimized for multi-week deployments
- Shorter intervals provide more frequent updates but reduce battery life
- Disable GPS when location tracking not needed
- GPS is automatically disabled in Low Power mode to conserve battery
- Poor cellular signal in combination with GPS can increase power consumption

Map Interface

- Toggle between Map and Satellite views
- Terrain overlay available for topographical reference
- Zoom controls for detailed area inspection

Weather & Environmental Guidelines

General Weatherproof Design

OcuTrap's exterior is designed to resist harsh weather, including rain, wind, and moderate environmental challenges. However, please keep in mind:

- **Internal Electronics:** Although the enclosure is weatherproof, internal electronics must not be submerged in water.
- **Durability:** The trap is built to endure outdoor conditions, but taking precautions in extreme weather can prevent potential damage.

Operating & Charging Temperature Guidelines

Operating Temperature

For best performance:

- **Ideal Range:** Operate OcuTrap between **0°C (32°F)** and **40°C (104°F)**.

Charging Temperature

Since OcuTrap is powered by a lithium-ion battery:

- **Recommended Charging Range:** Charge the battery in ambient temperatures between **0°C (32°F)** and **45°C (113°F)**.
- **Performance Consideration:** Charging outside of this range can affect battery efficiency and lifespan.

Temperature Monitoring

The OcuTrap R1 has an integrated temperature sensor. You can see what it reports on the trap's **Charts**, under the temperature reading.

This sensor does not send alerts. The temperature alerts you can switch on in **Trap settings** watch the **outdoor weather at the trap's location** instead, not the trap's own sensor. See [Advanced settings](#).

Handling Extreme Weather Conditions

Extreme Heat and Cold

While OcuTrap is capable of operating in a broad temperature range, long-term exposure to temperatures outside the ideal operating conditions can:

- Reduce overall performance.
- Diminish battery life.

Icing Conditions

In freezing weather:

- The moving door mechanism (which opens and closes) may freeze shut.
- To maintain functionality, avoid operating OcuTrap in conditions where icing is likely.

For comprehensive cold weather guidance including battery care, condensation prevention, and seasonal deployment tips, see [Cold Weather](#).

Heavy Rain and Flooding

Even though the external design is weatherproof:

- Ensure that the internal electronics are not exposed to submersion.
- During heavy rain or flooding, consider relocating or protecting the trap to keep the internal components dry.

Battery-Specific Guidance

To maximize the performance and longevity of the lithium-ion battery:

- Adhere to the recommended operating and charging temperature guidelines.
- Avoid exposing the battery to prolonged extreme temperatures.
- No additional maintenance is required beyond following these guidelines.

For more battery information, see [Battery Overview](#).

Related Pages

- [Cold Weather](#) — Detailed guide for winter deployments
- [Battery Overview](#) — Complete battery information
- [Condensation on the Camera](#) — Troubleshooting camera condensation

Cold Weather

Operating OcuTrap in cold weather requires some additional considerations. This guide consolidates all cold weather-related information to help you maintain optimal performance during winter months.

Temperature Ranges

Operating Temperature

- **Supported operating range:** 0°C (32°F) to 40°C (104°F). **0°C is the published operating floor** — the trap is not rated or supported below it.
- **Below 0°C:** The trap may still power on, but operation below freezing is outside the supported range and is not recommended. Prolonged sub-freezing exposure can impact performance and battery longevity, with issues such as door and motor sticking, icing, and motor seizing.

Charging Temperature

- **Recommended Range:** 0°C (32°F) to 45°C (113°F)
- **Important:** Charging outside this range can affect battery efficiency and lifespan. Bring the battery indoors to charge if ambient temperatures are below freezing.

Temperature Alerts

The OcuTrap R1 model features an integrated temperature sensor that monitors internal conditions:

- **Low Temperature Alert:** Triggers at -10°C (14°F) by default
- **Alert Interval:** Every 8 hours (configurable from 0–48 hours)

The low-temperature alert default (-10°C) sits **below** the 0°C operating floor on purpose: it is an early warning that the trap is now running below its supported range, not a sign that -10°C is safe. Treat the alert as a prompt to retrieve or warm the trap. You can raise the Low Temperature Limit in Settings if you want to be warned before conditions reach freezing.

Battery Performance in Cold Weather

Cold temperatures significantly affect lithium-ion battery performance:

- **Reduced Capacity:** Battery capacity decreases in cold temperatures, sometimes dramatically
- **Shorter Runtime:** Expect shorter runtime during winter deployments
- **Recommended Solution:** Consider the 10,000 mAh battery (standard for new traps and US shipments) for extended cold-weather deployments to compensate for reduced capacity

Battery Care Tips

- Store batteries in a cool, dry place when not in use
- Avoid leaving batteries in freezing conditions for extended periods
- If possible, swap batteries more frequently during cold weather operations
- Charge batteries at room temperature for best results

Ice and Freezing Conditions

Door Mechanism

In freezing weather, the door mechanism may be affected:

- **Frozen Door:** The moving door mechanism (which opens and closes) may freeze shut
- **Motor Seizing:** In icing conditions, the door motor may seize if the arm becomes frozen, preventing the motor from moving
- **Recommendation:** Avoid operating OcuTrap in conditions where icing is likely

Preventing Ice-Related Issues

- Check weather forecasts before deployment

- If ice formation is expected, consider temporarily retrieving the trap
- After ice events, inspect the door mechanism before resuming operation
- Allow frozen components to thaw naturally—do not force the door open

Condensation

Temperature swings common in cold weather (such as morning/evening transitions) can cause condensation issues:

Symptoms

- Foggy or "milky" images that typically clear after a few minutes
- This is caused by external condensation from temperature changes

Solutions

- **Immediate Fix:** Place a fresh silica gel pack inside the trap pod before closing
- **Deep-Dry Procedure:** Leave the POD cracked open in a warm, ventilated spot for 24 hours, or seal in a zipper bag with desiccant packs for 12–18 hours

Seasonal Deployment Tips

Before Winter

- Fully charge batteries and consider having spares ready
- Inspect door mechanism and ensure it moves freely
- Add fresh silica gel packs to prevent condensation
- Test the trap to confirm all systems function properly

During Winter

- Monitor battery levels more frequently
- Check for ice buildup after freezing rain or sleet events
- Be prepared for reduced check-in frequency if battery is depleted faster
- Review temperature alerts in the app

End of Winter

- Perform a full inspection of the trap

- Check for any moisture intrusion or corrosion
- Replace silica gel packs
- Verify door mechanism operates smoothly after the cold season

Related Pages

- [Weather & Environmental Guidelines](#) — Full environmental guidelines including heat and rain
- [Battery Overview](#) — Complete battery information
- [Tips and Tricks](#) — General deployment tips
- [Condensation on the Camera](#) — Detailed condensation troubleshooting

Camera

The **OcuTrap camera** provides **daytime and night vision capabilities**, allowing users to configure image capture settings based on lighting conditions.

Camera Time-Lapse Mode

OcuTrap can **automatically capture images** at set intervals in **any mode**: unarmed, armed, or scouting.

Configurable Option

- **Photo Capture Frequency** – Defines how often the camera captures an image while the trap is armed.

If images are too frequent, **reduce the frequency** to conserve battery and data. If you need more monitoring, **increase the frequency** to capture more activity.

Camera Image Settings

These settings control **image quality, resolution, and night vision brightness.**

- **Image Quality** – Adjusts resolution and compression. Higher quality means clearer images but **increased data usage.**
- **Image Size** – Defines the resolution of captured images.
- **Maximum IR Brightness** – Adjusts infrared light intensity in **night vision mode** to **prevent overexposure or underexposure.**

If **daytime images look fine but nighttime images are too dark**, **increase *Max IR Brightness*.**

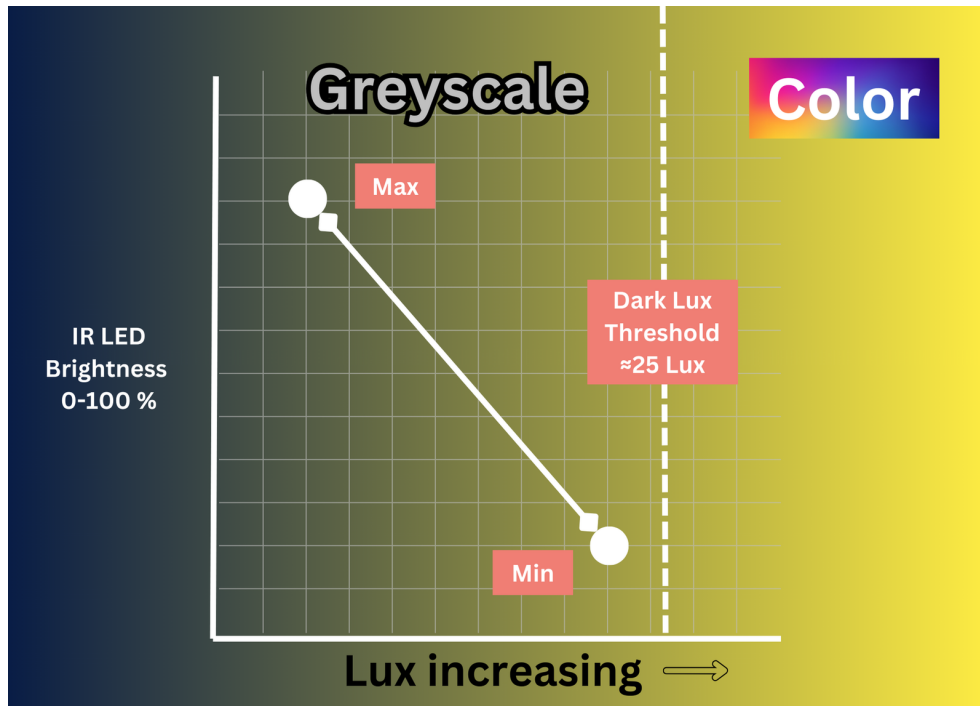
If **nighttime images are washed out or too bright**, **lower *Max IR Brightness*.**

Limits for IR Brightness

Setting	Min Value	Default Value	Max Value
Max IR Brightness	0	50	100
Min IR Brightness	0	20	100

Night Vision & Light Adaptation

Most users do not need to adjust light settings, as the camera is designed to work automatically. However, users can fine-tune these settings for optimal image clarity in specific environments.



The camera **automatically adjusts** between **color mode** (daytime) and **night vision (greyscale)** based on ambient light levels.

Automatic Light Switching

- **Dark Lux Threshold**
 - If ambient light **falls below this value**, the camera activates **night vision mode** (greyscale) and **enables IR**.
- **Dynamic Light Adaptation**
 - When light is **between the two thresholds**, the IR brightness **gradually adjusts** to optimize visibility.

Limits for Light Thresholds

Setting	Min Value	Default Value	Max Value
Dark Lux Threshold	10.0	20.0	100.0

If **daytime images are still in greyscale**, lower *Dark Lux Threshold* so the camera switches to color mode sooner.

If **nighttime images are still in color and too dark**, increase *Dark Lux Threshold* to enable greyscale mode earlier.

Understanding and Adjusting Image Quality

If you experience **image quality issues**, use the guide below to fine-tune your settings:

Issue	Cause	Solution
Daytime images appear too dark	<i>Dark Lux Threshold</i> is too high	Lower <i>Dark Lux Threshold</i> so the camera switches to color mode sooner.
Daytime images are blurry	Low image quality setting	Increase Image Quality in settings.
Nighttime images are too dark	IR brightness is too low	Increase <i>Max IR Brightness</i> to enhance night vision.
Nighttime images are too bright or washed out	IR brightness is too high	Lower <i>Max IR Brightness</i> to prevent overexposure.
Images have too much glare	Reflections from IR light	Adjust trap positioning or lower <i>Max IR Brightness</i> .
Images are too pixelated	Low resolution setting	Increase Image Size or Image Quality .

How OcuTrap Adapts to Different Light Conditions

Light Condition	Camera Mode	IR Brightness
Bright daylight (above <i>dark lux threshold</i>)	Color	Off
Low light/Night (below <i>dark lux threshold</i>)	Greyscale (night vision)	<i>Between Max and Min IR Brightness</i>

Summary of Best Practices

For Most Users:

- No need to adjust light settings—the camera adapts automatically.

If Adjustments Are Needed:

- **Improve night images** → Increase `maxIrBrightness`.
- **Fix overexposed IR images** → Lower `maxIrBrightness`.
- **Make daytime images clearer** → Increase **Image Quality**.

Power Modes

OcuTrap is designed with multiple power modes to **maximize battery life** while maintaining functionality in the field. These modes ensure that the device can operate efficiently for extended periods while allowing users to interact when needed.

The power management system optimizes energy consumption by adjusting connectivity, sensor activity, and LED brightness based on usage. This allows for **extended deployment without frequent battery replacements or recharges**.

Quick Reference: OcuTrap has 6 power modes ranging from full operation to complete shutdown. The device automatically transitions between modes based on activity, battery level, and armed state.

Power Modes

1. Normal Power Mode

- **Description:** This is the highest power state where OcuTrap is fully operational.
 - **When Active:** When the user is interacting with the device through commands or pressing buttons.
 - **Indicators:** LED at full brightness.
-

2. Low Power Idle Mode

- **Description:** A power-saving mode where the device reduces energy consumption while waiting for user interaction.
 - **When Active:** After a period of inactivity in normal power mode.
 - **Indicators:** LED brightness is dimmed.
-

3. Low Power Armed Mode

- **Description:** Same as Low Power Idle, but the trap is armed and ready to capture an animal.
- **When Active:** When the trap is armed and waiting.
- **Indicators:** LED brightness is dimmed.
- **Detection:** The distance sensor continues monitoring for animals while using less power than full operation

Important: When in **armed mode**, the device will **not enter hibernation** unless a **very low battery event** occurs.

4. Sleep Mode

- **Description:** A deeper power-saving state where most systems are powered down except essential wake functions.
 - **When Active:** Extended periods of inactivity without being armed.
 - **Indicators:** LED is powered off.
 - **Power Consumption:** Very low — most sensors disabled.
 - **Wake Events:** Button press, scheduled check-in, or incoming cloud command.
-

5. Armed Sleep Offline Mode

- **Description:** A specialized armed mode that extends battery life further by periodically checking in with the cloud while keeping the internet disconnected in between. The trap remains armed and monitoring for captures even when offline.

- **When Active:** When armed, but conserving power between check-ins, or when cellular connectivity is unavailable.
 - **Check-In Interval:** Every **20 minutes** (fixed, cannot be changed by the user).
 - **Power Consumption:** Lower than Low Power Armed Mode due to reduced network usage.
 - **Indicators:** LED flashes at 3-second intervals.
 - **Capture Behavior:** If a capture occurs while offline, the trap will report it at the next check-in.
-

6. Hibernation Mode

- **Description:** The lowest power state where the device is completely inactive. No communication is possible in this mode.
- **When Active:**
 - If the **battery is too low** to continue operation.
 - If the **power button is held down for 3+ seconds**.
- **Power Consumption:** Minimal.
- **Indicators:** LED is powered off.
- **Recovery:**
 - If due to **low battery**, the trap **checks the battery about once an hour on its own** and recovers automatically once voltage is back (for example after solar charging) — or **replace/recharge** the battery to bring it back sooner.
 - If due to a **power button press**, the user must **press the power button to wake the device**.

Note: In hibernation mode, **OcuTrap cannot receive messages or send notifications**.

Power Mode Transitions

Automatic Transitions:

- **Normal Power Mode** → **Low Power Idle Mode** (after inactivity).
- **Low Power Idle Mode** → **Low Power Armed Mode** (when armed).
- **Armed Sleep Offline** → **Cloud Check-in** (every 20 minutes).

- **Any Mode** → **Hibernation** (if low battery).

User-Controlled Transitions:

- **Power Button Press:** Can wake the device from hibernation.
- **Sending a Command:** Resets the idle timer and returns to normal power mode.

Battery & Power Alerts

To ensure users are aware of power status, **OcuTrap sends battery warnings** at:

- **20% Battery** – Low battery warning.
- **10% Battery** – Critical battery warning.
- **Hibernation** – Final alert before shutdown.

These alerts help prevent unexpected downtime and allow users to take action before the device powers off.

Summary Table

Power Mode	Description	LED Status	Can Receive Commands?	Can Send Data?
Normal Power Mode	Full power, user interaction	Full brightness	✓ Yes	✓ Yes
Low Power Idle Mode	Reduced power while waiting	Dimmed	✓ Yes	✓ Yes
Low Power Armed Mode	Trap is armed, waiting	Dimmed	✓ Yes	✓ Yes
Sleep Mode	Deep sleep, most systems off	Off	✓ Yes (wakes on command)	✓ Yes (when awake)
Armed Sleep Offline	Periodic check-ins, no internet in between	Flashing (3s)	✗ No (Between check-ins)	✓ Yes (During check-ins)
Hibernation	Fully powered down, no communication	Off	✗ No	✗ No

Miscellaneous

This section covers additional topics and frequently asked questions that don't fit into other categories.

Topics in This Section

- [Password Policy for Users](#) — Requirements and best practices for account passwords

Other Helpful Resources

Looking for something specific? Check these related sections:

- [Common Questions](#) — General FAQ covering a wide range of topics
- [Troubleshooting](#) — Solutions for common issues
- [Support](#) — Contact information and help resources

Password Policy for Users

Who this applies to

- All customers and internal users who sign in with an email and password.

Sign in basics

- Your username is your email address.
- OcuTrap uses a standard email and password sign in. There is no additional authentication at this time.

Password requirements

- 10 or more characters
- No required mix of numbers or symbols. We check real password strength instead.
- Common passwords and passwords found in known data breaches are not allowed.
- Do not reuse a password that you use on other sites.

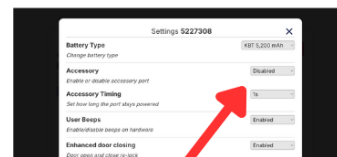
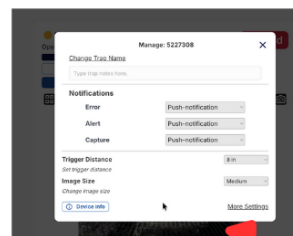
How to create a strong password

- Use a passphrase with several random words. Example:
river tulip taxi folder cloud
- Avoid personal info like names, addresses, or dates.
- Use a password manager to generate and store unique passwords.

Accessory Port

Modifying Settings: Enable, Disable, and Adjust

Learn how to manage your settings efficiently by enabling, disabling, or altering them as needed.

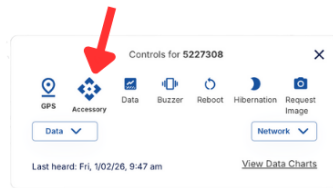


To use the button, simply click it to power the accessory.

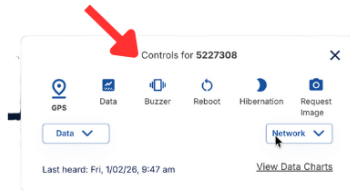


Click Controls Button

Accessory shown (enabled)



Accessory hidden (disabled)



The Accessory feature allows you to remotely power an external device connected to your OcuTrap, such as a buzzer, motor, solenoid, or other low-voltage accessory. Power is switched directly by the OcuTrap and is intended for short, controlled activations.

The accessory system consists of:

- A software-controlled **Accessory button** in the Controls menu
- A physical **12V accessory port** located on the OcuTrap pod
- Internal switching circuitry rated for up to **3.0A continuous current**

Accessory Button Behavior

The Accessory button appears in the **Controls** panel when the accessory port is enabled.

When the button is visible

- The accessory port is enabled in **Settings**
- The device is online and able to receive commands

When the button disappears

- The accessory port is disabled in **Settings**
- This is expected behavior and helps prevent accidental activation

If you do not see the Accessory button, check that **Accessory = Enabled** in the device Settings -> More Settings menu.

Physical Port Location

The accessory port is located at the **top of the OcuTrap pod**.

- Output voltage: **12V DC**
- Maximum continuous current: **3.0A**
- Output type: Switched power controlled by OcuTrap firmware

This port is intended only for powering external accessories. It does not accept power input.

Electrical Specifications

Parameter	Value
Output Voltage	12V DC
Max Continuous Current	3.0A
Default State	OFF

Usage Guidelines

Polarity Sensitive

This port is **not reversible**.

- **Pin 1:** Switched Ground
- **Pin 2:** +12V Output

Always verify polarity before connecting an accessory. Incorrect wiring may damage the connected device or the OcuTrap.

Unidirectional Power Only

This port is designed **exclusively to output power**.

Do **not**:

- Back-feed voltage into the port
- Connect an external power supply to the accessory pins

Back-feeding power can permanently damage the trap.

Load Requirements

- Do not exceed **3.0A continuous current**
- High-current loads may cause overheating or failure
- Short activation times are recommended for power-hungry accessories

If your accessory requires more current, use an external relay or driver circuit.

Motors and Solenoids

For motors, solenoids, or relays, use a **relay or driver circuit** rated for your accessory. Follow the accessory manufacturer's wiring instructions.

Failure to use proper wiring may damage the accessory or the trap.

Default OFF State

The accessory port stays **OFF during startup** and turns **OFF if the control signal is lost**, so accessories do not activate unexpectedly.

Common Use Cases

- External buzzers
- Solenoids or latches
- Low-power motors
- Custom accessories using the OcuTrap accessory port

Potential Automation Applications

The Accessory Port enables automation and remote activation for various external devices:

1. **Rebaiter / Feeder** – Automatically dispense bait at specific intervals to keep the trap effective longer.
2. **Vaccine Feeder** – Deliver oral vaccines to target animals, aiding in disease control efforts.
3. **Lure Dispenser** – Release scent-based attractants to increase trapping efficiency for specific species.

Always test new accessories with short activations before regular use.

Important Safety Notes

Do Not Use the Accessory and Main Door Motor Simultaneously

- The accessory port and the main door motor should not be activated at the same time because both draw power from the same 12V battery.
- The trap door motor can momentarily draw up to 5A, and if an accessory is also in use, it can exceed the power supply limits.
- **Result:** Excessive current draw may cause:
 - Device shutdown due to voltage drop
 - Overheating and potential failure of the power circuit
 - Reduced battery life

Accessory Shutdown When Door Motor is Operated

If the door motor is moved to an open or closed position while the accessory is running, the accessory will automatically power off. This behavior is an intentional safety feature designed to prevent potential conflicts between the door mechanism and the accessory. To avoid an unexpected shutdown, always ensure that the accessory is stopped before adjusting the door motor.

Timing Conflicts

- If the trap door is operating, avoid triggering the accessory at the same time.

- If using an automated system, set a delay between door operation and accessory activation in the app settings.
-

Troubleshooting

Accessory button missing

- Confirm the accessory port is enabled in Settings
- Refresh the page after changing settings

Accessory does not power on

- Verify wiring polarity
- Confirm current draw is below 3.0A
- Check that the device is online

Device resets or behaves unexpectedly

- Check that motors or solenoids are wired with a proper relay or driver circuit
 - Check for short circuits or overcurrent conditions
-

If you have questions about a specific accessory or need help validating your setup, contact support@ocutrap.com before deployment.

Troubleshooting

Trap Offline or Won't Connect

If your trap shows **offline**, will not connect, or does not respond to commands, the most common causes are **low battery**, **hibernation**, a **loose battery connection**, **weak cellular signal**, or the trap **still trying to connect**.

OcuTrap connects primarily through **4G LTE cellular service**. The trap does **not** need local Wi-Fi for normal operation. Poor cellular coverage can prevent the trap from connecting or receiving commands.

The **LED light** is the fastest way to see what the trap is doing. Work through the steps below in order.

Not sure what the light means? Use the [interactive LED diagnostic](#) — tap the color you see, then how it's blinking, and it tells you exactly what's happening and what to do next.

Quick Checklist

1. Make sure the battery is charged.
2. Unplug and reconnect the yellow battery connector.
3. Press the **power button once** to wake the trap.
4. Check the **LED color or blink pattern**.
5. Move the trap to an area with better cellular signal if needed.
6. Refresh the app or dashboard and check the trap's **Last Activity**.
7. If still offline, send Support the **LED pattern**, **Trap ID**, and a **screenshot of the error**.

Step 1: Check the Battery

A low or disconnected battery is one of the most common reasons a trap appears offline.

1. **Disconnect and reconnect** the yellow battery connector.
2. Make sure the connector is **fully seated** — it should click into place without forcing.
3. If the battery may be low, charge it using the **charger that came with your trap**.
 - The charger light turns **red** while charging and **green** when charged.
4. A very low battery can cause the trap to shut down or fail to connect.

After reconnecting the battery, **press the power button once** and watch the LED.

For more on battery care and charging, see the [Battery FAQ](#).

Step 2: Wake the Trap From Hibernation

If the trap has been **unarmed and idle**, it may have entered **hibernation** to save power. In hibernation:

- There may be **no LED**.
- The trap **cannot send notifications** or **receive commands** from the app.

To wake the trap:

1. Press the **power button once**.
2. Wait a few minutes for the trap to reconnect.

Note: If the trap is **armed**, it may use an **offline or sleep mode** and check in with the cloud periodically instead of staying connected all the time. Allow time for the next check-in before assuming the trap is fully offline.

If the trap **immediately powers down again** after you press the power button, the battery may be too low. Charge or replace the battery before trying again.

For a deeper explanation of power states, see [Power Modes](#).

Step 3: Read the LED Status

Use the table below to interpret what the trap is doing. If the LED never turns on after a charged battery is connected and the power button is pressed, contact [OcuTrap Support](#).

LED Pattern	What It Usually Means	What To Do
Breathing cyan	Connected and online	Refresh the app and try the command again
Fast blinking cyan	Connecting to the cloud	Wait a few minutes
Blinking green	Looking for cellular/internet connection	Move to better cellular coverage
Fast blinking blue	Trying to join the cellular network and failing	Move to better cellular coverage. If it keeps blinking blue quickly, contact Support
Blinking magenta	Firmware update or safe mode activity	Leave powered on and wait
Rapid red blinks	Powering down — the power button is being held	Release the power button within ~3 seconds to cancel, or let it finish and press power again to restart
Solid red during boot	Battery too low at startup	Charge or replace the battery
No light	Powered off, hibernating, no battery, or failed boot	Reconnect battery and press power button

For a full list of LED patterns — including door and arm/unarm indicators — see the [LED Guide](#).

Step 4: Check Cellular Coverage

OcuTrap depends on **cellular signal** to send and receive commands. Metal buildings, garages, basements, dense structures, and remote areas can weaken or block signal.

If the LED is **blinking green for a long time**, the trap may not have enough cellular coverage where it is placed.

1. Move the trap **outdoors** or to a more open area.
2. Give it a few minutes to search for signal and reconnect.
3. The trap may reconnect automatically once signal improves.

For antenna checks, placement and height fixes, and how long to wait before escalating, see [Improving a Weak Cellular Signal](#).

Fast blinking blue means the trap is trying to join the cellular network and cannot. Move it to better coverage and wait 10 minutes. If it is still blinking blue quickly, that is not something you can fix in the field. Contact [OcuTrap Support](#) with your Trap ID.

Step 5: Check the App or Dashboard

1. Confirm the trap **appears in your account**.
2. Open the trap **settings** or **control panel**.
3. Check **Last Activity** or last heard time.
4. Tap **refresh** or **request latest data** if that option is available.
5. Confirm you are viewing the **correct Trap ID** (the serial number from the POD label, shown in the app after registration).

If the trap was recently added, make sure the **Trap ID** in the app matches the **serial number** on the label inside the POD. See [Adding a trap to your account](#).

Step 6: Inspect Connections

1. Make sure the **yellow battery connector** is secure.
2. Make sure the **POD is closed and latched**.
3. If instructed by Support, check that the **antenna connections** are seated.
4. Do **not** force connectors or open internal components unless Support instructs you to.

Step 7: When Commands Do Not Reach the Trap

If the trap is **offline**, **hibernating**, or **between check-ins**, commands from the app may fail or show an error message.

Recommended actions:

1. **Wake the trap** with the power button.
2. Wait for the LED to become **breathing cyan**.
3. **Retry the command**.
4. If the trap is **armed and offline**, allow time for the **next check-in** before trying again.

For more on command failures specifically, see [Trap Not Sending Commands](#).

What To Send OcuTrap Support

If the issue continues, email support@ocutrap.com with as much of the following as you can:

- **Trap ID**
- **Screenshot** of the app error message
- **LED color or pattern** (or note if there is **no LED at all**)
- Whether the battery was **recently charged**
- **Approximate location type** — for example: indoors, garage, field, metal building, wooded area
- **Last Activity** time shown in the app
- Any recent **weather**, **battery change**, or **impact/transport**

Safety Note

Before handling the trap, keep hands and fingers **clear of the door path**. The door can close quickly when the trap reconnects or receives a command.

Still Offline?

If the trap remains offline after checking the battery, waking the device, and confirming cellular coverage, contact [OcuTrap Support](#) with the details above so we can review the device status and help determine the next step.

Improving a Weak Cellular Signal

Weak coverage is the most common reason a trap checks in late or drops offline in the field. Most of it is fixable on site.

How the trap connects

The trap connects over 4G LTE using multiple nationwide networks, not just one carrier. It picks whichever network has the best usable signal at your site, and it switches automatically if that network fails.

Its radio is a long-range, low-power type built for remote equipment. It can hold a connection in places where a phone shows no bars. The reverse is also true, so your phone's signal bars are not a reliable guide to the trap's coverage either way.

What weak signal looks like

- Long stretches of blinking green LED, which means the trap is still searching for a network.
- Photos and check-ins arriving late.
- The trap showing offline between check-ins.
- Faster battery drain. The radio works harder in weak signal.

Not sure what the light means? See the [LED Guide](#).

What to do at the trap site

1. **Check the antenna.** Make sure the antenna cap and connections are snug and the antenna points straight up.
2. **Move the trap a few feet.** Even a small move toward open sky can make a big difference. Keep it away from metal roofs, siding, vehicles, and tanks, and out of dips and low spots.
3. **Raise it.** Height helps more than anything else. Getting the trap above nearby brush or clutter often restores a connection.
4. **Power cycle once.** Turn the trap off, wait 30 seconds, turn it back on. This makes the cellular module start a fresh network search from scratch.

5. **Then leave it alone for up to an hour.** In weak signal the trap rotates through every available network and retries on its own, and a full search cycle takes time. Repeated power cycling restarts that search from the beginning and makes things worse, not better.
6. **Still offline after an hour?** Contact [OcuTrap Support](#) and describe the site: terrain, nearby buildings, how remote it is. Support can review the trap's signal history and tell weak coverage apart from a hardware fault, and can advise on options for sites that are permanently weak.

Power cycle once, then wait. Do not power cycle repeatedly.

Trapping in weak-signal areas

An armed trap does not need continuous signal.

- It stays armed and keeps monitoring while disconnected.
- It checks in about every 20 minutes.
- It reports any capture at its next check-in.
- You can arm, unarm, and open the trap with the buttons on the trap, with no signal at all.

See [Using the Buttons on the Trap](#) and [Connectivity & Coverage](#).

See also

- [Trap Offline or Won't Connect](#): the full offline checklist.
- [Connectivity & Coverage](#): how the trap stays connected.
- [Using the Buttons on the Trap](#): running the trap with no signal.
- [Power Modes](#): check-in cycles and hibernation.

Common Issues

This guide covers frequently encountered issues and their solutions based on how OcuTrap operates.

Trap Won't Arm

If you're unable to arm your trap, check the following:

Door Must Be Fully Open

The trap **requires the door to be fully open** before arming. This is a safety feature to ensure proper capture operation.

Solution:

1. Open the OcuTrap app
2. Tap the **Open** button and wait for the door to fully open
3. Check that the light shows **blue** (unarmed and open) — see the [LED Guide](#)
4. Try arming again

Obstruction Detected

Before arming, the trap performs an **obstruction check** to ensure the capture zone is clear. If something is blocking the sensor, arming will fail.

Solution:

1. Check that nothing is in front of the sensor inside the trap
2. Clear any debris, leaves, or objects from the trap interior
3. Ensure the sensor window is clean
4. Wait for 5+ distance readings to confirm the zone is clear
5. Try arming again

Sensor blocked or dirty

The trap uses a **warn-and-arm** approach: if the POD lens looks blocked or dirty, the trap **still arms** but sends a warning so you know to clean it:

- Arm: **Trap armed. Check camera and clean sensor if blocked.**
- Scout: **Scout on. Check camera and clean sensor if blocked.**

Clean the POD lens and clear the sensor path when you see this. The trap keeps working, but a dirty lens can affect detection — clean it as soon as you can.

A real object physically blocking the trap interior is different: arming is **blocked** with **Remove object at <distance> first**. Remove the object and arm again.

See [Distance Limits, Sensor Alerts & Errors](#) for capture distance presets and other arming errors.

Sensor Error (Blocks Arming)

If the distance sensor can't see at all, arming is blocked with one of two errors:

- **Sensor blocked or dirty. Clean sensor window, then power-cycle.** — the sensor is healthy but can't see through the POD lens. Usually condensation or grime on the lens; overnight dew is a common cause and clears as the day warms.
- **Sensor fault. Power-cycle the trap.** — the sensor did not respond to its self-check. Traps on firmware v1061 or earlier also show this message for the blocked/dirty case above.

Solution:

1. Clean the POD lens with a dry, soft cloth
2. Power-cycle the trap
3. Arm again — contact support if the error persists with a clean lens

Motor Connectivity Issue

The trap tests motor connectivity before arming. If the motor doesn't respond, arming will fail.

Solution:

1. Check the motor connector is securely attached
 2. See [Motor Connector Tightness Check](#)
 3. Verify the motor cable isn't damaged
 4. If red and black internal wires are visible at the connector, see [Wire Exposed](#)
 5. Contact support if the issue persists
-

False Triggers / Unwanted Captures

OcuTrap has sophisticated false-trigger prevention, but environmental factors can sometimes cause issues.

Rain or Debris Triggering

Heavy rain or debris falling through the trap can sometimes trigger captures.

How OcuTrap Prevents This:

- Requires **several steady readings in a row** before closing the door
- **Ignores splashy or erratic movement** (such as rain or blowing debris)
- **Ignores weak or unreliable readings** from a dirty or obstructed sensor window

If you're still getting false triggers:

1. **Decrease** the **Capture Distance** setting (smaller = animal must be closer before the door closes)
2. Ensure the trap is positioned to minimize rain entry
3. Check that the sensor window is clean and undamaged
4. Consider repositioning the trap to a more sheltered location

Capture Distance Too Sensitive

If the trap triggers before animals are fully inside:

Solution:

1. Go to **Settings** → **More Settings**
 2. Decrease the **Capture Distance** value (smaller = animal must be closer)
 3. Default is **8 in** — try **6 in** or **7 in** for more selective triggering
-

GPS Not Updating

GPS updates are battery-optimized and may not update as frequently as expected.

Understanding GPS Behavior

- **Default interval:** Every 8 hours (not real-time)
- **First boot delay:** 5-minute delay before first GPS acquisition
- **Capture updates:** GPS automatically updates when a capture occurs

GPS Shows Old Location

Solution:

1. Wait for the next scheduled update (check your GPS Interval setting)
2. Request a manual update: in the Trap Controls bar, tap **Location**
3. Ensure GPS is not disabled in settings

No GPS Fix Available

Solution:

1. Ensure the trap is outdoors with a clear view of the sky
 2. Move away from buildings, dense tree cover, or metal structures
 3. Allow up to 3 minutes for the first fix after power-on
 4. Check that GPS is enabled in settings
 5. If problems persist, contact support for GPS troubleshooting
-

Camera Issues

Dark or Black Images

Possible Causes:

- Camera not detecting darkness correctly
- IR LEDs not activating

Solution:

1. Check **Dark Lux Threshold** setting — night vision and IR activate when light falls **below** this value, so **increase** it to enable them earlier (see [Camera](#))
2. Increase **Minimum IR Brightness** setting
3. Ensure the IR LED window is clean
4. Verify the camera lens is not blocked or dirty

Overexposed / Washed Out Images

Solution:

1. Decrease **Maximum IR Brightness** setting
2. Adjust image cropping to remove reflective areas
3. Reposition the trap to reduce direct reflections

Images Not Sending

Possible Causes:

- Poor cellular signal
- Large image size taking too long to transfer

Solution:

1. Check cellular connectivity (LED should be breathing cyan when connected)
 2. Reduce **Camera Quality** setting (1-2 for faster transfer)
 3. Move trap to an area with better cellular coverage
 4. Wait — high-quality photos can take several minutes to upload, especially on a weak cellular connection
-

Connectivity Issues

Trap Shows "Offline"

For a step-by-step field guide — battery, hibernation, LED patterns, cellular coverage, and what to send Support — see [**Trap Offline or Won't Connect**](#).

Automatic reconnection: If the trap loses connection, it will try to reconnect on its own. This can take up to an hour. Leave it powered on in an area with decent cellular coverage and check back later.

If the trap stays offline after the steps in the guide above, contact support.

Commands Not Reaching Trap

See [Trap Not Sending Commands](#) for detailed troubleshooting.

Battery Issues

Battery Draining Quickly

Common Causes:

- Poor cellular signal (device uses more power searching)
- GPS interval set too frequently
- Camera timelapse interval set too short
- Cold temperatures reduce battery capacity

Solution:

1. Deploy in areas with good cellular coverage
2. Increase GPS Interval (8+ hours recommended)
3. Increase Camera Time Lapse interval (6+ hours recommended)
4. In cold weather, expect reduced battery life
5. Keep firmware updated (includes battery optimizations)

Trap Keeps Hibernating

If the trap enters hibernation unexpectedly:

1. **Check battery level** — the trap hibernates when the battery is critically low
 2. **Charge or replace the battery**
 3. **Verify the correct Battery Type** is selected in settings
 4. If the battery is charged but hibernation persists, the battery may be damaged
-

Door Issues

Door Won't Open or Close

Solution:

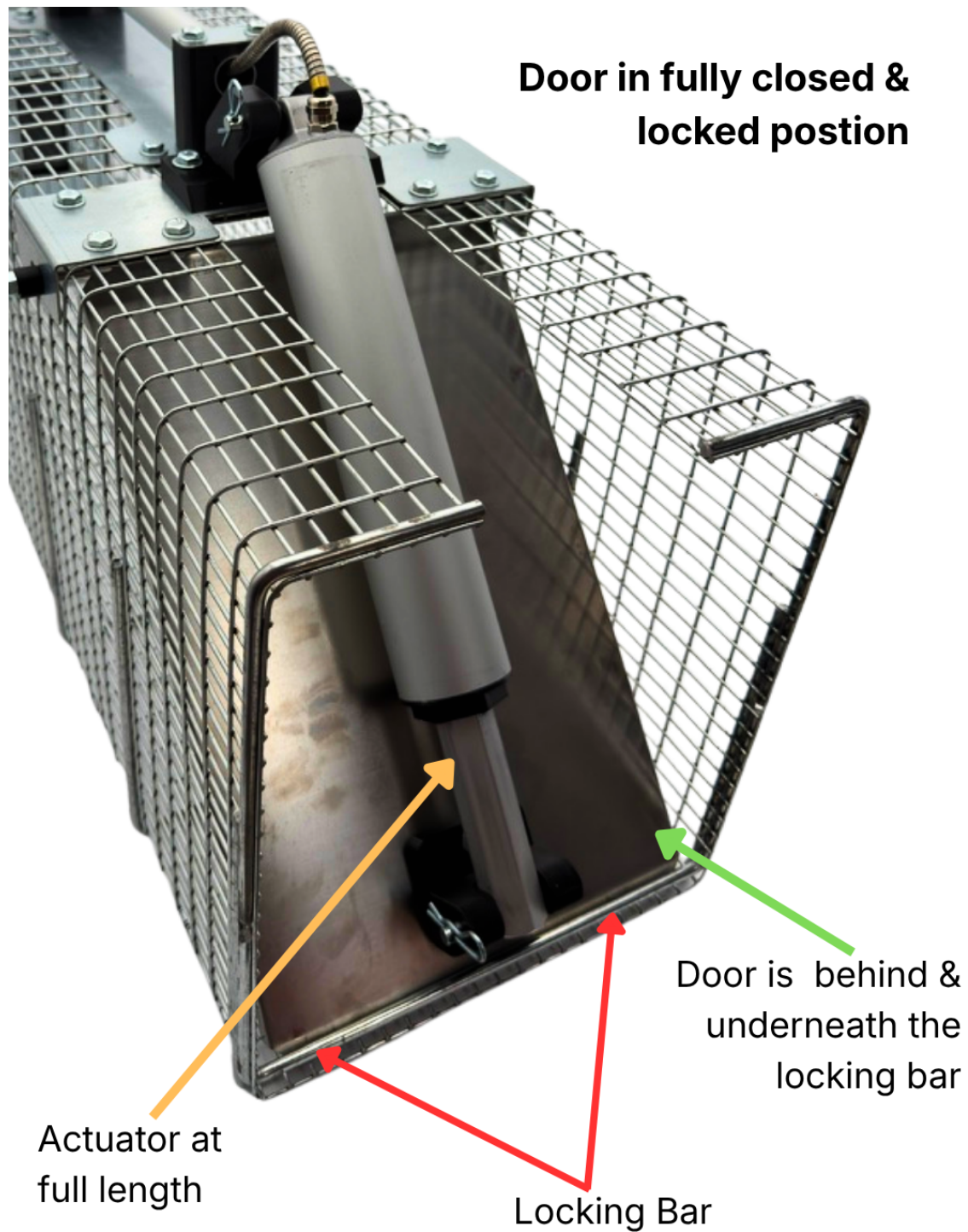
1. Check motor connector is securely attached
2. If red and black internal wires are visible at the connector, see [Wire Exposed](#)
3. Verify no physical obstruction is blocking the door
4. Check battery level — door operation requires adequate power

5. Use the manual door control: press the **User Button** once, then press again and **hold ~5 seconds** (about 7 seconds total before the door moves)
6. Check for a sensor-fault indicator (3 orange flashes)

Door Not Latching Behind the Locking Bar

When the door closes correctly, it sits **behind and underneath the locking bar**, with the actuator extended to its full length. If the door comes to rest *in front of* the locking bar, the bar cannot hold the door down — a captured animal can push from the inside and bend the door upward, creating enough gap to escape.

What "fully closed and locked" looks like:



- **Actuator** is at its **full length** (fully extended).
- **Door** is **behind and underneath the locking bar** along its entire width — not resting on top of or in front of the bar.

- The locking bar runs across the door opening and physically blocks the door from lifting.

How to verify (every trapping session):

1. From the app, tap **Close** and wait for the door to fully close.
2. Look at the door from the front of the trap.
3. Confirm the door edge is *tucked under* the locking bar across the full width — not pinched on top of it or sitting outside it.
4. Gently try to lift the door by hand. It should not move; the locking bar should stop it within a small fraction of an inch.

If the door is on top of or in front of the locking bar:

1. Tap **Open**, wait for the door to fully retract, then tap **Close** again.
2. Check that **Enhanced Door Closing** is on (Settings → Door). It is on by default. It re-seats the door under the locking rod after every close. It does not confirm the lock, so keep checking the door at the trap when a capture matters.
3. Inspect the door track and locking bar area for debris (dirt, vegetation, ice).
4. Check that the door is not bent. A previously bent door may not seat correctly even when the mechanism works. Contact support if the door edge is deformed.

Why it matters: A door that is not behind the locking bar may not prevent an animal from escaping.

Door Opens/Closes Slowly

Possible Causes:

- Low battery
- Motor wear
- Mechanical obstruction

Solution:

1. Charge the battery fully
2. Check for debris in the door track
3. Contact support if the issue persists

LED Indicators

No LED / Trap Appears Dead

Solution:

1. Press the power button to wake from hibernation
2. Charge the battery — the trap may have auto-hibernated due to low power
3. Check battery connections
4. If battery is charged and power button doesn't respond, contact support

Rapid Red Blinking

Rapid red blinking means the trap is **powering down** because the power button is being held — it is **not** an error code.

Solution:

1. If you didn't mean to power off, **release the power button within about 3 seconds** to cancel the shutdown.
2. If it finishes shutting down, the LED goes **solid red** and the trap powers off. Press the power button again to turn it back on.
3. Genuine faults show as brief flash bursts instead: **3 orange flashes** (sensor error — clean the POD lens and power-cycle) or **5 magenta flashes** (data error). If a fault repeats, contact support.

For LED status meanings, see the [LED Guide](#).

Tilt / Movement Alerts

Unexpected Tilt Alerts

The trap sends tilt alerts when not level during armed mode.

Solution:

1. Ensure the trap is placed on level ground
 2. Check that the trap is stable and not shifting
 3. Only one tilt alert is sent per arming session to prevent spam
-

Still Need Help?

If you've tried the solutions above and still have issues:

1. [Contact Support](#) with details about your issue
2. Include: trap serial number, battery voltage, LED status, and steps already tried

Trap Not Sending Commands

If your OcuTrap is not responding to commands and is displaying error codes, it may have entered hibernation mode or lost connection.

When you send a command, the app shows its live status — **Sending...**, then **confirmed** once the trap acknowledges it, or a failure message with the device's error if something went wrong — so you can see exactly what happened.

For a full step-by-step guide when the trap shows offline or will not connect, see [Trap Offline or Won't Connect](#).

Possible Causes

1. **Sleep Mode** – When **unarmed and idle**, the trap drops into a low-power sleep after a few minutes to save battery. This is normal — it still wakes for commands on its next check-in, or press the power button to wake it immediately.
2. **No Battery Connection** – Ensure the battery is properly connected and charged. A loose or depleted battery will prevent the trap from operating.
3. **No Trap Online** – If the trap is not showing as online, it may not be connected to the network.
4. **Poor Cellular Communication** – Weak signal strength can prevent the trap from sending or receiving commands.

Solutions

Wake the Trap from Hibernation

- Press the **power button** (the left-most button) to wake up the trap.
- Wait for the LED to show **breathing cyan** before retrying your command.

- If the trap is **unarmed and idle**, a low-power sleep is expected — commands are picked up at the next check-in. Full hibernation only happens on very low battery or a long power-button press (see [Power Modes](#)).

Check Battery Connection

- Verify that the battery is properly seated and securely connected.
- Check the battery charge level and recharge or replace if necessary.

Verify Network Connectivity

- Check if the trap appears online in the app or dashboard.
- Move the trap to an area with better cellular reception if the signal is weak.

Additional Help

If the issue persists after trying these steps, please contact support for further assistance.

Motor-to-Pin Connection Too Tight

Issue

When attaching the motor to the bracket:

- The **pin and clevis** may not fit easily into the motor connector.
- This can cause frustration during setup and may appear as though the parts are misaligned or stuck.

Example scenario:



Cause

This issue is usually due to the **motor being fully retracted** at the time of assembly. In its fully retracted state, the motor's position prevents easy insertion of the clevis and pin.

Solution

To solve this:

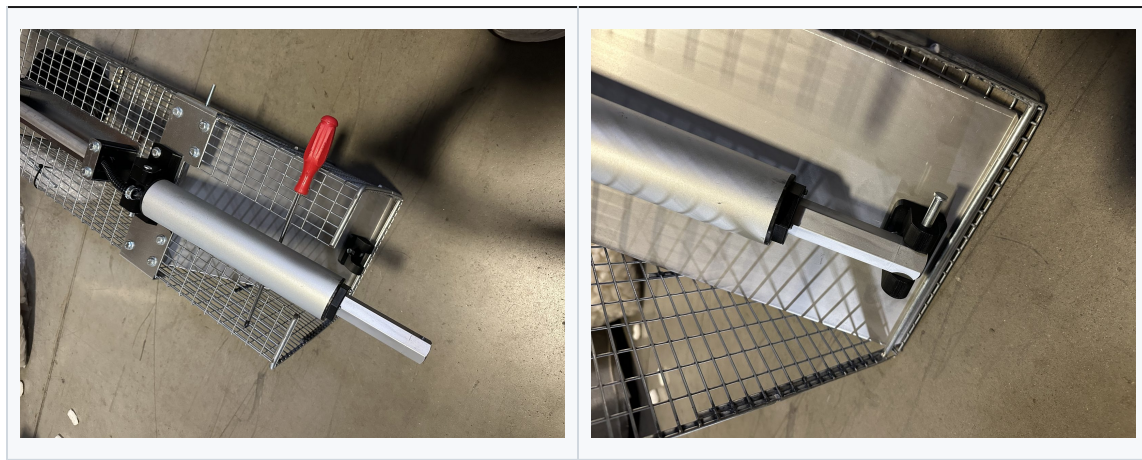
1. **Power on the OcuTrap.**
2. Using the **app** or the **buttons inside the POD**, press the "**Close**" button to extend the motor slightly.
 - This will expand the motor outward, creating enough clearance for the pin and clevis to fit properly.
3. **Prop up the motor** to allow it room to extend fully (see images below).



Step-by-Step

Step	Action
1	Ensure the OcuTrap is powered on and motor is plugged in.
2	Use the app or POD controls to press the Close button, extending the motor outward.
3	Hold or prop up the motor (lift it slightly) to give it clearance to move.
4	Once extended, let the door down all the way and slide it forward to reposition.
5	Unplug the motor to prevent it from moving unexpectedly.
6	Insert the clevis and pin into the motor connector easily.

Photos for reference:



Tip

- Always make sure the **trap door is fully lowered** before attempting final assembly of the motor to the bracket.
- If the motor is already fully extended, no further action is needed.

Condensation on the Camera

1. How to Spot the Issue

Symptom	Likely Cause	Severity
Foggy or “milky” images that clear after a few minutes	External condensation —morning/evening temperature swings	Low
Persistent haze or water beads inside the lens window	Internal moisture —air leak at the lens gasket or loose accessory port	Medium
Visible droplets inside the device	Water ingress —damaged seal or submerged trap	High

2. Immediate Fix (10 min)

1. Power down & open the POD

- Tap **Settings ► Power Off** or hold the left-most button until the LEDs go dark.
- Remove the battery pack and disconnect the accessory cable (if attached).

2. Wipe the outside glass

Use a microfiber cloth or lens wipe. If fogging disappears, the issue was external.

3. Inspect the lens seal

- Look for debris, hair, or grit around the rubber gasket.
- Gently clean the seal with isopropyl alcohol and a lint-free swab.

4. Dry packs save the day

Place a fresh silica gel pack inside the trap pod before closing.

3. Deep-Dry Procedure (24–48 hrs)

If internal moisture persists:

1. Remove the **battery**
2. Leave the POD cracked open in a warm, ventilated spot for **24 hrs** —or—
Seal the POD in a zipper bag with **desiccant** packs for **12–18 hrs**.
3. Re-assemble, close the POD, and request an image to confirm clarity.

4. Prevention Checklist

- **Gasket care** – Lightly coat the rubber seal with silicone grease every 6 months.
 - **Tight hardware** – Finger-tighten the antenna and accessory caps after each service visit.
 - **Avoid submersion** – OcuTrap R1 is weather-sealed, but not rated for full underwater exposure.
-

5. Still Seeing Haze? We're Here to Help.

1. Take **two clear photos** of the issue: one of the lens/window and one of the interior POD.
2. Email support@ocutrap.com with the photos, trap id, and a brief description.
3. Our technicians will review your case and advise the next step — whether the issue is covered under warranty, repairable, or best resolved with a replacement or upgrade.

For current repair terms, turnaround times, and any service fees, **contact support** — they'll confirm what applies to your trap based on its warranty status and condition.

Motor Connector Tightness Check

► **This page has a video.** Watch it online at docs.ocutrap.com.

Symptoms

- Motor does not move at all
- Door does not open or close when commanded
- Motor can be heard engaging but produces no motion
- Intermittent operation after handling or transport

Cause

The motor is **not tightened enough**.

If the motor mounting hardware is too loose, the motor shaft does not stay properly aligned under load. This prevents effective torque transfer and can cause the motor to slip or fail to engage.



Correct Gap Specification

The motor must be tightened to leave a small, controlled gap.

- **Required gap:** approximately **0.15 to 0.20 inches**
- Less than this can cause motor electronics not to connect properly
- More than this usually means the motor is too loose

A gap larger than 0.20 inches is a common cause of the motor not operating.

How to Check

1. Inspect the motor mounting location.
2. Verify the motor is not loose or able to shift by hand.
3. Measure the gap between the motor and the mounting surface.

4. Confirm the gap is within the 0.15 to 0.20 inch range.

How to Fix

1. Tighten the motor mounting hardware gradually.
2. Stop tightening once the gap is within 0.15 to 0.20 inches.
3. Ensure the motor is firmly secured and cannot move under hand pressure.
4. Do not overtighten past this range.

After Adjustment

After tightening the motor and setting the correct gap, try controlling the door once again.

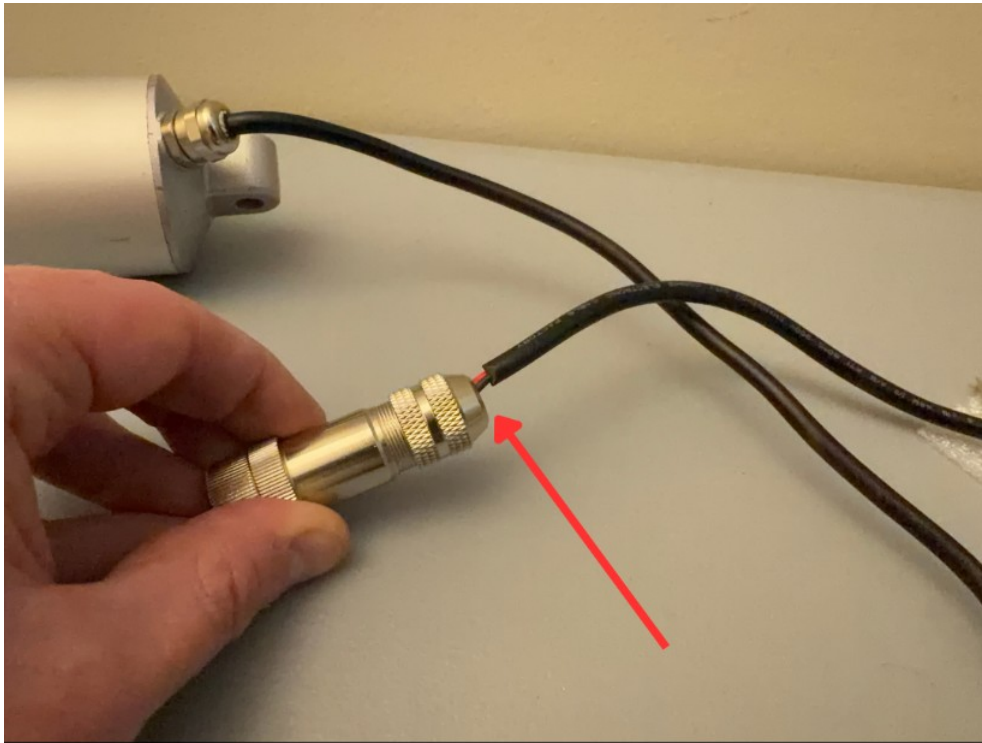
If the motor still does not operate after this adjustment, disconnect and reconnect the motor connector and repeat the steps. If it still fails, contact support@ocutrap.com with your Trap ID.



Wire Exposed

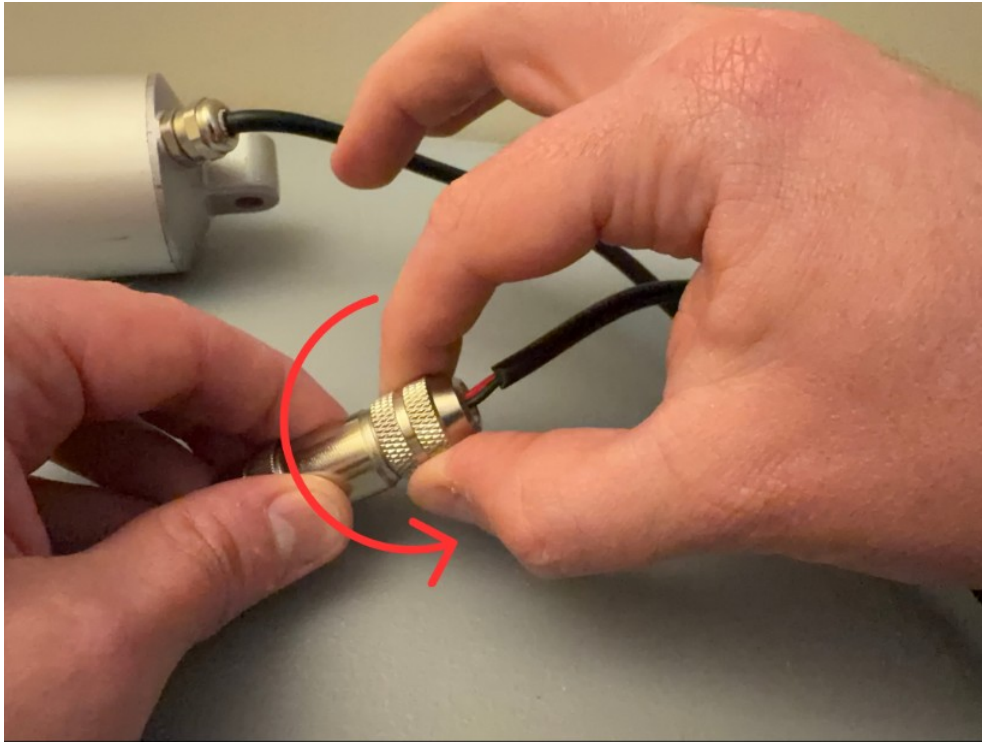
What You Are Seeing

Sometimes the smaller internal wires (red and black) are visible where the cable enters the metal connector on the motor cable. This is usually not a big deal, but over time it can reduce waterproofing at that connection.

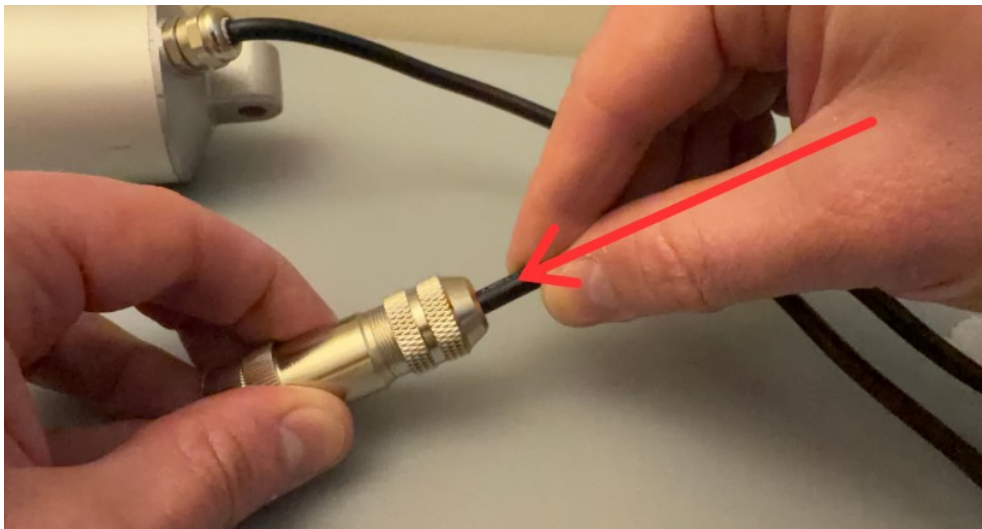


How to Fix

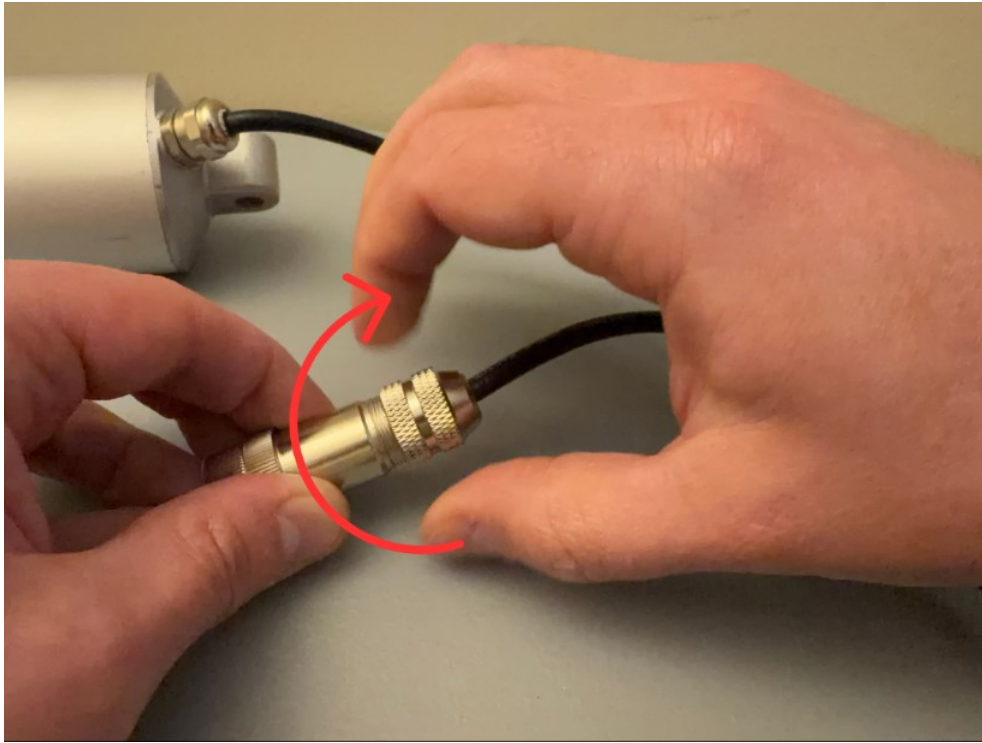
1. **Loosen the connector.** Hold the smooth center base with one hand and rotate the knurled top part **counter-clockwise** until the cable is loose.



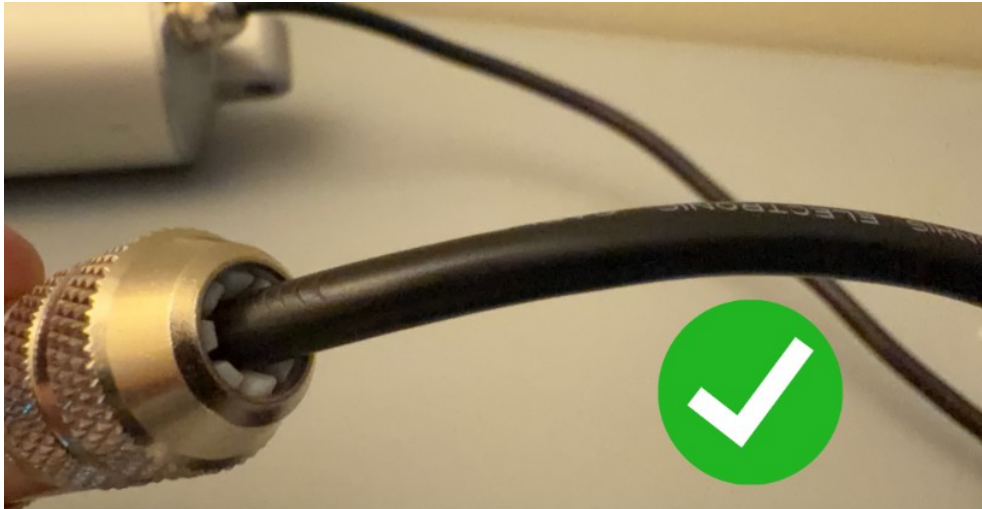
1. **Push the cable in.** Push the cable into the connector until the red and black wires are no longer exposed, and a bit farther to improve the waterproof seal.



1. **Tighten the connector.** While keeping light pressure on the cable so it stays seated, rotate the top part **clockwise** to tighten the connector.



1. **Check the result.** The cable should sit fully inside the connector with no internal wires visible.



Can't Sign In to Your Account

Sign-in problems almost always come down to one of a few causes. Find the section below that matches what you see. Your email address is your username, and the same email and password work on the web app at app.ocutrap.com and in the mobile app.

Forgot Your Password

Reset it from the email we send you:

1. Go to app.ocutrap.com and click **Forgot password?**
2. Enter your email and click **Send Reset Code**.
3. Open the email and click **Reset Password**. The page opens headed **Choose a new password**.
4. Enter your new password, confirm it, and submit. When you see **Password reset complete**, sign in with your new password.

If your mail app strips the button, the email also carries a reset code. Click **Enter Reset Code** in the app and paste it in. The code is **long** (32 characters of mixed letters and numbers) and **case-sensitive**, so paste it rather than typing it.

Your new password needs at least 8 characters, a number, and a special character.

Resetting Password

Password Policy for Users

Reset Code Didn't Arrive

Codes usually land within a minute or two. If yours has not:

1. Check your **spam or junk folder**, and search your inbox for "OcuTrap".
2. Confirm you entered the **email you registered with**. Codes only send to addresses that have an OcuTrap account. If the app says "Unable to send reset email", the address you entered likely does not match an account.
3. On the reset screen, click **Didn't receive a code? Send again**, then use the newest code from your inbox.
4. On a work email? Company mail filters sometimes hold automated messages. Ask your IT team to allow mail from OcuTrap.

Still nothing after a few tries? Email support@ocutrap.com and we can help from our side.

Sign-In Isn't Working

Match what you see on the sign-in page:

- **"The email or password you entered is incorrect."** Check for typos and caps lock. Click the eye icon in the password field to see what you typed. If it still fails, reset your password using the steps above.
- **"Too many attempts. Please wait a moment and try again."** Sign-in is briefly limited after repeated failures. Wait a few minutes, then try once.
- **A verification code screen appears.** Some accounts confirm their email before signing in. Enter the code we emailed you and click **Verify and continue**.
- **The form asks for your first and last name.** That is the sign-up form. Click **Sign in instead** at the bottom to get back to sign-in.
- **You deleted your account.** Account deletion is permanent and the old sign-in will not work. You would need to create a new account.

Passwords stay in sync between the web and mobile apps, so a password that works on one works on the other.

Account Deletion

Lost Access to Your Email

Your email address is your OcuTrap username, so we verify it is really you before changing anything.

Do not create a second account. Your traps, images, and subscription are attached to your original email.

Email support@ocutrap.com from any address you can use. Include the email on your account, your **Trap ID(s)**, and your name so we can verify ownership and help you regain access.

Coming From the Old OcuTrap App

The old app at base.ocutrap.com and the new app at app.ocutrap.com use separate sign-ins. Your old password does not work on the new app.

- Your account already exists in the new app under the **same email** you used before. Do not sign up for a new one.
- When it is your turn to move, you get an email from OcuTrap with a **Set your password** link. Open it, choose a new password, and sign in at app.ocutrap.com.
- No email yet? The move happens in waves. Keep using the old app until yours arrives.
- Lost the email? Contact support@ocutrap.com and we will send a fresh link.

Still Stuck

Email support@ocutrap.com with:

- The **email address** on your account
- The **exact error message** you see (a screenshot helps)
- Whether you were on the **web app** or the **mobile app**

[Contact Us](#)

Resetting the Mobile App

If the OcuTrap app is frozen, won't load, or you're not getting push notifications, a full quit or reinstall usually fixes it. Your **account, traps, images, and subscription stay on the server** — resetting the app on your phone does not delete them. After you reinstall, sign in with the same email and password.

Try the steps below in order. Start with a force quit; only reinstall if that doesn't help.

Force Quit the App

Closing the app from the home screen isn't always enough. Use the app switcher so it fully stops, then open it again.

iPhone / iPad (iOS)

1. Open the **App Switcher**: swipe up from the bottom of the screen and pause in the middle (or double-click the Home button on older devices).
2. Find the **OcuTrap** card and swipe it **up** to close it.
3. Go back to the Home Screen and open **OcuTrap** again.

Android

1. Open the **Recents** / app switcher (usually the square or recent-apps button, or a swipe-up gesture — depends on your phone).
2. Find **OcuTrap** and swipe it away (or use **Close all** if your phone offers that).
3. Open **OcuTrap** again from your Home Screen or app drawer.

Clear Cache (Android only)

On Android you can clear temporary files without uninstalling. This does **not** remove your signed-in session on every phone, but if the app still misbehaves after force quit, try it before a full reinstall.

1. Open your phone's **Settings**.
2. Tap **Apps** (or **Apps & notifications**), then **OcuTrap**.
3. Tap **Storage** (or **Storage & cache**).
4. Tap **Clear cache** — prefer this over **Clear storage** / **Clear data**, which signs you out and wipes local app data.

iPhone does not expose a separate "clear cache" control for apps. If force quit isn't enough on iOS, go to delete and reinstall below.

Delete and Reinstall the App

Use this when force quit (and Android cache clear) didn't fix the problem, or when support asks you to reinstall so the app can re-register for push notifications.

Before you delete the app, make sure you know the **email and password** for your OcuTrap account. You'll need them to sign in again. If you forgot your password, reset it first — see [Can't Sign In to Your Account](#).

iPhone / iPad (iOS)

1. Touch and hold the **OcuTrap** icon on the Home Screen.
2. Tap **Remove App**, then **Delete App**, and confirm.
3. Open the **App Store**, search for **OcuTrap**, and tap **Get** / the cloud icon to install again.
 - Direct link: [Download on the App Store](#)
4. Open **OcuTrap** and sign in with your email and password.
5. When prompted, **Allow Notifications** so push alerts work again.
 - You can also turn them on later: **Settings** → **Notifications** → **OcuTrap** → **Allow Notifications**, then confirm **Push Notifications** are on in the app's **Notification Settings**.

Android

1. Open **Settings** → **Apps** → **OcuTrap**, then tap **Uninstall** (or touch and hold the OcuTrap icon and choose **Uninstall**).
2. Open **Google Play**, search for **OcuTrap**, and tap **Install**.
 - Direct link: [Get it on Google Play](#)
3. Open **OcuTrap** and sign in with your email and password.
4. When prompted, allow notifications for OcuTrap.
 - You can also turn them on later: **Settings** → **Apps** → **OcuTrap** → **Notifications**, then confirm **Push Notifications** are on in the app's **Notification Settings**.

After You Reinstall

1. Sign in with the **same account** you used before — your traps should appear as usual.
2. Open **Notification Settings** in the app and turn on **Push Notifications** plus the alert types you want.

3. Confirm the phone itself still allows OcuTrap notifications (steps above).

Using the Mobile App

Notification Settings

What This Does Not Change

- Your **OcuTrap account**, password, and email stay the same.
 - Your **traps**, capture history, and images stay on your account.
 - Your **subscription and billing** are unchanged.
 - This is not the same as deleting your account or resetting your password.
-

Still Stuck?

Email support@ocutrap.com and include:

- Whether you're on **iPhone** or **Android**
- What you already tried (force quit, clear cache, reinstall)
- A short description of what the app is doing wrong (a screenshot helps)

Contact Us

Support

Contact Us

Chat Support

You can message OcuTrap support through the chat bubble that can be found on the [OcuTrap.com](https://ocutrap.com) homepage by clicking the chat icon on the bottom right of the page.

Email Support

You can send us an email through the [contact page](#) or emailing us at support@ocutrap.com

Website Status

Check if our website is down at ocutrap.statuspage.io

Bug reporting

The fastest way to report a bug is from inside the OcuTrap app — your report goes straight to our team along with the details we need to reproduce the issue (your account email, app version, and the page or screen you were on).

On the web app (app.ocutrap.com): click **Report a bug** at the bottom of the left sidebar, describe what went wrong and what you expected to happen, and click **Send report**.

On the mobile app: open the **Settings** tab, go to **Help & Support**, tap **Report a bug**, describe the issue, and tap **Send report**.

We'll follow up by email if we need more detail.

You can also report bugs by emailing support@ocutrap.com. Include a detailed bug description, reproduction steps, and any relevant visuals. Explain what you expected to happen and what actually did. Your detailed feedback helps improve our service.

You can also reach us through the chat bubble on the OcuTrap.com homepage.

Safety Information

Using the OcuTrap involves inherent risks. Always adhere to the guidelines in this manual to ensure safe operation and prevent injury or equipment malfunction.

Important:

This manual should be read in its entirety prior to using the OcuTrap, in order to prevent any serious injury or harm. Failure to review this Operations Manual may result in injury.

Warning: Hazard

- **Hazard:**

This device uses a depth sensor to remotely trigger the actuator on the door. This mechanism allows the door to close quickly, which can cause serious injury if precautions are not followed.

Ensure that nothing is blocking the door's path, as this may not only cause injury but can also lead to trap malfunction.

Child Safety

- **Child Safety Warning:**

This product can cause serious injury and contains small components. **Keep children away from the equipment** at all times.

Operational Notice

- **Power Management:**

Make sure that your OcuTrap is turned off when not in use to preserve battery power.

- **POD Security:**

Keep the OcuTrap POD closed after setup to prevent any malfunctions in the system.

- **Water-Tight Assurance:**

Verify that the POD is water-tight during operation by closing both latches and tightening the knob on the right side of the device.

Potential Injury: Finger and Hand Damage

Overview

The OcuTrap door is designed to open and close automatically and swiftly. While this is essential for its proper operation, it also poses a risk of injury—especially to fingers and hands—if safety precautions are not strictly observed.

Potential Injuries

- **Finger Injuries:**

The rapid closure of the door can result in pinching, crushing, or lacerations.

- **Hand Injuries:**

Similarly, if a hand is in the door's path, it can suffer comparable injuries.

Safety Guidelines

- **Keep a Safe Distance:**

Always ensure that your fingers, hands, and any other body parts are completely clear of the door's path before the trap is activated.

- **Supervise Operation:**

Keep children and pets away from the device during its operation to prevent accidental injury.

- **Review the Manual:**

Familiarize yourself with all aspects of this manual and the device's operation to fully understand the safety features and risks.

- **Regular Maintenance:**

Inspect the device frequently to ensure that the door mechanism and other components are functioning properly without signs of wear or misalignment.

- **Stopping the Trap Quickly:**

The OcuTrap has no dedicated emergency-stop button. The fastest ways to halt the door mechanism are: (1) set the trap to **Unarmed** in the app — an unarmed trap will not close on detection; and (2) **power the trap off** by holding the **power button** on the POD for about 3 seconds. Because the door can close quickly whenever the trap is armed, keep hands and fingers clear of the door path at all times rather than relying on a stop after the fact.

In Case of Injury

- **Immediate Action:**

Stop using the device immediately. Administer basic first aid such as cleaning the wound and applying a bandage.

- **Seek Medical Attention:**

For serious injuries, persistent pain, or significant swelling, contact a medical professional immediately.

- **Report the Incident:**

For additional support or to report an incident, please contact our support team at support@ocutrap.com.

Purchases

Payments and Purchases

New traps and accessories are purchased through the website at OcuTrap.com on your mobile phone or computer. Subscription billing is managed separately in the app — see [Billing](#).

Nonprofits and organizations that need purchase orders, invoicing, or ACH payment: see the [Nonprofit & 501\(c\) Program](#).

Nonprofit and 501(c) Program

Nonprofit and 501(c) Program

OcuTrap partners with wildlife rescues, shelters, conservation groups, municipalities, and schools. Eligible 501(c) organizations can receive discounted pricing and tax exempt purchasing where allowed by state law.

Apply here: the [OcuTrap contact page](#)

Benefits

- **Discounted hardware pricing.** Special nonprofit rates on traps and accessories.
- **Onboarding and training.** Setup help, volunteer training materials, and safety guides.
- **Priority support.** Faster responses and a dedicated point of contact for larger deployments.
- **Flexible purchasing.** Quotes on request. Purchase orders and invoicing for qualifying organizations.
- **Bulk benefits.** Volume pricing and spare parts discounts for multi-trap fleets.

Need something not listed

Tell us what would help your mission. We can tailor training, reporting, and deployment plans.

Eligibility

- U.S. 501(c) organizations such as 501(c)(3) charities and 501(c)(4) social welfare groups.
 - Government agencies and accredited schools may qualify for nonprofit pricing.
 - Sales tax exemption depends on the shipping destination state. A state sales tax exemption certificate is usually required.
-

How to get the nonprofit discount

1. **Submit the application.** Use the contact form and title form “Nonprofit pricing and tax exemption.”
Apply on the [OcuTrap contact page](#) or email support@ocutrap.com
2. **Share basic info.** Organization legal name, EIN, billing and shipping addresses, website, and a primary contact.
3. **Account review.** We verify your details and flag your customer account for nonprofit pricing.
4. **Sign in to order.** Your nonprofit pricing appears on quotes or invoices when you shop or place POs.

Processing may take 1-2 weeks

Steps to receive the tax exempt rate

1. **Collect state documentation.**
Provide a **state sales tax exemption certificate** for each state where you want tax exempt purchasing.
2. **Send certificates for approval.**
Upload during the application or include links when you contact us.
3. **Verification.**
We review and mark your account as **tax exempt** for the covered states.
4. **Place orders while signed in.**
Sales tax will not be charged on qualifying orders shipped to approved states.
5. **Keep certificates current.**
Renew before expiration to avoid tax on future orders.

Required documents checklist

- ☐ IRS determination letter showing your 501(c) status
- ☐ State sales tax exemption certificate for each shipping state
- ☐ EIN and organization legal name
- ☐ Billing and shipping addresses



Website URL and primary contact details

Note

The IRS 501(c) letter confirms nonprofit status for discounts. It is not enough for state sales tax exemption in most states.

Purchasing options

- **Quotes and POs.** Available for qualifying organizations.
 - **Invoicing terms.** Net terms may be available after review.
 - **Credit card or ACH.** Supported for faster fulfillment.
-

FAQs**Is the IRS 501(c) letter enough for tax exempt purchases**

Not in most states. You will need the applicable state sales tax exemption certificate.

Do municipalities and schools qualify

Yes. State tax exemption depends on your state and documentation.

Can we use a purchase order

Yes, for qualifying organizations. Include PO details when you contact us.

Contact

Questions or ready to apply
[contact page](#)

Legal & Compliance

Warranty Information

The full OcuTrap hardware warranty terms are published on our website:

<https://ocutrap.com/pages/warranty> OcuTrap Warranty — ocutrap.com/pages/warranty {% endembed %}

For warranty claims or questions, contact support@ocutrap.com with your Trap ID.

Legal Disclaimers & Compliance Information

All OcuTrap policies, terms, and legal documents are kept in a single place on our website. The versions there are always the most current.

Central source: [OcuTrap Legal & Policy Documents](#) — one hub that links to every policy listed below.

General Policies

- [Privacy Policy](#)
- [Terms of Service](#)
- [Refund Policy](#)
- [Shipping Policy](#)

Product & Service Policies

- [Subscription Policy](#)
- [Hardware Warranty](#)
- [Software License Agreement](#)
- [Volume Pricing Policy](#)

Data & Technology

- [Data Use Policy](#)
 - [Animal Recognition Policy](#)
-

See also

- [Warranty Information](#) — where to find the full warranty terms.
- [Your Data & Privacy](#) — what OcuTrap collects and your controls.
- [Responsible & Legal Use](#) — using OcuTrap within local laws.
- [Safety Information](#) — operating the device safely.

Responsible & Legal Use

This page is **general guidance, not legal advice**. Laws differ by country, state/province, and municipality, and they change over time. **You are responsible for knowing and following the rules that apply where you use your OcuTrap.**

Know Your Local Laws

Trapping animals — and especially **moving or releasing them somewhere else** — is regulated almost everywhere. Before you deploy a trap, check with your **local wildlife or fish-and-game authority**.

Rules commonly cover:

- **Permits and licenses** — some areas require one to trap at all.
 - **Which species you may trap** — and which are protected.
 - **What you may do with a captured animal** — on-site release, relocation, or, in some cases, required handling by a professional.
 - **Relocation limits** — many areas restrict or prohibit moving wildlife, or cap the distance.
 - **Trapping seasons** and required **check frequency**.
 - **Consent** to trap on a given property.
-

Protected & Non-Target Species

- **Release protected and non-target animals immediately and unharmed**, at the place they were caught. Do not relocate them.
 - OcuTrap's detection is designed to be **selective**, but no system is perfect — be prepared to release animals you didn't intend to catch. See [Handling & Releasing a Captured Animal](#).
 - If an animal is injured, or you're unsure whether a species is protected, contact your **local wildlife authority or a licensed wildlife rehabilitator**.
-

Pets

OcuTrap's target weight range (**5–25 lb**) overlaps with domestic cats and small dogs. If you trap a pet, **release it promptly** and, if it's identifiable, let the owner know. Consider this when choosing where and when to arm your trap.

Humane Treatment

- Check captures **promptly** — OcuTrap reminds you for up to 48 hours, but sooner is better for the animal.
 - Keep a captured animal **shaded, ventilated, and out of extreme heat or cold**.
 - Minimize handling time and stress. See [Handling & Releasing a Captured Animal](#).
-

OcuTrap Policies

Your use of OcuTrap is also governed by our published policies:

- [Legal Disclaimers & Compliance Information](#) — Terms of Service, Privacy Policy, Animal Recognition Policy, and more.
 - [Safety Information](#) — operating the device safely.
-

See also

- [Handling & Releasing a Captured Animal](#)
- [Your Data & Privacy](#)

- [Legal Disclaimers & Compliance Information](#)

Your Data & Privacy

This page explains, in plain terms, what information your OcuTrap collects and the controls you have over it. For the full legal text, see the **Privacy Policy** and **Data Use Policy**, linked from [Legal Disclaimers & Compliance Information](#).

What OcuTrap Collects

To do its job, your trap and the OcuTrap app handle:

- **Images** — capture photos and, if enabled, timelapse images from the trap's camera.
 - **Location** — GPS position of the trap (see [GPS](#)).
 - **Device & sensor data** — battery level, temperature/humidity, door state, connectivity, and similar status used to keep the trap running and to send you alerts.
 - **Account information** — the details you provide when you create and manage your account.
-

Who Can See Your Data

- **You**, as the account owner.
 - **People you share traps with.** When you share a trap, the recipient can see that trap's data according to their **user level**. See [Sharing Traps](#) and [User Levels](#).
 - Sharing is under your control — you choose who to add and can manage access at any time.
-

Data Retention

- **While your account is active**, your captures, images, and trap data remain available in the OcuTrap app so you can review past events and trends.
- **You stay in control.** You can remove individual images whenever you like (see below); deleted images are removed from your account.

- **When you delete your account**, your associated data is removed. See [Account Deletion](#).
 - Your data is **stored securely in the cloud** and protected both in transit and at rest. For the complete, authoritative terms, see our [Privacy Policy](#).
-

Managing & Deleting Your Data

- **Delete individual images** you no longer want — see [Deleting an Image](#).
 - **Delete your account and associated data** — see [Account Deletion](#).
-

Image Recognition

OcuTrap uses automated image recognition to help identify captures. How that works and how the resulting data is handled is described in our **Animal Recognition Policy**, linked from [Legal Disclaimers & Compliance Information](#).

See also

- [Legal Disclaimers & Compliance Information](#) — Privacy Policy, Data Use Policy, Animal Recognition Policy, and more.
- [Sharing Traps](#) and [User Levels](#)
- [Deleting an Image](#)
- [Account Deletion](#)

Device Management

Deleting a Trap

Removing a trap permanently deletes the trap and all of its data from your account. Review this page before proceeding.

Warning: This action is permanent and cannot be undone. Removing a trap deletes its images, activity history, and vitals history. Anyone the trap was shared with also loses access.

Before you start

- **Only the trap's owner can remove it.** Managers and users the trap is shared with do not see the option.
- **The trap's subscription must be canceled first.** The app will not remove a trap that still has an active subscription. Cancel it from the trap's **Trap billing** page: select **Billing** in the sidebar, find the trap under **Per-trap status**, select **Manage**, then **Manage subscription** to cancel in the Stripe portal. See . Note that a canceled subscription stays active until the end of the current billing period, so the trap can be removed once the period ends and the trap shows **Canceled**. If the trap is billed through an organization, it must be removed from the organization's billing first.
- **Use the web app.** Trap removal is available at app.ocutrap.com, not in the mobile app.

Steps

1. **Open the trap** — sign in at app.ocutrap.com and select the trap you want to remove.
2. **Go to the Settings tab** on the trap's page.
3. **Scroll to the Danger zone** section at the bottom of Settings.
4. **Click "Remove trap."** If the button is disabled, the trap still has an active subscription. Cancel it from the trap's **Trap billing** page first.

5. **Confirm.** A **Remove trap?** dialog summarizes what will be deleted. Click **Remove** to permanently delete the trap. You'll be returned to your trap list.

What happens when you remove a trap

- The trap and all of its data — images, activity history, and vitals history — are permanently deleted from your account.
- Sharing access is removed for everyone the trap was shared with.
- The physical trap itself is unaffected. It can be added to another OcuTrap account later — if you're handing it to a new owner, follow .

Selling or Transferring a Trap

There are two ways to hand a trap to a new owner:

- **Transfer ownership in the app.** The trap moves to the new owner's account in one step, including its settings and its capture history.
- **Remove, then re-add.** You delete the trap (and your images and history) from your account, and the new owner adds it fresh.

Both paths require the trap's subscription to be canceled first.

Pick based on the history. An in-app transfer hands the new owner your images and activity for that trap. If you don't want the new owner to see them, use remove-then-re-add instead.

Option 1: Transfer ownership in the app

The fastest hand-off. The trap keeps its capture history and moves to the new owner immediately.

1. **The new owner needs an OcuTrap account first.** The transfer is addressed to their account email, so have them sign up and tell you the email they used.
2. **Cancel the trap's subscription.** Select **Billing** in the sidebar, find the trap under **Per-trap status**, select **Manage**, then **Manage subscription** to cancel in the Stripe portal (see). If the trap is billed through an organization,

- remove it from the organization's billing first. The app will not transfer a trap that still carries a subscription.
3. On the trap's page, open the **Settings** tab, scroll to the **Danger zone**, and choose **Transfer ownership**.
 4. Enter the new owner's account email and confirm. The confirmation reminds you what the hand-off does: the new owner will see this trap's capture history, everyone you shared the trap with loses access, and the trap leaves any organization it belongs to. If the trap is in an organization, the confirmation names it.
 5. Done. The trap leaves your account and appears in the new owner's account right away. They start their own subscription from the trap's **Trap billing** page to bring it online.

A transfer clears every kind of access, not just yours.

- **Shared users.** Everyone you shared the trap with loses access, including people you invited who have not accepted yet. The new owner starts with an empty sharing list and re-invites whoever they want.
- **Organizations.** The trap leaves every organization it belongs to, along with any trap group it was assigned to. Members of that organization lose access to the trap, its photos, and its controls. The organization itself, its trap groups, and its members are not changed.

Nothing here is reversible from your side after the transfer. If the trap should stay with an organization, do not transfer it: the new owner adds it to an organization themselves.

Only the trap's owner can transfer it. Being an owner in an organization the trap belongs to is not enough. If the email you enter has no OcuTrap account, the app will ask you to have the new owner sign up first.

Option 2: Remove, then re-add (fresh start)

Use this when the new owner should start with a clean slate. It is a **remove, then re-add** process, and the order matters:

1. **You** cancel the trap's subscription.
2. **You** remove the trap from your account.
3. **The new owner** adds the trap to their account and starts their own subscription.

Do the steps in this order. The app will not remove a trap that still has an active subscription, and the new owner cannot add a trap that is still attached to your account.

Removing the trap permanently deletes your images and history for that trap. Save anything you want to keep before you start.

Step 1: Cancel the trap's subscription

1. Sign in at app.ocutrap.com, select **Billing** in the sidebar, find the trap under **Per-trap status**, and select **Manage**.
2. Select **Manage subscription** and cancel in the Stripe portal. See .
3. A canceled subscription stays active until the end of the current billing period; the trap can be removed once it shows **Canceled**.

If the trap is billed through an organization, remove it from the organization's billing first.

Step 2: Remove the trap from your account

1. On the trap's page, open the **Settings** tab and scroll to the **Danger zone**.
2. Click **Remove trap** and confirm. This permanently deletes the trap and its data from your account.

Full instructions and what gets deleted:

Step 3: New owner adds the trap

1. The new owner needs their own OcuTrap account with a verified email.
2. After signing in, they open **Add trap** and enter the **Trap ID** and **Device ID** (found on the trap and inside the POD), choose a cellular plan, name the trap, set its location, and tap **Activate trap**. See .
3. They then start a subscription from the trap's **Trap billing** page to bring the trap online.

Buying a trap second-hand

If you bought a trap from a previous owner, add it the normal way: open **Add trap** and enter the **Trap ID** and **Device ID** printed on the unit (and inside the POD), then finish the wizard — see .

If the app says "**Device ID already registered**," OcuTrap automatically checks whether the trap is unclaimed. When the **Trap ID** you entered matches the one printed on the unit, the trap is transferred to your account and the add continues as normal — no support ticket needed.

If it can't be claimed automatically — the Trap ID doesn't match the unit, the trap still belongs to someone else, or the unit can't be verified — you'll be asked to double-check the **Trap ID** printed on the unit or contact support. Re-enter the printed Trap ID exactly; if it still won't add, contact us via .

A seller doesn't need to do anything special to release a trap — removing it from their account (Steps 1–2 above) is enough for the next owner to add it.

Important Notes

- With **Remove, then re-add**, your images and history are deleted and the new owner starts fresh. With **Transfer ownership**, they move to the new owner with the trap.
- The **warranty** begins from the date the trap was first activated, not the transfer date.
- Any **free trial** of service may have already been used during the original activation.

Trap Tests

Firmware requirement: v565 or later

A safe, audio-only demo of your trap's detection pipeline — no door movement.

Before You Start

Confirm all four before running Trap Test:

1. Trap door is **open**
2. Trap is **unarmed**
3. Trap is **clear** of obstructions
4. Open the back pod door so the beeps can be clearly heard

Finding Trap Test Button

From your trap, tap **Settings** → **More Settings** → **Trap Test** button at the top of the settings page.

What the Button Does

Tapping **Trap Test** sends a test command to your device. The trap enters a safe demo mode — audio feedback only, no door movement. There is no visible response in the app; listen for audio from the trap to confirm the test is running.

Running the Test

Wave your hand (or any object) toward the sensor. You'll hear the trap react through four phases:

Phase	What You Hear	What It Means
Waiting	Silent	Ready — move something toward the sensor
Detecting	Beeps, speeding up	Object seen within ~39 in (1000 mm)
Verified	Confirmation cue	Reading is stable — move into the capture zone
Capture!	Solid 3-second tone	Crossed the trigger distance — door would close in real mode

Account and Billing

Your OcuTrap Subscription

An active subscription keeps your trap **connected over cellular** and unlocks the cloud features of the OcuTrap app. **Each trap has its own subscription**, so if you own more than one, each is billed and managed separately.

What's Included

With an active subscription, your trap stays online and you get the full OcuTrap experience:

- **Cellular connectivity** — the cellular data your trap uses is included; there's no separate data plan or SIM card to buy.
 - **Remote monitoring and control** — open, close, arm, and adjust settings from anywhere.
 - **Captures and notifications** — real-time capture alerts by push and/or email (see [Notification Settings](#)).
 - **Image history** — view captured and timelapse images in the app.
 - **GPS and map view** — see where each trap is located.
-

Plans & Billing

- Choose **Monthly** or **Annual** billing — annual is billed once a year and costs less than paying monthly.
 - All billing is handled securely through **Stripe**.
 - You can switch between plans, update your payment method, or cancel at any time. See [Managing Your Subscription](#).
-

Canceling

- You can **cancel at any time**. You won't be charged again, and your subscription **stays active until the end of the current billing period**.

- See [Managing Your Subscription](#) for steps.
-

If Your Subscription Lapses

A trap's subscription can end because you canceled it, a payment failed, or it was never started. When that happens, the trap shows **Canceled** (it ran before) or **Inactive** (it never started) under **Per-trap status** on the **Billing** page.

Because cellular data is part of your subscription, a trap **without an active subscription can no longer connect to the OcuTrap cloud**. This means:

- **Remote control stops** — you can't open, close, arm, or adjust the trap from the app.
- **Live captures and notifications stop** — the trap can't report events while disconnected.

Reactivating your subscription restores full function. You can **reactivate at any time**, and the trap continues to work without interruption once the plan is active again:

1. Sign in at app.ocutrap.com.
2. Select **Billing** in the sidebar, find the trap under **Per-trap status**, and select **Manage**.
3. Under **Cellular plan**, pick **Monthly** or **Annual** and complete checkout.

Full steps: [Update Individual Trap Subscriptions](#).

Pausing a Trap (Monthly Plans)

If you don't need a trap for a while but don't want to cancel, you can **pause** its subscription instead. Pause it from the trap's **Trap billing** page (**Pause subscription**).

- **Monthly plans only**, for up to **6 months**. Annual plans can't be paused.
- **While paused, you're not billed** and no invoices are generated.
- A paused trap is **dormant** — remote commands and new captures are off. (Opening the door and releasing an animal stay available for welfare.)
- **Your data and settings are kept** and restored in full when you resume.

- It **resumes automatically** on the date you choose, or you can **Resume now** anytime.

A paused trap shows a **Paused** status. This is different from a subscription that lapses from a failed payment (see above) — pausing is something you choose, and you can resume it yourself at any time.

See also

- [Billing When You Move to the New App](#)
- [Managing Your Subscription](#)
- [Update Individual Trap Subscriptions](#)
- [Transferring Trap Billing to an Organization](#)
- [Changing Your Subscription Payment Method](#)
- [Connectivity & Cellular Coverage](#)

Billing When You Move to the New App

We rebuilt the OcuTrap app. Your account moves to it. **Your billing does not change.**

Same plan. Same price. Same renewal date. Same payment method. You are not charged anything new for the move.

You do not need to do anything to keep your subscription. It moves with your trap, automatically.

What Carries Over

- **Your subscription.** Each trap keeps the subscription it already has. One subscription per trap, exactly as today.
- **Your price.** Monthly stays Monthly. Annual stays Annual. The amount does not change.
- **Your renewal date.** Unchanged. Your next charge lands on the same day it would have.
- **Your payment method.** The same card stays on file. Nothing to re-enter.
- **Your invoice history.** Your past invoices stay in the **Stripe** billing portal. Same billing account, so nothing is lost.

- **Your trial.** If a trap is in a free **Trial**, the trial keeps its end date.

Your subscription is billed through **Stripe**, and it always has been. The move does not create a new subscription, cancel your old one, or interrupt service.

What You Do

1. Watch for our email with your **Set your password** link.
2. Set your password.
3. Sign in at app.ocutrap.com or in the mobile app, using the same email address you use today.

Your traps, photos, shared access, and subscription are already attached when you arrive.

What You Should See

Sign in and select **Billing** in the sidebar. You should see:

- Each trap listed under **Per-trap status**, marked **Active** (or **Trial** if you're in a free trial), never **Inactive**.
- Your **Payment method** showing **Provider: Stripe** and **Active subscription**.
- Your past charges under **Invoices**.

Select **Manage** next to a trap to open its **Trap billing** page. There, **Plan** reads **Cellular plan**, **Billing frequency** reads **Monthly** or **Annual**, and **Next charge** shows your renewal date, unchanged.

Important: Do Not Subscribe Twice

If the new app asks you to check out for a trap you already pay for, stop. Do not complete checkout.

Migrated traps never need a new checkout. If you're prompted for one, something is attached wrong, and paying again would start a second subscription on that trap.

Email support@ocutrap.com instead. Include the trap name. We'll fix the attachment. Your existing subscription keeps running while we do.

If a Charge Looks Wrong

Email support@ocutrap.com with:

- The trap name.
- The date and amount of the charge.
- The email address on your account.

We can see your billing records on both sides of the move, so we can tell you exactly what a charge is for and correct it if it's wrong.

The Old App

The old app stays available until the retire date in your email. After that, OcuTrap lives only in the new app.

There is **nothing to cancel** in the old app. Your subscription was never billed by it. It is the same Stripe subscription throughout, and it simply continues.

Common Questions

Will I be billed by both apps?

No. There is one subscription per trap and it does not get duplicated by the move. The old app does not bill you separately.

Do I need to re-enter my card?

No. Your payment method stays on file.

Will my trap lose service because of the move?

No. Your subscription does not lapse, so nothing about billing takes your trap offline.

I use a different email now than when I bought my trap.

Reply to our email or contact support@ocutrap.com. We'll move your account, traps, and subscription to your current address before you set a password. Your billing doesn't change.

Can I still pause, cancel, or change my plan?

Yes. Those work the same way in the new app. See [Managing Your Subscription](#).

See also

- [Your OcuTrap Subscription](#)
- [Managing Your Subscription](#)
- [Billing](#)
- [Changing Your Subscription Payment Method](#)

Billing**1. Signing In**

1. **Log in** to your OcuTrap account at app.ocutrap.com.
2. The sidebar has **Settings**, **Billing**, and **Account**. **Account** holds your personal information and security settings. **Billing** holds your subscriptions.

The **Billing** page shows your plan, your **Payment method**, **Per-trap status** for every trap you can see, and **Invoices**. Each trap has its own subscription, so select **Manage** next to a trap to open its **Trap billing** page.

2. Opening the Billing Portal

1. On the **Billing** page, select **Payment portal** at the top, or **Manage in portal** on the **Payment method** card.
2. On a single trap's **Trap billing** page, select **Manage subscription** (or **Update payment / Resolve payment** if a payment failed).

In the portal you can:

- **Update billing information** (address, payment method, etc.)

- **Manage credit cards** (add/remove payment methods)
- **Cancel a subscription**
- **View past invoices**

Switching between **Monthly** and **Annual** is done in the app, not the portal. See section 3.2.

3. Managing Your Subscriptions

Once you are in the secure billing portal, you'll see an overview of your subscriptions for your traps. From here, you can:

3.1 Update Billing Information

- **Address** – Update your physical billing or shipping address.
- **Credit Cards** – Add, remove, or modify your credit card on file.
- **Payment Methods** – Choose a default payment method if you have multiple.

3.2 Change Subscription Plans

There is one plan, the **Cellular plan**, billed **Monthly** or **Annual** per trap. There are no feature tiers.

- **Switch billing interval** – Do this in the app, not the portal. On the trap's **Trap billing** page, under **Cellular plan**, select **Monthly** or **Annual**.
- **Cancel** – End the subscription in the Stripe portal. You'll still have access for the remainder of your billing cycle.

3.3 Status Definitions

These are the statuses shown on the **Billing** page under **Per-trap status**:

- **Active**
The subscription is paid and the trap has full function.
- **Trial**
The trap is in its free trial. You aren't charged until the trial ends.
- **Past Due**
A payment failed. The trap still works for now. Select **Update payment**.

- **Suspended**

Payment stayed unresolved. The trap stops taking images and accepting commands. Select **Resolve payment**.

- **Canceled**

The subscription was canceled. Access continues until the cancellation date takes effect.

- **Paused**

You paused a monthly plan. Billing is stopped and the trap is dormant.

- **Inactive**

No subscription was ever started for this trap.

If you have questions about a status, [contact our support team](#).

4. Frequently Asked Questions

4.1 How do I update my payment method?

1. On the **Billing** page, select **Payment portal** (or **Manage in portal** on the **Payment method** card).
2. Select **Payment Methods**.
3. Add a new card or edit existing card details.
4. Confirm your changes.

Full steps: [Changing Your Subscription Payment Method](#).

4.2 Can I view my billing history?

Yes. The **Billing** page has an **Invoices** section covering all traps, with **View** and **Receipt** on each row. A single trap's **Trap billing** page has **Recent invoices** for that trap only.

5. Getting Help

If you encounter any issues or have additional questions, please reach out to us:

- **Email:** support@ocutrap.com

We're here to help you get the most out of your OcuTrap subscription.

Changing Your Subscription Payment Method

1. Log in to Your Account

1. Visit app.ocutrap.com and sign in to your account.
2. Select **Billing** in the sidebar.
3. Select **Payment portal** at the top of the page, or **Manage in portal** on the **Payment method** card. Either one opens the Stripe portal, where your card is stored.

The **Payment method** card shows **Provider: Stripe** and a status of **Active subscription**, **Update required**, or **No active subscription**.

2. Add a New Payment Method

1. In the Stripe portal, scroll down to **Payment Methods**.
2. Click **Add payment method**.

3. If You Are Using Link

Some customers already have a card saved through **Link**, Stripe's fast checkout system.

If you see that your card is associated with Link:

1. Click the **three dots** at the top right of the payment method.
2. Select **Pay without Link**.

This will allow you to use a normal card or bank account instead of Link.

4. Enter Your New Payment Information

You will now see options to:

- Add a new credit or debit card
- Add a bank account

Enter your details and save the payment method.

5. Set the New Method as Default (Optional)

If you entered multiple payment methods, choose which one should be used for your subscription.

1. Under the payment method list, click **Make default** next to the method you want active.

Update Individual Trap Subscriptions

When You Might Need to Update

- The trap shows **Canceled** or **Inactive** under **Per-trap status** on the **Billing** page
- You've never started a subscription for this trap
- Your subscription ended or payment failed

Update Your Subscription in a Few Steps

1. **Sign in**
Go to app.ocutrap.com and sign in.
2. **Open the trap's billing page**
Select **Billing** in the sidebar. Find the trap under **Per-trap status** and select **Manage**. The page is titled **Trap billing**.
3. **Start or renew the subscription**
Under **Cellular plan**, pick **Monthly** or **Annual**, then complete checkout in Stripe. On a canceled or never-started trap the button reads **Subscribe · Monthly** or **Subscribe · Annual**.

Once finished, the trap shows **Active** and continues to work without interruption.

Tip: Each trap has its own subscription, so if you have more than one, repeat these steps for each trap you want to activate. The **Billing** page lists every trap you can see under **Per-trap status**.

Transferring Trap Billing to an Organization

If a trap you own is billed to you individually, you can move its subscription onto your **organization's** billing. After the transfer, the organization's payment method is charged for that trap going forward, and the trap appears on the organization's invoice alongside your other organization traps.

Adding a trap to an organization does **not** move its billing on its own. Transferring billing is a separate, deliberate step you take on the trap's **Trap billing** page.

Before You Start

You can transfer a trap's billing to an organization only when **all** of the following are true:

- **You own the trap.** Only the trap owner can transfer its billing.
- **You are the organization's primary owner.** Organization billing is handled by a single payer — the organization's primary owner. If someone else is the primary owner, they'll need to make the transfer (or transfer ownership to you first).
- **The trap is already in the organization.** Add it to the organization first (from the Organizations area); adding it does not move billing by itself.
- **The trap has an active individual subscription.** Its plan must be **Active** or in a free **Trial**, and not already billed to an organization.

If any of these isn't met, the **Transfer billing to an organization** section still appears, and tells you which condition is missing.

How to Transfer

1. Sign in at app.ocutrap.com.
2. Select **Billing** in the sidebar, find the trap under **Per-trap status**, and select **Manage**.
3. Scroll to **Transfer billing to an organization**. If you're the primary owner of more than one eligible organization, pick one first.
4. Select **Transfer billing to *your organization***. The confirmation spells out what changes.

5. Select **Continue to Stripe**, confirm the organization's payment method, and complete checkout. If the organization doesn't have a payment method on file yet, Stripe collects one here.

There's **no free trial** on a transfer. The trap is already subscribed, so its billing simply moves to the organization. If you close the checkout window without finishing, **nothing changes** and the trap stays on its individual subscription.

What Changes After the Transfer

- **The organization pays going forward.** The organization's payment method is charged for the trap from now on, and the trap is included on the organization's invoice.
 - **Your individual subscription is canceled.** The trap's old individual subscription ends right away, and any unused paid time is returned to **you** as a **prorated credit** on your personal billing account.
 - **Your billing interval stays the same** — Monthly stays Monthly and Annual stays Annual — unless the organization is on a different billing cycle, in which case the organization's cycle applies.
 - **Organization discounts apply automatically**, if your organization has one.
-

Moving Billing Back

If the trap is later removed from the organization, its organization billing is canceled and the trap goes **Inactive**. To keep it running, start an individual subscription again from the trap's **Trap billing** page. See [Update Individual Trap Subscriptions](#).

See also

- [Your OcuTrap Subscription](#)
- [Managing Your Subscription](#)
- [Update Individual Trap Subscriptions](#)

Resetting Password

If you forget your password, you can reset it from the email we send you:

1. Go to app.ocutrap.com and click **Forgot password?**
2. Enter your email and click **Send Reset Code**.
3. Open the email and click **Reset Password**. The page opens headed **Choose a new password**, already knowing your email and code.
4. Enter your **new password**, confirm it, and submit. When you see **Password reset complete**, sign in with your new password.

Your password is kept in sync across the web and mobile apps, so the new password works everywhere.

If the Button Doesn't Work

Some mail apps strip buttons out. The email carries a reset code underneath as a backup:

1. Back in the app, click **Enter Reset Code**.
2. Copy the code from the email and paste it in, then enter your new password.

The code is **long** (32 characters of mixed letters and numbers), so copy and paste it rather than typing it. It is also **case-sensitive**. If your phone capitalizes the first character for you, the code stops working, so check the first letter after pasting.

Codes are single use. If one is rejected, click **Didn't receive a code? Send again** and use the newest email.

Managing Your Subscription

How to Access Subscription Settings

1. Go to app.ocutrap.com and sign in.
2. Select **Billing** in the sidebar for an overview across traps.
3. For one trap, find it under **Per-trap status** and select **Manage**. That opens its **Trap billing** page.

Available Options

On a trap's **Trap billing** page you can:

- **Switch plans** – Under **Cellular plan**, select **Monthly** or **Annual**. The current one is marked **Current**.
- **Pause subscription** – Temporarily pause a monthly plan (see below).
- **Manage subscription** – Opens the secure Stripe portal to manage your card. The **Billing** page also has **Payment portal** and **Manage in portal**.
- **Cancel subscription** – Cancel in the Stripe portal. You'll continue to have access until the end of your current billing period.
- **Reactivate** – Changed your mind after canceling? Until your billing period ends, a **Canceling at end of period** notice on the **Trap billing** page offers **Reactivate**, and your subscription continues as if you never canceled.
- **View invoices** – See past charges under **Recent invoices** on the **Trap billing** page (this trap only) or under **Invoices** on the **Billing** page (all traps). Each row has **View** and **Receipt**.

If a payment failed, the button reads **Update payment**. If the trap was suspended, it reads **Resolve payment**. Both open the Stripe portal.

Only the trap owner can change a subscription or payment method. Shared users see a note instead of the buttons.

Pausing a Trap

Monthly plans can be **paused** for up to **6 months** from the trap's **Trap billing** page (**Pause subscription**). While paused you aren't billed, the trap is dormant (no remote commands or new captures, though you can still open the door and release an animal), and your data and settings are kept and restored when you resume. It resumes automatically on your chosen date, or you can **Resume now** anytime. Annual plans can't be paused, and the button shows as **Pause (monthly only)**. See [Your OcuTrap Subscription](#).

Notes

- All billing is processed securely through Stripe.
- If you cancel, you won't be charged again, but your subscription remains active until the billing period ends — and you can reactivate it any time before then.

- Annual subscriptions are billed once per year, offering savings compared to monthly billing.

Account Deletion

You can permanently delete your OcuTrap account from the web app or the mobile app. Deletion cannot be undone.

Warning: Deleting your account permanently deletes your owned traps and their data, removes sharing access, and removes you from organizations (where allowed). It cannot be undone.

Before you start

1. **Cancel active trap subscriptions** in Billing. The app blocks account deletion while you still own an active or trialing subscription.
2. If you are the **only owner** (or the billing owner) of an organization, **transfer ownership or delete that organization** first. The app will block deletion until those orgs are resolved.

What deletion does

When you confirm deletion, OcuTrap will:

- Permanently delete **traps you own**, including captures/images, settings, vitals, and location history for those traps
- **Remove sharing access** — revoke shares you granted to others, and remove you from traps that were shared with you
- Remove your **organization memberships** (after the owner/billing guards above are satisfied)
- Permanently delete your **account** and sign you out

It does **not** cancel Stripe subscriptions for you — cancel those in Billing first.

Web

1. Sign in at app.ocutrap.com and open **Account**.
2. Scroll to the **Danger zone** section and, next to **Delete account**, click **Delete**.

3. Read the consequences list in the confirmation dialog.
4. **Re-enter your account email** to confirm (capitalization does not matter).
5. Click **Delete account**.

You are signed out when deletion completes.

Mobile

1. Open the OcuTrap mobile app and go to **Settings** → **Account**.
2. Under **Danger zone**, tap **Delete account**.
3. Read the consequences list on the confirmation screen.
4. **Type your account email** to confirm (capitalization does not matter).
5. Tap **Delete account**.

You are signed out when deletion completes.